“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 25

Making the Residents of Kāśī Vaiṣṇavas, and the Return to Nīlācala

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. A brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra was a servant of Mahāprabhu. Whenever he heard the Lord’s glory, he was filled with joy. One day he invited the sannyāsīs and Mahāprabhu, brought them together, and made the sannyāsīs fit to receive Mahāprabhu’s mercy; this is described in the seventh chapter of the Ādi-līlā. From that day the Lord’s greatness became known throughout the city of Vārāṇasī, and many of its residents became His followers. One of Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī’s disciples also became a follower of the Lord. When this disciple censured Māyāvāda and described the greatness of the teaching of pure devotion that Mahāprabhu had given, Prakāśānanda Svāmī defended his own position with many arguments. One day, after bathing at Pañcanada, Mahāprabhu began kīrtana with His devotees in the temple of Bindu-mādhava, and Prakāśānanda came there with his disciples. Prakāśānanda fell down and clasped Mahāprabhu’s feet, condemned his own past conduct, and asked about the truth of bhakti in harmony with Vedānta. Mahāprabhu taught him the unprecedented doctrine of devotion established in the Brahma-sampradāya, showed that the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is the commentary on the *Brahma-sūtra*, and, explaining the *Catuḥ-ślokī*, set forth the whole truth. From that day the sannyāsīs became “devotees.” Mahāprabhu instructed Sanātana, told him to go to Vṛndāvana, and set out for Puruṣottama. After this Kavirāja Gosvāmī described something of the history of Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana and Subuddhi Rāya. Mahāprabhu set out with Balabhadra through Jhārikhaṇḍa and arrived in Śrī Puruṣottama. In the last part of this chapter Śrī Kavirāja Gosvāmī listed the

subjects of every chapter of the Madhya-līlā and instructed all jīvas to read this *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Gaurasundara turns the Māyāvādīs, averse to Kṛṣṇa, towards Kṛṣṇa —

বৈষ্ণবীকৃত্য সন্ন্যাসিমুখান্ কাশীনিবাসিনঃ ।
সনাতনং সুসংস্কৃত্য প্রভুর্নীলাদ্রিমাগমৎ ॥ ১ ॥

vaiṣṇavī-kṛtya sannyāsi-
having made Vaiṣṇavas the sannyāsīs
mukhān kāśī-nivāsinaḥ
headed by of Kāśī the residents
sanātanaṁ su-saṁskṛtya
Sanātana fully having purified
prabhur nīlādrim āgamat
the Lord to Nīlādri went

1 The Lord made Vaiṣṇavas of the residents of Kāśī, headed by the sannyāsīs; He fully purified Sanātana, and then He went to Nīlādri.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Having made the sannyāsīs and the other residents of Kāśī "Vaiṣṇavas," and having performed the purificatory rite (*saṁskāra*) for Sanātana in the best way, the Lord came to Nīlādri.

Anubhāṣya.

prabhuḥ (Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanyacandra) **kāśī-nivāsinaḥ** (living in Vārāṇasī) **sannyāsi-mukhān** (the sannyāsīs headed by Prakāśānanda and others) **vaiṣṇavī-kṛtya** (having brought onto the path of pure devotion) **sanātanaṁ su-saṁskṛtya** (and having given him the dress of a pure Vaiṣṇava)[35] **nīlādrim** (to Śrī Puruṣottama-kṣetra) **āgamat**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory to Gaura's devotees host

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

For two months the Lord instructs Sanātana in Kāśī —

এই মত মহাপ্রভু দুই মাস পর্য্যন্ত ।
শিখাইলা তাঁরে ভক্তিসিদ্ধান্তের অন্ত ॥ ৩ ॥

ei-mata mahāprabhu dui māsa paryanta
in this way Mahāprabhu two months for
śikhāilā tāṁre bhakti-siddhāntera anta
taught him of the conclusions of bhakti the utmost limit

3 In this way, for two months, Mahāprabhu taught him the conclusions of bhakti to their utmost depth.

Paramānanda Kīrtanīyā's service to the Lord —

'পরমানন্দ কীর্ত্তনীয়া' — শেখরের সঙ্গী ।
প্রভুরে কীর্ত্তন শুনায়, অতি বড় রঙ্গী ॥ ৪ ॥

'paramānanda kīrtanīyā' — śekharera saṅgī
Paramānanda Kīrtanīyā Śekhara's companion
prabhure kīrtana śunāya, ati baḍa raṅgī
to the Lord kīrtana makes hear very great in delight

4 Paramānanda Kīrtanīyā, the companion of Candraśekhara, would sing kīrtana for the Lord with great delight.

The Lord delivers the Māyāvādīs of Kāśī only to fulfil the wish of His devotees

—

সন্ন্যাসীর গণ প্রভুরে যদি উপেক্ষিল ।
ভক্ত-দুঃখ খণ্ডাইতে তারে কৃপা হৈল ॥ ৫ ॥

sannyāsīra gaṇa prabhure yadi upekṣila
of the sannyāsīs the host the Lord when disregarded
bhakta-duḥkha khaṇḍāite tāre kṛpā haila
the devotees' sorrow to dispel for them mercy arose

5 When the sannyāsīs disregarded the Lord, mercy towards them arose in Him, so that He might dispel the sorrow of His devotees.

The deliverance of the Māyāvādīs was described earlier, in the Ādi-līlā; now it is told again, briefly —

সন্ন্যাসীরে কৃপা পূর্ব্বে লিখিয়াছোঁ বিস্তারিয়া ।
উদ্দেশে কহিয়ে ইঁহা সংক্ষেপ করিয়া ॥ ৬ ॥

sannyāsīre kṛpā pūrve likhiyāchoṁ vistāriyā
to the sannyāsīs the mercy before I have written in detail
uddeśe kahiye iṁhā saṅkṣepa kariyā
by way of mention I tell here brief making (it)

6 I have described the Lord's mercy to the sannyāsīs before, in detail. Here I mention it again, briefly.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"I have described this before in detail" — see Ādi 7.

The Māyāvādī sannyāsīs revile the Lord; the brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra reflects, pained at heart —

যাঁহা তাঁহা প্রভুর নিন্দা করে সন্ন্যাসীর গণ ।
শুনি' দুঃখে মহারাষ্ট্রীয় বিপ্র করয়ে চিন্তন ॥ ৭ ॥

yāṁhā tāṁhā prabhura nindā kare sannyāsīra gaṇa
here there of the Lord blasphemy do of the sannyāsīs the host
śuni' duḥkhe mahārāṣṭrīya vipra karaye cintana
hearing in sorrow a Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa does reflection

7 Everywhere the sannyāsīs blasphemed the Lord. Hearing this, a brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra reflected sorrowfully:

The sign by which the Lord is known to be the Supreme Lord —

প্রভুর স্বভাব, — যেবা দেখে সন্নিধানে ।
'স্বরূপ' অনুভবি' তাঁরে 'ঈশ্বর' করি' মানে ॥ ৮ ॥

prabhura svabhāva, — yebā dekhe sannidhāne
the Lord's nature whoever sees near at hand
'svarūpa' anubhavi' tāṁre 'īśvara' kari' māne
His true nature perceiving Him as Īśvara taking accepts

8 "Whoever sees the Lord's nature at close hand perceives who He truly is and accepts Him as Īśvara, the Supreme Lord.

The wish to bring everyone together —

কোন প্রকারে পারোঁ যদি একত্র করিতে ।
ইহা দেখি' সন্ন্যাসিগণ হবে ইঁহার ভক্তে ॥ ৯ ॥

kona prakāre pāroṁ yadi ekatra karite
by some means I can if together to bring
ihā dekhi' sannyāsi-gaṇa habe iṁhāra bhakte
this seeing the sannyāsīs will become His devotees

9 If by some means I can bring them together, the sannyāsīs will see this and become His devotees.

বারাণসী-বাস আমার হয় সর্ব্বকালে ।
সর্ব্বকাল দুঃখ পাব, ইহা না করিলে ॥ ১০ ॥

vārāṇasī-vāsa āmāra haya sarva-kāle
in Vārāṇasī residence my is at all times
sarva-kāla duḥkha pāba, ihā nā karile
at all times sorrow I will get this not if I do

10 I live in Vārāṇasī all the time. If I do not do this, I shall grieve for ever."

The Māyāvādī sannyāsīs are invited to his home —

এত চিন্তি' নিমন্ত্রিল সন্ন্যাসীর গণে ।
তবে সেই বিপ্র আইল মহাপ্রভুর স্থানে ॥ ১১ ॥

eta cinti' nimantrila sannyāsīra gaṇe
so thinking he invited of the sannyāsīs the host
tabe sei vipra āila mahāprabhura sthāne
then that brāhmaṇa came Mahāprabhu's to the place

11 Thinking thus, he invited all the sannyāsīs. Then that brāhmaṇa came to the place where Mahāprabhu was staying.

Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra at the same time make the same appeal to the Lord —

হেনকালে নিন্দা শুনি' শেখর, তপন ।
দুঃখ পাঞা প্রভু-পদে কৈলা নিবেদন ॥ ১২ ॥

hena-kāle nindā śuni' śekhara, tapana
at that time the blasphemy hearing Śekhara Tapana
duḥkha pāñā prabhu-pade kailā nivedana
sorrow feeling at the Lord's feet made a petition

12 At that time Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra, pained to hear the blasphemy, made their appeal at the Lord's feet.

To fulfil the wish of His devotees, the Lord desires to bestow mercy —

ভক্ত-দুঃখ দেখি' প্রভু মনেতে চিন্তিল ।
সন্ন্যাসীর মন ফিরাইতে মন হইল ॥ ১৩ ॥

bhakta-duḥkha dekhi' prabhu manete cintila
the devotees' sorrow seeing the Lord in His mind reflected
sannyāsīra mana phirāite mana haila
of the sannyāsīs the minds to turn the wish arose

13 Seeing His devotees' sorrow, the Lord reflected within Himself, and the wish arose in Him to turn the hearts of the sannyāsīs.

The brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra arrives and invites the Lord —

হেনকালে বিপ্র আসি' করিল নিমন্ত্রণ ।
অনেক দৈন্যাদি করি' ধরিল চরণ ॥ ১৪ ॥

hena-kāle vipra āsi' karila nimantraṇa
at that time the brāhmaṇa coming made an invitation
aneka dainyādi kari' dharila caraṇa
much humility and so on showing clasped the feet

14 Just then the brāhmaṇa came and invited Him. With great humility he clasped the Lord's feet.

The Lord accepts the invitation —

তবে মহাপ্রভু তাঁর নিমন্ত্রণ মানিলা ।
আর দিন মধ্যাহ্ন করি' তাঁর ঘরে গেলা ॥ ১৫ ॥

tabe mahāprabhu tāṁra nimantraṇa mānilā
then Mahāprabhu his invitation accepted
āra dina madhyāhna kari' tāṁra ghare gelā
the next day midday duties performing to his house went

15 Mahāprabhu then accepted his invitation, and the next day, after His midday duties, He went to his house.

The deliverance of the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs was described earlier, in the

seventh chapter of the Ādi-līlā —

তাঁহা যৈছে কৈলা প্রভু সন্ন্যাসী-নিস্তার ।
পঞ্চতত্ত্বাখ্যানে তাহা কৈরাছি বিস্তার ॥ ১৬ ॥

tāṁhā yaiche kailā prabhu sannyāsī-nistāra
there how made the Lord the deliverance of the sannyāsīs
pañca-tattvākhyāne tāhā kairāchi vistāra
in the account of the Pañca-tattva that I have made in detail

16 I have already told in detail, in the account of the Pañca-tattva, how the Lord delivered the sannyāsīs there.

Anubhāṣya.
Ādi 7: there this pastime is described in detail in the account of the Pañca-tattva.

The fear of repeating himself —

গ্রন্থ বাড়ে, পুনরপি হয় ত' কথন ।
তাঁহা যেন না লিখিলুঁ, তাহা করিয়ে লিখন ॥ ১৭ ॥

grantha bāḍe, punarapi haya ta' kathana
the book grows again would be indeed a telling
tāṁhā yena nā likhiluṁ, tāhā kariye likhana
there what not I wrote that I make writing

17 To tell it again would only lengthen the book; so here I write only what I did not write there.

From the day the Māyāvādīs received mercy, many logicians gather to debate with the Lord —

যে দিবস প্রভু সন্ন্যাসীরে কৃপা কৈল ।
সে দিবস হৈতে গ্রামে কোলাহল হৈল ॥ ১৮ ॥

ye divasa prabhu sannyāsīre kṛpā kaila
on which day the Lord to the sannyāsīs mercy showed
se divasa haite grāme kolāhala haila
that day from in the town a clamour arose

18 From the day the Lord showed mercy to the sannyāsīs, the whole town was astir.

লোকের সংঘট্ট আইসে প্রভুরে দেখিতে ।
নানা শাস্ত্রে পণ্ডিত আইসে শাস্ত্র বিচারিতে ॥ ১৯ ॥

lokera saṅghaṭṭa āise prabhure dekhite
of people crowds come the Lord to see
nānā śāstre paṇḍita āise śāstra vicārite
in various scriptures scholars come scripture to discuss

19 Crowds of people came to see the Lord, and scholars learned in various scriptures came to discuss scripture with Him.

With irrefutable arguments full of the conclusions of pure devotion, the Lord demolishes everyone's false reasoning —

সর্ব্বশাস্ত্র খণ্ডি' প্রভু 'ভক্তি' করে সার ।
সযুক্তিক বাক্যে মন ফিরায় সবার ॥ ২০ ॥

sarva-śāstra khaṇḍi' prabhu 'bhakti' kare sāra
all scriptures refuting the Lord bhakti makes the essence
sa-yuktika vākye mana phirāya sabāra
with well-reasoned words the minds turns of all

20 Refuting every rival reading of the scriptures, the Lord established bhakti as their essence, and with well-reasoned words He turned everyone's mind.

Everyone receives the Lord's teaching and sings the names of Hari —

উপদেশ লঞা করে কৃষ্ণ-সংকীর্ত্তন ।
সর্ব্বলোক হাসে, গায়, করয়ে নর্ত্তন ॥ ২১ ॥

upadeśa lañā kare kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
the instruction accepting perform kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
sarva-loka hāse, gāya, karaye nartana
all the people laugh sing do dancing

21 Accepting His instruction, they performed kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana; all the people laughed, sang and danced.

The sannyāsīs give up Māyāvāda and, among themselves, talk of Kṛṣṇa —

প্রভুরে প্রণত হৈল সন্ন্যাসীর গণ ।
আত্মমধ্যে গোষ্ঠী করে ছাড়ি' অধ্যয়ন ॥ ২২ ॥

prabhure praṇata haila sannyāsīra gaṇa
before the Lord bowed down became of the sannyāsīs the host
ātma-madhye goṣṭhī kare chāḍi' adhyayana
among themselves discussion they hold giving up study

22 The sannyāsīs bowed down to the Lord. Giving up their studies, they held discussions among themselves.

Anubhāṣya.
The sannyāsīs gave up their own study of Vedānta, gathered among themselves, and began to talk about the path of bhakti that Mahāprabhu had shown.

At an assembly, one of Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī's disciples, weighing the doctrines, recognises the Lord as Nārāyaṇa, praises His explanation of Vedānta as spiritual pastimes (cid-vilāsa), and condemns Śaṅkara's Māyāvāda interpretation —

প্রকাশানন্দের শিষ্য এক তাঁহার সমান ।
সভামধ্যে কহে প্রভুর করিয়া সম্মান ॥ ২৩ ॥

prakāśānandera śiṣya eka tāṁhāra samāna
Prakāśānanda's disciple one to him equal
sabhā-madhye kahe prabhura kariyā sammāna
the assembly in the midst of says the Lord showing honour

23 One of Prakāśānanda's disciples, his equal, spoke in the assembly in praise of the Lord:

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য হয় 'সাক্ষাৎ নারায়ণ' ।
'ব্যাসসূত্রের' অর্থ করেন অতি-মনোরম ॥ ২৪ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya haya 'sākṣāt nārāyaṇa'
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is directly Nārāyaṇa
'vyāsa-sūtrera' artha karena ati-manorama
of the Vyāsa-sūtra the meaning He gives most charming

24 "Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Nārāyaṇa Himself. He explains the meaning of the *Vyāsa-sūtra* most charmingly.

উপনিষদের করেন মুখ্যার্থ ব্যাখ্যান ।
শুনিয়া পণ্ডিত-লোকের জুড়ায় মন-কাণ ॥ ২৫ ॥

upaniṣadera karena mukhyārtha vyākhyāna
of the Upaniṣads He gives of the primary meaning explanation
śuniyā paṇḍita-lokera juḍāya mana-kāṇa
hearing of learned men are soothed minds ears

25 He explains the primary meaning of the Upaniṣads, and hearing it soothes the minds and ears of the learned.

সূত্র-উপনিষদের মুখ্যার্থ ছাড়িয়া ।
আচার্য্য 'কল্পনা' করে আগ্রহ করিয়া ॥ ২৬ ॥

sūtra-upaniṣadera mukhyārtha chāḍiyā
of the sūtras and Upaniṣads the primary meaning abandoning
ācārya 'kalpanā' kare āgraha kariyā
the Ācārya imagination makes insistence showing

26 Abandoning the primary meaning of the sūtras and the Upaniṣads, the Ācārya (Śaṅkara) insists on his own imaginings.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Ācārya means Śaṅkarācārya.

আচার্য্য-কল্পিত অর্থ যে পণ্ডিত শুনে ।
মুখে 'হয়' 'হয়' করে, হৃদয় না মানে ॥ ২৭ ॥

ācārya-kalpita artha ye paṇḍita śune
by the Ācārya imagined meaning which a scholar hears
mukhe 'haya' 'haya' kare, hṛdaya nā māne
with his mouth 'yes' 'yes' he says the heart not accepts

27 When a scholar hears the meaning the Ācārya imagined, his mouth says 'Yes, yes,' but his heart does not accept it.

On the path of knowledge, māyā cannot be conquered by false renunciation (phalgu-vairāgya) —

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-বাক্য দৃঢ় সত্য মানি ।
কলিকালে সন্ন্যাসে 'সংসার' নাহি জিনি ॥ ২৮ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-vākya dṛḍha satya māni
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's words firmly true I accept
kali-kāle sannyāse 'saṁsāra' nāhi jini
in the age of Kali by sannyāsa saṁsāra not we conquer

28 I accept the words of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya as firmly true: in the age of Kali one does not conquer *saṁsāra* by sannyāsa.

Praise of the Lord's explanation of the verse harer nāma —

হরের্নাম-শ্লোকের যেই করিলা ব্যাখ্যান ।
সেই সত্য সুখদার্থ পরম প্রমাণ ॥ ২৯ ॥

harer nāma-ślokera yei karilā vyākhyāna
of the harer nāma verse which He gave explanation
sei satya sukhadārtha parama pramāṇa
that true a delightful meaning supreme evidence

29 The explanation He gave of the *harer nāma* verse is true; its meaning gives joy, and it is the supreme evidence.

Only bhakti grants liberation, and even the semblance of the Name (nāmābhāsa) gives liberation —

ভক্তি বিনা মুক্তি নহে, ভাগবতে কয় ।
কলিকালে নামাভাসে সুখে মুক্তি হয় ॥ ৩০ ॥

bhakti vinā mukti nahe, bhāgavate kaya
bhakti without liberation there is not in the Bhāgavata it says
kali-kāle nāmābhāse sukhe mukti haya
in the age of Kali by nāmābhāsa easily liberation comes

30 The *Bhāgavata* says that without bhakti there is no liberation, and in the age of Kali liberation comes easily by *nāmābhāsa*, the mere semblance of the holy name.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 14, verse 4)

শ্রেয়ঃসৃতিং ভক্তিমুদস্য তে বিভো
ক্লিশ্যন্তি যে কেবলবোধলব্ধয়ে ।
তেষামসৌ ক্লেশল এব শিষ্যতে
নান্যদ্যথা স্থূলতুষাবঘাতিনাম্ ॥ ৩১ ॥

śreyaḥ-sṛtiṁ bhaktim udasya te vibho
the path to the highest good bhakti having rejected Your O almighty Lord
kliśyanti ye kevala-bodha-labdhaye
toil those who for attaining mere knowledge
teṣām asau kleśala eva śiṣyate
for them this toil only remains
nānyad yathā sthūla-tuṣāvaghātinām
nothing else as for those who pound empty husks

31 "O almighty Lord, bhakti to You is the path to the highest good. Those who reject it and toil only to gain knowledge are left with nothing but their toil, like those who pound empty husks." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.4)[2]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 22.22.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 2, verse 32)

যেঽন্যেঽরবিন্দাক্ষ বিমুক্তমানিন-
ত্ত্বয়্যস্তভাবাদবিশুদ্ধবুদ্ধয়ঃ ।
আরুহ্য কৃচ্ছ্রেণ পরং পদং ততঃ
পতন্ত্যধোঽনাদৃতযুষ্মদঙ্ঘ্রয়ঃ ॥ ৩২ ॥

ye 'nye 'ravindākṣa vimukta-māninas
those who others O lotus-eyed Lord who think themselves liberated
tvayy asta-bhāvād aviśuddha-buddhayaḥ
towards You for want of love of impure intelligence
āruhya kṛcchreṇa paraṁ padaṁ tataḥ
having risen with hardship to the supreme position from there
patanty adho 'nādṛta-yuṣmad-aṅghrayaḥ
fall down having neglected Your feet

32 "O lotus-eyed Lord, others think themselves liberated, but their intelligence is impure, for they have no love for You. Though they rise with great hardship to the supreme position, they fall down from there, having neglected Your feet." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.2.32)[3]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 22.30.

The primary meaning of the word brahma —

'ব্রহ্ম'-শব্দে কহে 'ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যপূর্ণ ভগবান্' ।
তাঁরে 'নির্ব্বিশেষ' স্থাপি, 'পূর্ণতা' হয় হানি ॥ ৩৩ ॥

'brahma' śabde kahe 'ṣaḍ-aiśvarya-pūrṇa bhagavān'
'Brahman' by the word is meant full of the six opulences Bhagavān
tāṅhre 'nirviśeṣa' sthāpi, 'pūrṇatā' haya hāni
Him as without attributes establishing completeness suffers loss

33 The word ‘Brahman’ means Bhagavān, full of the six opulences. To establish Him as without attributes (*nirviśeṣa*) is to diminish His completeness.

Anubhāṣya.

To declare Bhagavān featureless (*nirviśeṣa*) is to deny His transcendental possession of attributes (*saviśeṣatva*), and so the fullness of His potencies is impaired. Featurelessness (*nirviśeṣatva*) is only the incomplete manifestation of one of His potencies.

By the descending path (avaroha) the Śrutis and Purāṇas reveal transcendental spiritual pastimes (cid-vilāsa); to regard these spiritual pastimes beyond māyā as māyic pastimes of matter, following the ascending path of logic (āroha), is itself irreligion (pāṣaṇḍatā), or a great offence (mahāparādha) —

শ্রুতি-পুরাণ কহে — কৃষ্ণের চিচ্ছক্তি-বিলাস ।
তাহা নাহি মানি’ পণ্ডিত করে উপহাস ॥ ৩৪ ॥

śruti-purāṇa kahe — kṛṣṇera cic-chakti-vilāsa
the śrutis the Purāṇas say Kṛṣṇa’s of the spiritual potency the play
tāhā nāhi māni’ paṇḍita kare upahāsa
that not accepting the scholar makes mockery

34 The śrutis and the Purāṇas speak of the play of Kṛṣṇa’s spiritual potency (*cic-chakti-vilāsa*). Not accepting this, the scholar mocks it.

Anubhāṣya.

The Vedic scriptures and all the Purāṇas establish the supreme eternality of the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa’s spiritual potency (*cic-chakti*). The *jñānī* who fancies himself a paṇḍita, with his worldly learning full of the desire to enjoy, sinks ever deeper into self-conceit. Deluded by the false notion that “the spiritual potency cannot have pastimes; they are one of the forms of *māyā-śakti*,” he ridicules [them].

চিদানন্দ কৃষ্ণবিগ্রহে ‘মায়িক’ করি’ মানি ।
এই বড় ‘পাপ’, — সত্য চৈতন্যের বাণী ॥ ৩৫ ॥

cid-ānanda kṛṣṇa-vigrahe ‘māyika’ kari’ māni
spiritual and blissful Kṛṣṇa’s form māyic taking to regard
ei baḍa ‘pāpa’, — satya caitanyera vāṇī
this a great sin true Caitanya’s words

35 To regard Kṛṣṇa’s form of spirit and bliss as *māyic* is a great sin. Caitanya’s words are true.

Anubhāṣya.
The *nirviśeṣa-vādī* regards Kṛṣṇa’s *sac-cid-ānanda* form as a form of Īśvara imagined and fashioned by māyā, and so he cannot understand Bhagavān’s eternal possession of attributes. This arrogance, or atheism (*nāstikatā*), is itself the gravest offence. In the words of Śrīman Mahāprabhu, Kṛṣṇa’s *sac-cid-ānanda* form, possessed of attributes, is full of eternal, true spiritual pastimes — that is the real truth.

The form full of spiritual pastimes is supreme above the featureless form — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 3, Chapter 9, verses 3–4) —

নাতঃ পরং পরম যদ্ভবতঃ স্বরূপ-
মানন্দমাত্রমবিকল্পমবিদ্ধবর্চ্চঃ ।
পশ্যামি বিশ্বসৃজমেকমবিশ্বমাত্মন্
ভূতেন্দ্রিয়াত্মকমদস্ত উপাশ্রিতোঽস্মি ॥ ৩৬ ॥

nātaḥ paraṁ parama yad bhavataḥ svarūpam
not than this higher O Supreme which Your form
ānanda-mātram avikalpam aviddha-varcaḥ
pure bliss free of difference of unobscured radiance
paśyāmi viśva-sṛjam ekam aviśvam ātman
I see of the universe the creator one distinct from the universe O Self
bhūtendriyātmakam adas ta upāśrito ’smi
the source of the elements and senses that Your sheltered I am

36 “O Supreme Lord, I see nothing higher than this form of Yours, which is pure bliss, free of all difference, its radiance unobscured. You are the one creator of the universe, yet You are distinct from it, O Self, and You are the source of the elements and the senses. I have taken shelter of that form of Yours.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"O Supreme! This form of Yours is bliss alone, free of all differentiation (*avikalpa*), radiant and beyond māyā. There is no form higher than the one I now behold. O Soul (*ātmā*)! You create the universe and yet are distinct from it. This form of Yours that I behold is the source of the elements and the senses; in it I take shelter (*prapatti*)."

Anubhāṣya.

Brahmā was born from the navel of Garbhodakaśāyī, yet he could not know that Puruṣa. So he entered the water and, performing austerities, began to offer prayers to Bhagavān. In the next two verses he describes how the *sac-cid-ānanda* form, possessed of attributes and full of spiritual pastimes, is superior to His featureless form.

parama (O Supreme Lord), **aviddha-varcaḥ** (whose radiance is untouched by *prakṛti*; being beyond māyā, it shines unveiled; therefore) **avikalpam** (that in which there is no variegated creation — nondual knowledge) **ānanda-mātram** (that of which bliss, the featureless spiritual Brahman, is but a part [*mātrā*])[36] **yat bhavataḥ** (Your) **svarūpam** (form of the complete Bhagavān), **ataḥ** (than this form) **param** (anything other), or higher, **na paśyāmi**. **ātman** (O Paramātmā), **viśva-sṛjam** (the creator of the universe) **ekam** (the one without a second) **aviśvam** (distinct from the perishable universe, for He is imperishable) **bhūtendriyātmakam** (the cause of the elements and the senses) **te** (Your) **adaḥ** (transcendental) form **upāśrito 'smi** (in it I take shelter).

The nirviśeṣa-vādī regards the form of Bhagavān, the master of māyā, as "māyic" — and this leads to hell —

তদ্বা ইদং ভুবনমঙ্গল মঙ্গলায়
ধ্যানে স্ম নো দর্শিতং ত উপাসকানাম্ ।
তস্মৈ নমো ভগবতেঽনুবিধেম তুভ্যং
যোঽনাদৃতো নরকভাগ্ভিরসৎপ্রসঙ্গৈঃ ॥ ৩৭ ॥

tad vā idaṁ bhuvana-maṅgala maṅgalāya
that indeed this (form) O good of the worlds for the good
dhyāne sma no darśitaṁ ta upāsakānām
in meditation indeed to us shown by You to the worshippers
tasmai namo bhagavate 'nuvidhema tubhyaṁ
to Him obeisance to Bhagavān we offer to You
yo 'nādṛto naraka-bhāgbhir asat-prasaṅgaiḥ
who is not honoured by those bound for hell attached to false arguments

37 "O good of all the worlds, for our good You have shown this very form to us, Your worshippers, in meditation. We bow down to You, Bhagavān, whom those bound for hell, attached to false arguments, do not honour." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.9.4)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"O auspiciousness of the universe! For our good You have revealed in meditation this form of Yours, worthy of our worship. To this form of Bhagavān we bow down and render service. People defiled by bad company and destined for hell have no regard for this spiritual form.[34]"

Anubhāṣya.
bhuvana-maṅgala (O sole abode of the *jīvas'* welfare), **tat vai** (this very form) **upāsakānām naḥ** (us) **maṅgalāya dhyāne te** (by You) **darśitaṁ sma**. **asat-prasaṅgaiḥ** (by those devoted to false reasoning and absorbed in speculation on featureless Brahman opposed to the path of *śruti* — whose words are fabricated by ignorance) **naraka-bhāgbhiḥ** (by certain atheists bound for hell) **yaḥ** (You, the Puruṣa) **na ādṛtaḥ** (are not accepted at all), **tasmai bhagavate tubhyaṁ namaḥ anuvidhema** (following [You], we bow down).

Seeing the transcendental Kṛṣṇa in a humanlike form, the irreligious in their worldly way think Him mortal — (Bhagavad-gītā, Chapter 9, verse 11)

অবজানন্তি মাং মূঢ়া মানুষীং তনুমাশ্রিতম্ ৷
পরং ভাবমজানন্তো সর্ব্বভূতমহেশ্বরম্ ॥ ৩৮ ॥

avajānanti mām mūḍhā
disregard Me fools
mānuṣīṁ tanum āśritam
humanlike form who has assumed
paraṁ bhāvam ajānanto
the supreme nature not knowing
sarva-bhūta-maheśvaram
of all beings the great Lord

38 "Fools disregard Me when I appear in a humanlike form, not knowing My supreme nature as the great Lord of all beings." (Bhagavad-gītā, 9.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Fools disregard Me, who have assumed a human form: they regard My eternal spiritual body as dependent on māyā and so disregard it. For they do not know the supreme spiritual nature of My form as Kṛṣṇa, the Great Lord of all beings.

Anubhāṣya.
sarva-bhūta-maheśvaram (of the Lord of all living beings, that is, of Me) **paraṁ bhāvam** (the truth of the transcendental embodiment of *rasa*) **ajānantaḥ mūḍhāḥ** (bewildered by sense-born knowledge) **mānuṣīm** (a humanlike form, taken by the will of the devotees, to delight the devotees) **tanum** (a body, though it is made of *śuddha-sattva*) **āśritam** (who has assumed) **mām** (Me, who have descended) **avajānanti** (disregard).

The destination of the irreligious — (Bhagavad-gītā, Chapter 16, verse 19)

তানহং দ্বিষতঃ ক্রূরান্ সংসারেষু নরাধমান্ ।
ক্ষিপাম্যজস্রমশুভানাসুরীষ্বেব যোনিষু ॥ ৩৯ ॥

tān ahaṁ dviṣataḥ krūrān
those I envious cruel
saṁsāreṣu narādhamān
into the cycles of birth and death the lowest of men
kṣipāmy ajasram aśubhān
I cast perpetually impure
āsurīṣv eva yoniṣu
into demonic indeed wombs

39 “Again and again I cast those envious, cruel and impure men, the lowest of mankind, into the cycles of birth and death — into demonic wombs.” (Bhagavad-gītā, 16.19)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The cruel, the lowest of men, who hate My divine form (*śrī-mūrti*), I cast again and again in this world into the wombs of *asuras* and other beings.

Anubhāṣya.

(Me) **dviṣataḥ** (given to hatred) **krūrān** (cruel) **aśubhān** (given to forbidden conduct) **narādhamān tān** (those people) **eva saṁsāreṣu** (on the paths of birth and death) **āsurīṣu yoniṣu** (into the wombs of animals, beasts and the like, endowed with cruelty and greed) **ajasram** (again and again) **aham kṣipāmi** (that is, for their terrible offences I give them just such a fruit).

Disregarding the guru, or out of hostility to the guru, the logicians reject the path of śruti — the transformation of potency — and so teach “vivarta-vāda”

—

সূত্রের পরিণাম-বাদ, তাহা না মানিয়া ।
‘বিবর্ত্তবাদ’ স্থাপে, ‘ব্যাস ভ্রান্ত’ বলিয়া ॥ ৪০ ॥

sūtrera pariṇāma-vāda, tāhā nā māniyā
of the sūtras the doctrine of transformation that not accepting
‘vivarta-vāda’ sthāpe, ‘vyāsa bhrānta’ baliyā
vivarta-vāda he establishes ‘Vyāsa is mistaken’ saying

40 Not accepting the doctrine of transformation (*pariṇāma-vāda*) taught in the sūtras, he establishes *vivarta-vāda*, saying that Vyāsa was mistaken.

Anubhāṣya.

See Ādi 7.121–126.

Relying on vivarta-vāda, the asuras bewilder the irreligious with fabricated meanings of Vedānta and the Upaniṣads by way of the secondary sense

(lakṣaṇā-vṛtti) —

এই ত' কল্পিত অর্থ মনে নাহি ভায় ।
শাস্ত্র ছাড়ি' কুকল্পনা পাষণ্ডে বুঝায় ॥ ৪১ ॥

ei ta' kalpita artha mane nāhi bhāya
this indeed imagined meaning to the mind not appeals
śāstra chāḍi' kukalpanā pāṣaṇḍe bujhāya
the scriptures abandoning wicked fancies to the pāṣaṇḍīs he explains

41 Such an imagined meaning does not appeal to the mind. Abandoning the scriptures, he explains his wicked fancies to the *pāṣaṇḍīs*.

Abandoning the highest goal, the mercy of Bhagavān, they take shelter of barren wrangling —

পরমার্থ-বিচার গেল, করি মাত্র 'বাদ' ।
কাঁহা মুক্তি পাব, কাঁহা কৃষ্ণের প্রসাদ ॥ ৪২ ॥

paramārtha-vicāra gela, kari mātra 'vāda'
inquiry into the highest truth is gone we do only argument
kāṁhā mukti pāba, kāṁhā kṛṣṇera prasāda
where liberation shall we get where Kṛṣṇa's grace

42 Inquiry into the highest truth is gone; we only argue. How shall we gain liberation, and how Kṛṣṇa's grace?

The cloud of the Śāṅkara-bhāṣya covers the sun of Vedānta —

ব্যাসসূত্রের অর্থ আচার্য্য করিয়াছে আচ্ছাদন ।
এই হয় সত্য শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-বচন ॥ ৪৩ ॥

vyāsa-sūtrera artha ācārya kariyāche ācchādana
of the Vyāsa-sūtra the meaning the Ācārya has covered
ei haya satya śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-vacana
this is true Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's word

43 The Ācārya has covered the meaning of the *Vyāsa-sūtra* — so says Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, and His words are true.

"Caitanya's teaching alone is the essence"; teachings without Caitanya (acaitanya, "unconscious") are all "empty" —

চৈতন্য-গোসাঞি যেই কহে, সেই মত সার ।
আর যত মত, সেই সব ছারখার ॥ ৪৪ ॥

caitanya-gosāñi yei kahe, sei mata sāra
Caitanya Gosāñi whatever says that doctrine is the essence
āra yata mata, sei saba chārakhāra
other as many doctrines they all worthless

44 Whatever Caitanya Gosāñi says is the essential doctrine; all other doctrines are worthless."

The words of Prakāśānanda, now a devotee of Gaura; there is no evidence that after his deliverance he received the name "Prabodhānanda" —

এত কহি' সেই করে কৃষ্ণসংকীর্ত্তন ।
শুনি' প্রকাশানন্দ কিছু কহেন বচন ॥ ৪৫ ॥

eta kahi' sei kare kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
so saying he performs kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana
śuni' prakāśānanda kichu kahena vacana
hearing Prakāśānanda some speaks words

45 Having said this, he began kṛṣṇa-saṅkīrtana. Hearing him, Prakāśānanda spoke:

To establish kevalādvaita-vāda, Śaṅkara tries to refute the Sātvata scriptures — this is "covert atheism" (pracchanna-nāstikatā), or unbelief in Bhagavān —

আচার্য্যের আগ্রহ — 'অদ্বৈতবাদ' স্থাপিতে ।
তাতে সূত্রের ব্যাখ্যা করে অন্য রীতে ॥ ৪৬ ॥

ācāryera āgraha — 'advaita-vāda' sthāpite
the Ācārya's insistence advaita-vāda to establish
tāte sūtrera vyākhyā kare anya rīte
therefore of the sūtras explanation he gives in another way

46 "The Ācārya was determined to establish *advaita-vāda*, and so he explained the sūtras in another way.

'ভগবত্তা' মানিলে 'অদ্বৈত' না যায় স্থাপন ।
অতএব সব শাস্ত্র করয়ে খণ্ডন ॥ ৪৭ ॥

'bhagavattā' mānile 'advaita' nā yāya sthāpana
Bhagavattā if one accepts advaita not can be established
ataeva saba śāstra karaye khaṇḍana
therefore all scriptures he makes refutation

47 If one accepts that He is Bhagavān (*bhagavattā*), *advaita* cannot be established. Therefore he refutes all the scriptures.

The fruit of doctrines rooted in false logic —

যেই গ্রন্থকর্ত্তা চাহে স্ব-মত স্থাপিতে ।
শাস্ত্রের সহজ অর্থ নহে তাঁহা হৈতে ॥ ৪৮ ॥

yei grantha-kartā cāhe sva-mata sthāpite
which of a book author wants his own doctrine to establish
śāstrera sahaja artha nahe tāṁhā haite
of the scriptures the natural meaning does not come from him

48 An author who wants to establish his own doctrine cannot give the natural meaning of the scriptures.

The various doctrines of the philosophers of the six schools, and the Vedic teaching —

'মীমাংসক' কহে, — ঈশ্বর হয় কর্ম্মের অঙ্গ ।
'সাংখ্য' কহে, — জগতের প্রকৃতি কারণ ॥ ৪৯ ॥

'mīmāṁsaka' kahe, — īśvara haya karmera aṅga
the Mīmāṁsaka says Īśvara is of karma a limb
'sāṅkhya' kahe, — jagatera prakṛti kāraṇa
the Sāṅkhya says of the world prakṛti is the cause

49 The Mīmāṁsaka says that Īśvara is a mere adjunct of karma; the Sāṅkhya says that *prakṛti* is the cause of the world.

‘ন্যায়’ কহে, — পরমাণু হৈতে বিশ্ব হয়।
‘মায়াবাদী’ নির্ব্বিশেষ-ব্রহ্মে ‘হেতু’ কয় ॥ ৫০ ॥

‘nyāya’ kahe, — paramāṇu haite viśva haya
the Nyāya says from atoms the universe arises
‘māyāvādī’ nirviśeṣa-brahme ‘hetu’ kaya
the Māyāvādī the impersonal Brahman the cause calls

50 The Nyāya says that the universe arises from atoms. The Māyāvādī calls the impersonal Brahman the cause.

‘পাতঞ্জল’ কহে, — ঈশ্বর হয় স্বরূপ-আখ্যান।
বেদমতে কহে তাঁরে স্বয়ংভগবান্ ॥ ৫১ ॥

‘pātañjala’ kahe, — īśvara haya svarūpa-ākhyāna
the Pātañjala says Īśvara is the realisation of one’s own nature
veda-mate kahe tāṅre svayaṁ bhagavān
in the Vedic view they call Him Svayam Bhagavān

51 The Pātañjala says that Īśvara is the realisation of one’s own nature. In the view of the Vedas, He is called Svayam Bhagavān, the Lord Himself.

In the Brahma-sūtra Vyāsa refutes all the doctrines —

ছয়ের ছয় মত ব্যাস কৈলা আবর্ত্তন।
সেই সব সূত্র লঞা ‘বেদান্ত’-বর্ণন ॥ ৫২ ॥

chayera chaya mata vyāsa kailā āvartana
of the six the six doctrines Vyāsa made overturning
sei saba sūtra lañā ‘vedānta’-varṇana
those all sūtras taking the description of Vedānta

52 Vyāsa overturned the six doctrines of the six schools, and in his sūtras he set forth the Vedānta.

According to "Vedānta," Brahman is a form full of spiritual pastimes, possessed of attributes — that is, full of eternity, knowledge and bliss (sac-cid-ānanda) —

'বেদান্ত'-মতে, — ব্রহ্ম 'সাকার' নিরূপণ ।
'নির্গুণ' ব্যতিরেকে তিঁহো হয় ত' 'সগুণ' ॥ ৫৩ ॥

'vedānta' mate, — brahma 'sākāra' nirūpaṇa
of Vedānta in the view Brahman with form is defined
'nirguṇa' vyatireke tiṁho haya ta' 'saguṇa'
nirguṇa by negation He is indeed saguṇa

53 In the view of Vedānta, Brahman is defined as having form (*sākāra*), and the word *nirguṇa*, a negation, shows that He is in truth *saguṇa* — possessed of qualities.

Refuting the opinions of others, each tries to establish his own doctrine —

পরম কারণ ঈশ্বর কেহ নাহি মানে ।
স্ব-স্ব-মত স্থাপে পরমতের খণ্ডনে ॥ ৫৪ ॥

parama kāraṇa īśvara keha nāhi māne
as the supreme cause Īśvara no one not accepts
sva-sva-mata sthāpe para-matera khaṇḍane
each his own doctrine establishes of others' doctrines by refutation

54 None of them accepts Īśvara as the supreme cause. Each establishes his own doctrine by refuting the doctrines of others.

One should leave the six darśanas — paths of logic rooted in uncertainty and governed by the mind — and take shelter of the mahājana who follows the path of śruti, that is, of the pure devotee —

তাতে ছয় দর্শন হৈতে 'তত্ত্ব' নাহি জানি ।
'মহাজন' যেই কহে, সেই 'সত্য' মানি ॥ ৫৫ ॥

tāte chaya darśana haite 'tattva' nāhi jāni
therefore the six philosophies from the truth not we know
'mahājana' yei kahe, sei 'satya' māni
the mahājanas whatever say that as truth we accept

55 So we do not come to know the truth from the six philosophies; we accept as truth what the *mahājanas* say.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Having heard the other *sannyāsī*'s words, imbued with devotion, Prakāśānanda Sarasvatī says: "Śaṅkarācārya was excessively eager to establish *advaita-vāda*, and so he explained the sūtras in another way. If one accepts that there is Bhagavān (*bhagavattā*), *advaita-vāda* cannot remain. That is why the Ācārya tried to refute all the other scriptures that establish the truth of Bhagavān. To abandon the plain meaning of the scriptures in order to establish one's own opinion — that is the rule of every 'doctrine' (*matavāda*). Look: (1) The Mīmāṁsakas headed by Jaimini abandoned bhakti, the root purport of the Vedas, and made Īśvara 'a limb of karma.' (2) The godless (*nirīśvara*) authors of Sāṅkhya headed by Kapila abandoned the true meaning of the Vedas and declared *prakṛti* the cause of the world. (3) Gautama, Kaṇāda and others, in the scriptures of Nyāya and Vaiśeṣika, called the atoms the cause of the universe. (4) In the same way the Māyāvādīs headed by Aṣṭāvakra presented featureless Brahman as the cause of the world. (5) Rāja-yogīs such as Patañjali established as the 'essential truth' (*svarūpa-tattva*) the imaginary Īśvara described in his *Yoga-śāstra*. These ācāryas, devoted to their doctrines, rejected Svayam Bhagavān, established by the Vedas, and each set up an 'opinion' based on a partial (*khaṇḍa*) perception of Him. Śrī Vyāsadeva thoroughly examined the six opinions of the six *darśanas*, refuted each of them, and, relying on the Vedic statements that establish Bhagavān, composed the *Vedānta-sūtra*. According to Vedānta, Brahman is *sac-cid-ānanda* and possessed of form (*sākāra*). The *nirviśeṣa-vādīs* declare Brahman *nirguṇa* (without qualities), and in particular cases call Bhagavān *saguṇa*, that is, made of the three *guṇas*. In truth, however, the Absolute is not merely *nirguṇa*, merely beyond the three *guṇas*: He is a form 'possessed of qualities' (*saguṇa*), the abode of countless spiritual qualities. The adherents of these doctrines do not accept the supreme cause, Īśvara (Viṣṇu): none of them accepts Viṣṇu, the Lord of all lords and the cause of all causes, though each, refuting the opinions of others, has tried to establish his own. Therefore what the *mahājana* says must be known as 'the truth.'"

(Mahābhārata, Vana-parva, Chapter 313, verse 117)

তর্কোঽপ্রতিষ্ঠঃ শ্রুতয়ো বিভিন্না
নাসাবৃষির্যস্য মতং ন ভিন্নম্ ।
ধর্ম্মস্য তত্ত্বং নিহিতং গুহায়াং
মহাজনো যেন গতঃ স পন্থাঃ ॥ ৫৬ ॥

tarko 'pratiṣṭhaḥ śrutayo vibhinnā
argument is unsettled the śrutis are various
nāsāv ṛṣir yasya mataṁ na bhinnam
there is no such sage whose opinion not differs
dharmasya tattvaṁ nihitaṁ guhāyāṁ
of dharma the truth is hidden in a cave
mahājano yena gataḥ sa panthāḥ
the great soul by which has gone that is the path

56 "Argument is inconclusive, the śrutis differ from one another, and there is no sage whose opinion does not differ from the others. The truth of dharma is hidden in the cave of the heart; the path is the one by which the great souls have gone." (Mahābhārata, Vana-parva, 313.117)[4]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 17.186.

Only the word — the conclusions of Caitanya — is to be followed —

শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-বাণী — অমৃতের ধার ।
তিঁহো যে কহয়ে বস্তু, সেই 'তত্ত্ব' — সার ॥ ৫৭ ॥

śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya-vāṇī — amṛtera dhāra
Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya's words of nectar a stream
tiṁho ye kahaye vastu, sei 'tattva' — sāra
He which speaks of thing that the truth the essence

57 The words of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are a stream of nectar. Whatever He declares is the truth, the very essence."

The brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra goes to tell the Lord the good news —

এ সব বৃত্তান্ত শুনি' মহারাষ্ট্রীয় ব্রাহ্মণ ।
প্রভুরে কহিতে সুখে করিলা গমন ॥ ৫৮ ॥

e saba vṛttānta śuni' mahārāṣṭrīya brāhmaṇa
these all events hearing the Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa
prabhure kahite sukhe karilā gamana
to the Lord to tell happily made going

58 Hearing all this, the brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra happily went to tell the Lord.

Following His daily practice in Kāśī, the Lord bathes at Pañcanada and goes for darśana of Śrī Bindu-mādhava —

হেনকালে মহাপ্রভু পঞ্চনদে স্নান করি' ।
দেখিতে চলিয়াছেন 'বিন্দুমাধব হরি' ॥ ৫৯ ॥

hena-kāle mahāprabhu pañca-nade snāna kari'
at that time Mahāprabhu at Pañcanada bath having taken
dekhite caliyāchena 'bindu-mādhava hari'
to see was going Bindu-mādhava Hari

59 At that time Mahāprabhu, having bathed at Pañcanada, was on His way to see Lord Bindu-mādhava.

The Lord rejoices to hear from the brāhmaṇa of Mahārāṣṭra about Prakāśānanda, now a devotee —

পথে সেই বিপ্র সব বৃত্তান্ত কহিল ।
শুনি' মহাপ্রভু সুখে ঈষৎ হাসিল ॥ ৬০ ॥

pathe sei vipra saba vṛttānta kahila
on the way that brāhmaṇa all the events told
śuni' mahāprabhu sukhe īṣat hāsila
hearing Mahāprabhu happily slightly smiled

60 On the way the brāhmaṇa told Him everything. Hearing it, Mahāprabhu smiled gently with pleasure.

On seeing Śrī Bindu-mādhava the Lord is overwhelmed with feeling and dances —

মাধব-সৌন্দর্য্য দেখি' আবিষ্ট হইলা ।
অঙ্গনেতে আসি' প্রেমে নাচিতে লাগিলা ॥ ৬১ ॥

mādhava-saundarya dekhi' āviṣṭa hailā
Mādhava's beauty seeing overwhelmed He became
aṅganete āsi' preme nācite lāgilā
into the courtyard coming in love to dance He began

61 Seeing the beauty of Mādhava, He was overwhelmed with feeling, and coming into the courtyard, He began to dance in love.

The saṅkīrtana of four devotees —

শেখর, পরমানন্দ, তপন, সনাতন ।
চারিজন মিলি' করে নাম সংকীর্ত্তন ॥ ৬২ ॥

śekhara, paramānanda, tapana, sanātana
Śekhara Paramānanda Tapana Sanātana
cāri-jana mili' kare nāma-saṅkīrtana
four persons together perform saṅkīrtana of the name

62 Candraśekhara, Paramānanda, Tapana and Sanātana — these four together joined in the saṅkīrtana of the holy name:

Nāma-saṅkīrtana —

হরি হরয়ে নমঃ কৃষ্ণ যাদবায় নমঃ ।
গোপাল গোবিন্দ রাম শ্রীমধুসূদন ॥ ৬৩ ॥

hari haraye namaḥ kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ
Hari to Hari obeisance Kṛṣṇa to Yādava obeisance
gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana
Gopāla Govinda Rāma Śrī Madhusūdana

63 "*Hari haraye namaḥ, kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ, gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana*."[5]

On all sides countless people call out the name of Hari —

চৌদিকেতে লক্ষ লোক বলে 'হরি' 'হরি' ।
উঠিল মঙ্গলধ্বনি স্বর্গ-মর্ত্ত্য ভরি' ॥ ৬৪ ॥

caudikete lakṣa loka bale 'hari' 'hari'
on all sides hundreds of thousands of people say 'Hari' 'Hari'
uṭhila maṅgala-dhvani svarga-martya bhari'
arose an auspicious sound heaven earth filling

64 On all sides hundreds of thousands of people called out, "Hari! Hari!" An auspicious sound arose, filling heaven and earth.

Prakāśānanda arrives there with his disciples —

নিকটে হরিধ্বনি শুনি' প্রকাশানন্দ ।
দেখিতে কৌতুকে আইলা লঞা শিষ্যবৃন্দ ॥ ৬৫ ॥

nikaṭe hari-dhvani śuni' prakāśānanda
nearby the sound of 'Hari' hearing Prakāśānanda
dekhite kautuke āilā lañā śiṣya-vṛnda
to see out of curiosity came bringing of disciples the host

65 Hearing the sound of "Hari" nearby, Prakāśānanda came out of curiosity to see, bringing his disciples with him.

Seeing the Lord's dancing, His love and His beauty, he too joins the kīrtana —

দেখিয়া প্রভুর নৃত্য, প্রেম, দেহের মাধুরী ।
শিষ্যগণ-সঙ্গে সেই বলে 'হরি' 'হরি' ॥ ৬৬ ॥

dekhiyā prabhura nṛtya, prema, dehera mādhurī
seeing the Lord's dance love of the body the sweetness
śiṣya-gaṇa-saṅge sei bale 'hari' 'hari'
with his disciples together he says 'Hari' 'Hari'

66 Seeing the Lord's dance, His love and the sweetness of His form, he too, with his disciples, called out, "Hari! Hari!"

Seeing His ecstatic feelings, the people of Kāśī are amazed —

হর্ষ, দৈন্য, চাপল্যাদি 'সঞ্চারী' বিকার ।
দেখি' কাশীবাসী লোকের হৈল চমৎকার ॥ ৬৭ ॥

harṣa, dainya, cāpalyādi 'sañcārī' vikāra
joy humility restlessness and others sañcārī transformations
dekhi' kāśī-vāsī lokera haila camatkāra
seeing of Kāśī the residents of the people there was amazement

67 Seeing in Him the transformations of joy, humility, restlessness and the other transient emotions (*sañcārī*), the people of Kāśī were amazed.

Seeing the crowd and the sannyāsīs, the Lord restrains His ecstatic dancing —

লোকসংঘট্ট দেখি' প্রভুর 'বাহ্য' যবে হৈল ।
সন্ন্যাসীর গণ দেখি' নৃত্য সম্বরিল ॥ ৬৮ ॥

loka-saṅghaṭṭa dekhi' prabhura 'bāhya' yabe haila
of people the crowds seeing the Lord's outer awareness when came
sannyāsīra gaṇa dekhi' nṛtya samvarila
of the sannyāsīs the host seeing the dance He restrained

68 When the Lord returned to outer awareness and saw the crowds of people and the sannyāsīs, He checked His dancing.

The Lord and Prakāśānanda greet each other with respect —

প্রকাশানন্দের প্রভু বন্দিলা চরণ ।
প্রকাশানন্দ আসি' তাঁর ধরিল চরণ ॥ ৬৯ ॥

prakāśānandera prabhu vandilā caraṇa
Prakāśānanda's the Lord honoured feet
prakāśānanda āsi' tāṁra dharila caraṇa
Prakāśānanda coming forward His clasped feet

69 The Lord honoured Prakāśānanda's feet, and Prakāśānanda came forward and clasped the Lord's feet.

The Lord expresses His humility —

প্রভু কহে, — তুমি জগদ্গুরু পূজ্যতম ।
আমি তোমার না হই 'শিষ্যের শিষ্য' সম ॥ ৭০ ॥

prabhu kahe, — tumi jagad-guru pūjyatama
the Lord says you the guru of the world most worshipful
āmi tomāra nā hai 'śiṣyera śiṣya' sama
I your not am of a disciple a disciple equal to

70 The Lord said, "You are the guru of the world, most worthy of worship. I am not equal even to a disciple of your disciple.

শ্রেষ্ঠ হঞা কেনে কর হীনের বন্দন ।
আমার সর্ব্বনাশ হয়, তুমি ব্রহ্ম-সম ॥ ৭১ ॥

śreṣṭha hañā kene kara hīnera vandana
superior being why do you make to an inferior obeisance
āmāra sarva-nāśa haya, tumi brahma-sama
My total ruin it is you to Brahman equal

71 Why should you, who are superior, honour one who is inferior? You are equal to Brahman, and your obeisance is My total ruin.

যদ্যপি তোমার সব ব্রহ্ম-সম ভাস ।
লোকশিক্ষা লাগি' এমত করিতে না আইস ॥ ৭২ ॥

yadyapi tomāra saba brahma-sama bhāsa
although to you everything to Brahman equal appears
loka-śikṣā lāgi' emata karite nā āisa
of people the teaching for the sake thus to do not you should come

72 Although to you everything appears as Brahman, for the sake of teaching the people you should not act in this way."

Prakāśānanda declares that by touching the Lord's feet his offences are removed —

তেঁহো কহে, — তোমার নিন্দা পূর্ব্বে যে করিল ।
তোমার চরণ-স্পর্শে, সব ক্ষয় গেল ॥ ৭৩ ॥

teṁho kahe, — tomāra nindā pūrve ye karila
he says Your blasphemy before which I did
tomāra caraṇa-sparśe, saba kṣaya gela
of Your feet by the touch all destroyed has gone

73 Prakāśānanda replied, "The blasphemy of You that I committed before has all been destroyed by the touch of Your feet."

Even the liberated fall back into bondage as the result of offending Bhagavān — (a statement of the Pariśiṣṭa cited in the Vāsanā-bhāṣya)

জীবন্মুক্তা অপি পুনর্যান্তি সংসারবাসনাম্ ।
যদ্যচিন্ত্যমহাশক্তৌ ভগবত্যপরাধিনঃ ॥ ৭৪ ॥

jīvan-muktā api punar
liberated in this life even again
yānti saṁsāra-vāsanām
go to worldly desires
yady acintya-mahā-śaktau
if towards the possessor of inconceivable great potencies
bhagavaty aparādhinaḥ
towards Bhagavān offenders

74 "Even those liberated in this life fall back into worldly desires if they offend Bhagavān, whose potencies are great and inconceivable." (a saying of the *Pariśiṣṭa*, quoted in the *Vāsanā-bhāṣya*)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

If even those liberated in this life (*jīvan-muktas*) offend Bhagavān, who possesses inconceivable great potency, they fall again into the desires of worldly existence (*saṁsāra-vāsanā*).

Anubhāṣya.

acintya-mahā-śaktau (who possesses transcendental spiritual potency) **bhagavati** (against Adhokṣaja) **yadi aparādhinaḥ bhavanti**, **tadā jīvan-muktāḥ api punaḥ saṁsāra-vāsanāṁ** (the *anartha* rooted in the desire to enjoy) **yānti** (attain).

The touch of Bhagavān's feet removes offences — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 34, verse 9)

স বৈ ভগবতঃ শ্রীমৎপাদস্পর্শহতাশুভঃ ।
ভেজে সর্পবপুর্হিত্বা রূপং বিদ্যাধরার্চ্চিতম্ ॥ ৭৫ ॥

sa vai bhagavataḥ śrīmat-
he indeed of Bhagavān beautiful

pāda-sparśa-hatāśubhaḥ
by the touch of the feet his evil destroyed

bheje sarpa-vapur hitvā
took the serpent's body leaving

rūpaṁ vidyādharārcitam
the form honoured by the Vidyādharas

75 "His sins destroyed by the touch of the Lord's beautiful feet, he gave up his serpent's body and took the form honoured by the Vidyādharas." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.34.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

By the touch of Śrī Kṛṣṇa's feet that serpent was freed from all inauspiciousness; he gave up the serpent's body and regained his former form, honoured by the Vidyādharas.

Anubhāṣya.

Once in Vraja the king of the cowherds, Śrī Nanda, was performing with his kinsmen the rite of pilgrimage to a deity (*deva-yātrā*). He came to the bank of the river Sarasvatī, took a vow, and himself lay down to sleep in the forest. Just then a Gandharva named Sudarśana attacked Nanda: he had laughed at the sages of the Aṅgirasa line, and by their curse he had been born a serpent. At Nanda's piteous cry Kṛṣṇa came, struck the serpent with His foot, and rescued Nanda from its jaws.

How the touch of Kṛṣṇa's feet removed the serpent's inauspiciousness, Śrī Śuka describes to Parīkṣit.

saḥ (the serpent) **vai bhagavataḥ** (of Kṛṣṇa) **śrīmat-pāda-sparśa-hatāśubhaḥ** (he whose inauspiciousness — the curse of the sages of the Aṅgirasa line, whom he had mocked on seeing their ugliness — was destroyed by the touch of the glorious foot) **sarpa-vapuḥ** (that is, his birth as a serpent) **hitvā** (giving up) **vidyādharārcitam** (honoured, worshipped among the Vidyādharas) **rūpam bheje** (attained).

Though He is Svayam Bhagavān, to teach the people the Lord, as the ācārya and guru of the world, humbly regards Himself as a jīva —

প্রভু কহে, — 'বিষ্ণু' 'বিষ্ণু', আমি ক্ষুদ্র জীব হীন ।
জীবে 'বিষ্ণু' মানি — এই অপরাধ-চিহ্ন ॥ ৭৬ ॥

prabhu kahe, — 'viṣṇu' 'viṣṇu', āmi kṣudra jīva hīna
the Lord says 'Viṣṇu' 'Viṣṇu' I a tiny jīva lowly
jīve 'viṣṇu' māni — ei aparādha-cihna
a jīva as Viṣṇu to regard this of offence the mark

76 The Lord said, "Viṣṇu! Viṣṇu! I am a tiny, lowly jīva. To regard a jīva as Viṣṇu is the mark of an offender.

The deeds, or the marks, of the pāṣaṇḍī —

জীবে 'বিষ্ণু' বুদ্ধি করে, — যেই ব্রহ্মা-রুদ্র-সম ।
নারায়ণে মানে, তার 'পাষণ্ডে' গণন ॥ ৭৭ ॥

jīve 'viṣṇu' buddhi kare, — yei brahmā-rudra-sama
in a jīva 'Viṣṇu' the idea makes who to Brahmā and Rudra equal
nārāyaṇe māne tāra 'pāṣaṇḍe' gaṇana
Nārāyaṇa regards of him among the pāṣaṇḍīs reckoning

77 One who thinks a jīva to be Viṣṇu, and one who regards Nārāyaṇa as equal to Brahmā and Rudra, are counted among the *pāṣaṇḍīs*.

The evidence of scripture — (a statement of the Vaiṣṇava-tantra; Padma Purāṇa, Uttara-khaṇḍa, Chapter 23, verse 12)

যস্তু নারায়ণং দেবং ব্রহ্মরুদ্রাদিদৈবতৈঃ ।
সমত্বেনৈব বীক্ষেত স পাষণ্ডী ভবেদ্ধ্রুবম্ ॥ ৭৮ ॥

yas tu nārāyaṇaṁ devaṁ
who but Nārāyaṇa the Lord
brahma-rudrādi-daivataiḥ
with Brahmā, Rudra and other gods
samatvenaiva vīkṣeta
as equal indeed sees
sa pāṣaṇḍī bhaved dhruvam
he a pāṣaṇḍī becomes surely

78 'One who looks upon the Lord Nārāyaṇa as equal to Brahmā, Rudra and the other gods is surely a *pāṣaṇḍī*.'" (Vaiṣṇava-tantra; Padma-purāṇa, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 23.12)[6]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 18.116.

Prakāśānanda's firm faith in the Lord, or his reverence for Him —

প্রকাশানন্দ কহে, — তুমি সাক্ষাৎ ভগবান্ ।
তবু যদি কর তাঁর 'দাস'-অভিমান ॥ ৭৯ ॥

prakāśānanda kahe, — tumi sākṣāt bhagavān
Prakāśānanda says You directly Bhagavān
tabu yadi kara tāṁra 'dāsa' abhimāna
still if You make His servant self-conception

79 Prakāśānanda said, "You are Bhagavān Himself. Even so, if You think of Yourself as His servant,

তবু পূজ্য হও তুমি আমা সবা-হৈতে ।
সর্ব্বনাশ হয় মোর তোমার নিন্দাতে ॥ ৮০ ॥

tabu pūjya hao tumi āmā sabā-haite
still worshipful are You than us all
sarva-nāśa haya mora tomāra nindāte
total ruin is my of You by blasphemy

80 You are still more worthy of worship than all of us. Blaspheming You has brought me total ruin.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 6, Chapter 14, verse 5)

মুক্তানামপি সিদ্ধানাং নারায়ণপরায়ণঃ ।
সুদুর্ল্লভঃ প্রশান্তাত্মা কোটিষ্বপি মহামুনে ॥ ৮১ ॥

muktānām api siddhānāṁ
of the liberated even of the perfected
nārāyaṇa-parāyaṇaḥ
Nārāyaṇa devoted to
sudurlabhaḥ praśāntātmā
very rare of peaceful mind
koṭiṣv api mahā-mune
among millions even O great sage

81 "O great sage, even among millions of the liberated and the perfected, one devoted to Nārāyaṇa, whose mind is at peace, is very rare." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 6.14.5)[7]

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 19.150.

Offending a great soul, that is, a Vaiṣṇava, ruins everything — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 4, verse 46)

আয়ুঃ শ্রিয়ং যশো ধর্ম্মং লোকানাশিষ এব চ ৷
হন্তি শ্রেয়াংসি সর্ব্বাণি পুংসো মহদতিক্রমঃ ॥ ৮২ ॥

āyuḥ śriyaṁ yaśo dharmaṁ
life fortune fame dharma
lokān āśiṣa eva ca
the higher worlds blessings also and
hanti śreyāṁsi sarvāṇi
destroys benefits all
puṁso mahad-atikramaḥ
of a man offence against the great

82 "Offence against great souls destroys a man's life, fortune, fame and dharma, his higher worlds and blessings — all that is good for him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.4.46)[8]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 15.270.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 7, Chapter 5, verse 32)

নৈষাং মতিস্তাবদুরুক্রমাঙ্ঘ্রিং
স্পৃশত্যনর্থাপগমো যদর্থঃ ৷
মহীয়সাং পাদরজোঽভিষেকং
নিষ্কিঞ্চনানাং ন বৃণীত যাবৎ ॥ ৮৩ ॥

naiṣāṁ matis tāvad urukramāṅghriṁ
not their mind so long Urukrama's feet
spṛśaty anarthāpagamo yad-arthaḥ
touches the removal of anarthas whose purpose
mahīyasāṁ pāda-rajo-'bhiṣekaṁ
of the great bathing in the dust of the feet
niṣkiñcanānāṁ na vṛṇīta yāvat
of those who own nothing not accepts as long as

83 "So long as people do not accept a bath in the dust of the feet of the great, who own nothing (*niṣkiñcana*), their minds cannot touch the feet of Urukrama, whose purpose is to remove all *anarthas*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.5.32)[9]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 22.53.

Whoever gives up pride and bows at Kṛṣṇa's feet attains pure devotion —

এবে তোমার পাদাব্জে উপজিবে ভক্তি ।
তথি লাগি' করি তোমার চরণে প্রণতি ॥ ৮৪ ॥

ebe tomāra pādābje upajibe bhakti
now for Your lotus feet will arise devotion
tathi lāgi' kari tomāra caraṇe praṇati
for that sake I make at Your feet obeisance

84 Now devotion to Your lotus feet will arise in me; for that I bow down at Your feet."

All sit down there; Prakāśānanda wishes to hear from the Lord's lips a critique of Śaṅkara's Māyāvāda and the true purport of the Brahma-sūtra —

এত বলি' প্রভুরে লঞা তথায় বসিল ।
প্রভুরে প্রকাশানন্দ পুছিতে লাগিল ॥ ৮৫ ॥

eta bali' prabhure lañā tathāya vasila
so saying the Lord taking there he sat
prabhure prakāśānanda puchite lāgila
the Lord Prakāśānanda to question began

85 With these words Prakāśānanda sat down there with the Lord and began to question Him:

মায়াবাদে করিলা যত দোষের আখ্যান ।
সবে এই জানি' আচার্য্যের কল্পিত ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ৮৬ ॥

māyāvāde karilā yata doṣera ākhyāna
in Māyāvāda You made all of the faults the exposition
sabe ei jāni' ācāryera kalpita vyākhyāna
all this know the Ācārya's imagined interpretation

86 "We all know now that the faults You have shown in Māyāvāda come from the Ācārya's imagined interpretation.

সূত্রের করিলা তুমি মুখ্যার্থ-বিবরণ ।
তাহা শুনি' সবার হৈল চমৎকার মন ॥ ৮৭ ॥

sūtrera karilā tumi mukhyārtha-vivaraṇa
of the sūtras made You the explanation of the primary meaning
tāhā śuni' sabāra haila camatkāra mana
that hearing of all became amazed the mind

87 You have explained the primary meaning of the sūtras, and hearing it, everyone's mind was filled with wonder.

তুমি ত' ঈশ্বর, তোমার আছে সর্ব্বশক্তি ।
সংক্ষেপরূপে কহ তুমি, শুনিতে হয় মতি ॥ ৮৮ ॥

tumi ta' īśvara, tomāra āche sarva-śakti
You indeed Īśvara Your are all potencies
saṅkṣepa-rūpe kaha tumi, śunite haya mati
in brief form tell You to hear there is the wish

88 You are Īśvara, and all potencies are Yours. Please explain it to us briefly; I long to hear it."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"Tell it in brief": I have already heard from You the primary meaning of each sūtra. Now I wish to hear in brief the principal purport (*mukhya-tātparya*) of Vedānta.

The Lord, who follows the path of śruti, in His humility regards Himself as a lowly jīva, a disciple, and honours Vyāsa as guru —

প্রভু কহে, — আমি 'জীব', অতি তুচ্ছ জ্ঞান !
ব্যাসসূত্রের গম্ভীর অর্থ, ব্যাস — ভগবান্ ॥ ৮৯ ॥

prabhu kahe, — āmi 'jīva', ati tuccha jñāna!
the Lord says I a jīva very meagre knowledge
vyāsa-sūtrera gambhīra artha, vyāsa — bhagavān
of the Vyāsa-sūtra deep the meaning Vyāsa is Bhagavān

89 The Lord said, "I am a jīva, and My knowledge is very meagre. The meaning of the *Vyāsa-sūtra* is deep, and Vyāsa is Bhagavān.

For the good of the jīvas, Vyāsadeva, himself the author of the sūtras, became also their commentator; therefore their true purport is easy to grasp —

তাঁর সূত্রের অর্থ কোন জীব নাহি জানে ।
অতএব আপনে সূত্রার্থ কৈরাছে ব্যাখ্যানে ॥ ৯০ ॥

tāṁra sūtrera artha kona jīva nāhi jāne
his of the sūtras the meaning any jīva not knows
ataeva āpane sūtrārtha kairāche vyākhyāne
therefore himself the meaning of the sūtras has made in explanation

90 No jīva knows the meaning of his sūtras; therefore he himself has explained their meaning.

যেই সূত্রকর্ত্তা, সে যদি করয়ে ব্যাখ্যান ।
তবে সূত্রের মূল অর্থ লোকের হয় জ্ঞান ॥ ৯১ ॥

yei sūtra-kartā, se yadi karaye vyākhyāna
who of the sūtras the author he if makes the explanation
tabe sūtrera mūla artha lokera haya jñāna
then of the sūtras the original meaning of people becomes knowledge

91 When the author of the sūtras himself explains them, people come to know their original meaning.

The seed of the tree of the Vedas is the praṇava, the mother (the sprout) is the Gāyatrī, and the fruit is the Catuḥ-ślokī of the Bhāgavatam —

প্রণবের যেই অর্থ, গায়ত্রীতে সেই হয়।
সেই অর্থ চতুঃশ্লোকীতে বিবরিয়া কয় ॥ ৯২ ॥

praṇavera yei artha, gāyatrīte sei haya
of the praṇava which meaning in the Gāyatrī that is
sei artha catuḥ-ślokīte vivariyā kaya
that meaning in the Catuḥ-ślokī unfolding tells

92 The meaning of the *praṇava* (*oṁ*) is contained in the Gāyatrī, and the Catuḥ-ślokī, the four essential verses, unfolds that same meaning.

How in the Brahma-sampradāya the Bhāgavatam is recited through the succession of sacred tradition (āmnāya) —

ব্রহ্মারে ঈশ্বর চতুঃশ্লোকী যে কহিলা।
ব্রহ্মা নারদে সেই উপদেশ কৈলা ॥ ৯৩ ॥

brahmāre īśvara catuḥ-ślokī ye kahilā
to Brahmā Īśvara the Catuḥ-ślokī which spoke
brahmā nārade sei upadeśa kailā
Brahmā to Nārada that instruction gave

93 Brahmā taught Nārada the Catuḥ-ślokī that Īśvara had spoken to him.

নারদ সেই অর্থ ব্যাসেরে কহিলা।
শুনি' বেদব্যাস মনে বিচার করিলা ॥ ৯৪ ॥

nārada sei artha vyāsere kahilā
Nārada that meaning to Vyāsa told
śuni' veda-vyāsa mane vicāra karilā
hearing Veda-vyāsa in his mind reflection made

94 Nārada told that meaning to Vyāsa, and hearing it, Veda-vyāsa reflected within himself:

The resolve to expand the Catuḥ-ślokī, the commentary on the Brahma-sūtra — that is, to compose the Bhāgavatam —

এই অর্থ — আমার সূত্রের ব্যাখ্যানুরূপ ।
'ভাগবত' করিব সূত্রের ভাষ্যস্বরূপ ॥ ৯৫ ॥

ei artha — āmāra sūtrera vyākhyānurūpa
this meaning of my sūtras accords with the explanation
'bhāgavata' kariba sūtrera bhāṣya-svarūpa
the Bhāgavata I shall make of the sūtras the commentary in the form of

95 'This meaning accords with the explanation of my sūtras. I shall make the *Bhāgavata* the commentary on my sūtras.'[10]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The *praṇava* is the *mahā-vākya* (great statement) of all the Vedas. The meaning contained in the *praṇava* is also in the Gāyatrī, and that same meaning is unfolded in the *Śrī Bhāgavatam* in four verses, beginning with the verse *aham evāsam evāgre*. From Bhagavān to Brahmā, from Brahmā to Nārada, from Nārada to Śrī Vyāsa — in this way, through the succession of a true sampradāya, all the Vedas and their purport came into the *Śrī Bhāgavatam*. The *Śrī Bhāgavatam* itself is "the commentary on the *Brahma-sūtra*."

The essence of the Vedas and Upaniṣads is extracted —

চারিবেদ-উপনিষদে যত কিছু হয় ।
তার অর্থ লঞা ব্যাস করিলা সঞ্চয় ॥ ৯৬ ॥

cāri-veda-upaniṣade yata kichu haya
in the four Vedas and the Upaniṣads as much anything there is
tāra artha lañā vyāsa karilā sañcaya
their meaning taking Vyāsa made a collection

96 Whatever there is in the four Vedas and the Upaniṣads, Vyāsa took its meaning and gathered it together.

The very śruti mantras that are the source of the sūtras are set down in the Bhāgavatam in the form of verses —

যেই সূত্রে যেই ঋক্ — বিষয়-বচন ।
ভাগবতে সেই ঋক্ শ্লোকে নিবন্ধন ॥ ৯৭ ॥

yei sūtre yei ṛk — viṣaya-vacana
in which sūtra which ṛk the statement of the subject
bhāgavate sei ṛk śloke nibandhana
in the Bhāgavata that ṛk in a verse is set down

97 Whatever Vedic mantra (*ṛk*) states the subject of a sūtra, that same mantra is set down in a verse of the *Bhāgavata*.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ṛk means a Vedic mantra; *viṣaya-vacana* means the statement of the subject (*uddeśya*). In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* that *ṛk* is set down in the form of a verse.

The same meaning of the Upaniṣadic mantras is expressed in the verses of the Bhāgavatam —

অতএব ব্রহ্মসূত্রের ভাষ্য — শ্রীভাগবত ।
ভাগবত-শ্লোক, উপনিষৎ কহে ‘এক’মত ॥ ৯৮ ॥

ataeva brahma-sūtrera bhāṣya — śrī-bhāgavata
therefore of the Brahma-sūtra the commentary is the Śrī Bhāgavata
bhāgavata-śloka, upaniṣat kahe ‘eka’ mata
the Bhāgavata’s verses the Upaniṣads speak one doctrine

98 Therefore the *Śrī Bhāgavata* is the commentary on the *Brahma-sūtra*. The verses of the *Bhāgavata* and the Upaniṣads teach one and the same

doctrine.

An example. Everything is full of Viṣṇu, and there is nothing apart from Him. Giving up the notion that we are enjoyers, one should accept all objects with yukta-vairāgya, as related to Viṣṇu, that is, as what Viṣṇu enjoys — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 8, Chapter 1, verse 10)

আত্মাবাস্যমিদং বিশ্বং যৎ কিঞ্চিজ্জগত্যাং জগৎ ।
তেন ত্যক্তেন ভুঞ্জীথা মা গৃধঃ কস্যস্বিদ্ধনম্ ॥ ৯৯ ॥

ātmāvāsyam idaṁ viśvaṁ
pervaded by the Lord this universe
yat kiñcij jagatyāṁ jagat
whatever at all in the world moves
tena tyaktena bhuñjīthā
by Him allotted enjoy
mā gṛdhaḥ kasyasvid dhanam
do not covet of anyone the wealth

99 "This universe and whatever moves within it are pervaded by the Lord. Enjoy what He has allotted to you, and do not covet anyone else's wealth." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 8.1.10)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Whatever you see in this world — all of it, that is, this whole universe — is pervaded by the Ātmā. O jīvas, this Ātmā is your controller and protector. Use all the things of the world as things granted by His grace, and do not seize the wealth of others. The purport is this. The mantra of the *Īśopaniṣad*, *īśāvāsyam idaṁ jagat*, is a *śruti-mantra*, that is, a *viṣaya-vacana* on which the *Brahma-sūtra* rests. In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* that *ṛk* (mantra) is set down in the form of a verse as *ātmāvāsyam idam*. In this way all the *ṛks* of all the sūtras are set down in the verses of the *Bhāgavatam*.

Anubhāṣya.

Parīkṣit heard the genealogy of Svāyambhuva Manu and asked about the other Manus and the deeds of the *manvantara* avatāras. Then Śrī Śuka first relates the words of Manu.

jagatyām (in the world) **yat kiñcit jagat** (whatever the conditioned jīvas enjoy — the transformation of *māyā-śakti* that gives pleasure to the senses), **idaṁ viśvaṁ** (all of it) **ātmāvāsyam** (is pervaded by the Ātmā, that is, by Bhagavān — by His being and consciousness; this is seen with transcendental vision, with the eyes of devotion anointed with the salve of *prema*). **tena** (therefore) **tyaktena** (by offering to Bhagavān out of the desire to serve) — or else: **tena** (by Īśvara) **tyaktena** (with whatever little wealth He has left, that is, given — as Bhagavān's remnants) — **bhuñjīthāḥ** (accept, that is, take). **kasyasvit** (of one attached to matter, thinking himself an enjoyer) **dhanam** (worldly objects of enjoyment and the like, for he sees māyā rather than Bhagavān) **mā gṛdhaḥ** (do not covet at all). So too the *śruti* says: *īśāvāsyam idam* — just like this verse.

In the original Bhāgavatam, the Catuḥ-ślokī, sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana are defined —

ভাগবতের সম্বন্ধ, অভিধেয়, প্রয়োজন ।
চতুঃশ্লোকীতে প্রকট তার কৈরাছে লক্ষণ ॥ ১০০ ॥

bhāgavatera sambandha, abhidheya, prayojana
of the Bhāgavata sambandha abhidheya prayojana
catuḥ-ślokīte prakaṭa tāra kairāche lakṣaṇa
in the Catuḥ-ślokī clearly their has given definition

100 The *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana* of the *Bhāgavata* are clearly defined in the Catuḥ-ślokī.

Before Brahmā, Śrī Kṛṣṇa briefly explains the three truths of the Catuḥ-ślokī. To ascertain the form of Bhagavān, the object (viṣaya), is "jñāna," purely spiritual; the manifestation of Bhagavān in the experience of spiritual pastimes, which the one who takes shelter (āśraya) attains, is "vijñāna"; the secret, or prema, is the "prayojana"; and sādhana-bhakti, its limb, is the "abhidheya" —

আমি — 'সম্বন্ধ'-তত্ত্ব, আমার জ্ঞান-বিজ্ঞান ।
আমা পাইতে সাধন-ভক্তি 'অভিধেয়'-নাম ॥ ১০১ ॥

āmi — 'sambandha' tattva, āmāra jñāna-vijñāna
I sambandha the truth of Me knowledge realisation
āmā pāite sādhana-bhakti 'abhidheya' nāma
Me to attain sādhana-bhakti abhidheya is named

101 'I am the truth of *sambandha*, and knowledge and realisation of Me belong to it as well. *Sādhana-bhakti*, the means of attaining Me, is called *abhidheya*.

সাধনের ফল — 'প্রেম' মূল-প্রয়োজন ।
সেই প্রেমে পায় জীব আমার 'সেবন' ॥ ১০২ ॥

sādhanera phala — 'prema' mūla-prayojana
of sādhana the fruit prema the chief goal
sei preme pāya jīva āmāra 'sevana'
by that love attains the jīva My service

102 The fruit of *sādhana* is prema, the chief goal (*prayojana*). By that love the jīva attains service to Me.

Of the six verses, this one, apart from the Catuḥ-ślokī, describes sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana: jñāna and vijñāna are "sambandha," the secret is the "prayojana," and its limb is the "abhidheya" — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 2, Chapter 9, verse 30)

জ্ঞানং পরমগুহ্যং মে যদ্বিজ্ঞান-সমন্বিতম্ ।
স-রহস্যং তদঙ্গঞ্চ গৃহাণ গদিতং ময়া ॥ ১০৩ ॥

jñānaṁ parama-guhyaṁ me
knowledge most confidential of Me
yad vijñāna-samanvitam
which with realisation endowed
sa-rahasyaṁ tad-aṅgaṁ ca
with its secret and its limb also
gṛhāṇa gaditaṁ mayā
receive spoken by Me

103 "Receive from Me, as I speak it, the supremely confidential knowledge of Myself, endowed with realisation, together with its secret and that secret's integral part." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.30)[11]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.51.

By the descending path (avaroha), through the power of Bhagavān's mercy, the Truth is revealed in the heart —

এই 'তিন' তত্ত্ব আমি কহিনু তোমারে ।
'জীব' তুমি এই তিন নারিবে জানিবারে ॥ ১০৪ ॥

ei 'tina' tattva āmi kahinu tomāre
these three truths I have told to you
'jīva' tumi ei tina nāribe jānibāre
a jīva you these three will not be able to know

104 I have told you these three truths. You are a jīva; you could not know these three by yourself.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"You are a *jīva*": O Brahmā, you are a "*jīva*"; without My mercy you will not be able to know the supreme secret.

Anubhāṣya.
"These three" are *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*.

Bhagavān, full of name, form, qualities and pastimes, is not merely "featureless" —

যৈছে আমার 'স্বরূপ', যৈছে আমার 'স্থিতি' ।
যৈছে আমার গুণ, কর্ম্ম, ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্য-শক্তি ॥ ১০৫ ॥

yaiche āmāra 'svarūpa', yaiche āmāra 'sthiti'
as is My form as is My abode
yaiche āmāra guṇa, karma, ṣaḍ-aiśvarya-śakti
as are My qualities deeds six opulences potency

105 As My form is, as My abode is, and as My qualities, deeds, six opulences and potencies are,

আমার কৃপায় এইসব স্ফুরুক তোমারে ।
এত বলি' তিন তত্ত্ব কহিলা তাঁহারে ॥ ১০৬ ॥

āmāra kṛpāya ei saba sphuruka tomāre
by My mercy this all may it be revealed to you
eta bali' tina tattva kahilā tāṁhāre
so saying three truths He told to him

106 may all this be revealed to you by My mercy.' Saying this, He told him the three truths.

Of the six verses, in this one, apart from the Catuḥ-ślokī, a blessing in the form of mercy is showered — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 2, Chapter 9, verse 31)

যাবানহং যথা-ভাবো যদ্রূপগুণকর্ম্মকঃ ।
তথৈব তত্ত্ববিজ্ঞানমস্তু তে মদনুগ্রহাৎ ॥ ১০৭ ॥

yāvān ahaṁ yathā-bhāvo
as great as I am, in what being
yad-rūpa-guṇa-karmakaḥ
with what forms qualities and deeds
tathaiva tattva-vijñānam
just so the true realisation
astu te mad-anugrahāt
may be yours by My grace

107 "By My grace may you truly realise Me as I am — My being, My forms, My qualities and My deeds." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.31)[12]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.52.

The beginning of the explanation of the Catuḥ-ślokī. In the first verse, the sambandha-tattva: the mark of "jñāna" of Kṛṣṇa, the possessor of the

svarūpa-śakti, denoted by the word aham, whose form is eternal, true and everlasting —

সৃষ্টির পূর্ব্বে ষড়ৈশ্বর্য্যপূর্ণ আমি ত' হইয়ে ।
'প্রপঞ্চ', 'প্রকৃতি', 'পুরুষ' আমাতেই লয়ে ॥ ১০৮ ॥

sṛṣṭira pūrve ṣaḍ-aiśvarya-pūrṇa āmi ta' haiye
of creation before full of the six opulences I indeed am
'prapañca', 'prakṛti', 'puruṣa' āmātei laye
prapañca prakṛti puruṣa in Me alone lie merged

108 Before creation I exist, full of the six opulences, and the manifest world (*prapañca*), *prakṛti* and the *puruṣa* lie merged in Me.

সৃষ্টি করি' তার মধ্যে আমি ত' বসিয়ে ।
প্রপঞ্চ যে দেখ সব, সেহ আমি হইয়ে ॥ ১০৯ ॥

sṛṣṭi kari' tāra madhye āmi ta' vasiye
creation having made within it I indeed dwell
prapañca ye dekha saba, seha āmi haiye
the world which you see all that also I am

109 Having created it, I dwell within it; and all this world that you see is also I, for it is My energy.

প্রলয়ে অবশিষ্ট আমি 'পূর্ণ' হইয়ে ।
প্রাকৃত প্রপঞ্চ পায় আমাতেই লয়ে ॥ ১১০ ॥

pralaye avaśiṣṭa āmi 'pūrṇa' haiye
at dissolution remaining I complete am
prākṛta prapañca pāya āmātei laye
the material world attains in Me dissolution

110 At dissolution I alone remain, complete, and the material world dissolves into Me.

The first verse of the Catuḥ-ślokī — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 2, Chapter 9, verse 32)

অহমেবাসমেবাগ্রে নান্যদ্যৎ সদসৎপরম্ ।
পশ্চাদহং যদেতচ্চ যোঽবশিষ্যেত সোঽস্ম্যহম্ ॥ ১১১ ॥

aham evāsam evāgre
I alone was indeed before (creation)
nānyad yat sad-asat-param
nothing else which effect cause beyond
paścād ahaṁ yad etac ca
afterwards I what this (world) also
yo 'vaśiṣyeta so 'smy aham
what remains that am I

111 "Before creation I alone existed; there was nothing else — neither effect, nor cause, nor That which is beyond them. After creation this whole world is not other than Me, and what remains after its dissolution is also I." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.32)[13]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.53.

The purport of the verse — Kṛṣṇa's form is full of eternity, knowledge and bliss (sac-cid-ānanda-vigraha) —

'অহমেব'-শ্লোকে 'অহম্' — তিনবার ।
পূর্ণৈশ্বর্য্য-বিগ্রহের স্থিতির নির্দ্ধার ॥ ১১২ ॥

'aham eva' śloke 'aham'-tina-bāra
in the 'aham eva' verse 'aham' three times
pūrṇaiśvarya-vigrahera sthitira nirdhāra
of the form full of opulence of the existence the establishing

112 The word *aham*, 'I', appears three times in the verse *aham eva*. It establishes the existence of His form, full of all opulence.

Anubhāṣya.

In the verse *aham eva* the word *aham* occurs three times: in the first line in the words *aham eva*, in the third in the words *paścād aham*, and in the fourth in the words *so 'smy aham*. This establishes the personal form (*vigraha*) of Bhagavān: He is not merely featureless.

The refutation of one who teaches that He is formless —

যে 'বিগ্রহ' নাহি মানে, 'নিরাকার' মানে ।
তারে তিরস্করিবারে করিলা নির্দ্ধারণে ॥ ১১৩ ॥

ye 'vigraha' nāhi māne, 'nirākāra' māne
who the form not accepts formless considers
tāre tiraskaribāre karilā nirddhāraṇe
him to rebuke has made the determination

113 This was set down to rebuke one who does not accept His form and holds Him to be formless.

Anubhāṣya.
The *nirviśeṣa-vādī* does not accept Bhagavān's personal form, possessed of attributes. To fix in the heart that his reasoning is full of error and must be rejected in every respect, the Lord said *aham eva* three times and so established the "*sambandha*."

In the second verse, besides the "internal nature" (antaraṅga-svarūpa), the marks of the potencies of the "marginal jīva" and the "external guṇa-māyā," and a consideration of how they are perceived. To see the nature that lies beyond the jīva and guṇa-māyā, that is, the internal potency, is independent, pure realisation of the svarūpa, or "vijñāna"; to see the jīva or guṇa-māyā is not "seeing the svarūpa" —

এই সব শব্দে হয় — 'জ্ঞান'-'বিজ্ঞান'-বিবেক ।
মায়া-কার্য্য, মায়া হৈতে আমি — ব্যতিরেক ॥ ১১৪ ॥

ei saba śabde haya — 'jñāna' 'vijñāna' viveka
in these all words there is of jñāna of vijñāna the discernment
māyā-kārya, māyā haite āmi — vyatireka
māyā's works from māyā I am distinct

114 In all these words lies the discernment of jñāna and *vijñāna*: I am distinct from the works of māyā and from māyā itself.

The sun, its reflection (ābhāsa) and darkness (tamaḥ) — an example of different perceptions of one and the same thing —

যৈছে সূর্য্যের স্থানে ভাসয়ে 'আভাস' ।
সূর্য্য বিনা স্বতঃ তার না হয় প্রকাশ ॥ ১১৫ ॥

yaiche sūryera sthāne bhāsaye 'ābhāsa'
as of the sun in the place appears the reflection
sūrya vinā svataḥ tāra nā haya prakāśa
the sun without by itself its not is manifestation

115 Just as a reflection (*ābhāsa*) appears in place of the sun, yet has no manifestation of its own without the sun,

The sambandha-tattva is defined through "jñāna" and "vijñāna" —

মায়াতীত হৈলে হয় আমার 'অনুভব' ।
এই 'সম্বন্ধ'-তত্ত্ব কহিলুঁ, শুন আর সব ॥ ১১৬ ॥

māyātīta haile haya āmāra 'anubhava'
beyond māyā when one goes there is of Me realisation
ei 'sambandha'-tattva kahiluṁ, śuna āra saba
this sambandha truth I have told hear the rest all

116 so one realises Me only on going beyond māyā. I have told you the truth of *sambandha*; now hear all the rest.

Anubhāṣya.

Jñāna is the meaning of the scriptures; *vijñāna* is realisation (*anubhava*). Discrimination (*viveka*) that comes from any source other than the guru or the scriptures is often a product of the mind (*manodharma*) or leans towards the featureless. When discrimination dawns from one's own realisation, one perceives the form of Bhagavān. Bhagavān's own form is distinct from māyā and from *māyic* activity. Until *vijñāna* arises, the jīva has no such understanding. The rays are manifest in the sun, yet the rays are distinct from the sun, and without the sun the rays

cannot manifest on their own. In the same way Bhagavān and māyā are two different (heterogeneous) perceptions. Unless the jīva has gone beyond māyā, he does not realise this: with an intellect confined within māyā, the form of Bhagavān cannot be understood.

The second verse of the Catuḥ-ślokī — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 2, Chapter 9, verse 33)

ঋতেঽর্থং যৎ প্রতীয়েত ন প্রতীয়েত চাত্মনি ৷
তদ্বিদ্যাদাত্মনো মায়াং যথাভাসো যথা তমঃ ॥ ১১৭ ॥

ṛte 'rthaṁ yat pratīyeta
without the reality what may appear
na pratīyeta cātmani
not may appear and in Me
tad vidyād ātmano māyāṁ
that one should know My māyā
yathābhāso yathā tamaḥ
as the reflection as the darkness

117 "Whatever appears to exist apart from Me, the Reality, and does not appear in Me, know that to be My māyā, like a reflection and like darkness." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.33)[14]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.54.

In the third verse — a consideration of how, on the path of śruti, the abhidheya, sādhana-bhakti, is necessary regardless of place, time, person and circumstance —

'অভিধেয়' সাধনভক্তির শুনহ বিচার ৷
সর্ব্ব-জন-দেশ-কাল-দশাতে ব্যাপ্তি যার ॥ ১১৮ ॥

'abhidheya' sādhana-bhaktira śunaha vicāra
of abhidheya of sādhana-bhakti hear the consideration
sarva-jana-deśa-kāla-daśāte vyāpti yāra
to all people places times circumstances extends whose

118 Now hear the consideration of *abhidheya*, *sādhana-bhakti*, which extends to all people in every place, time and circumstance.

Anubhāṣya.

The *abhidheya*, "*sādhana-bhakti*," extends to all persons, places, times and circumstances.

The abhidheya, sādhana-bhakti, is beyond the four aims of life (catur-varga) —

'ধর্ম্মাদি' বিষয়ে যৈছে এ 'চারি' বিচার ।
সাধন-ভক্তি — এই চারি বিচারের পার ॥ ১১৯ ॥

'dharmādi' viṣaye yaiche e 'cāri' vicāra
in dharma and the rest in matters as these four considerations
sādhana-bhakti-ei cāri vicārera pāra
sādhana-bhakti these four considerations beyond

119 In matters of dharma and the rest, people weigh the four aims of life; but *sādhana-bhakti* lies beyond all four.[15]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the *dharma-śāstras*, for the sake of learning from the guru, four truths are examined: dharma, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa*. In the same way the scriptures on the Truth (*tattva-śāstras*), to examine it in like manner, give instruction on "*jñāna*," "*vijñāna*," "*tad-aṅga*" (its limb) and "*tad-rahasya*" (its secret). But here it should be noted that the four subjects beginning with dharma follow the ordinary laws of worldly life. With the four subjects of the Truth (*jñāna* and the rest) the matter is different: even *sādhana-bhakti*, the first of them, stands above the four truths beginning with dharma — that is, it is superior to them.

Serving a genuine guru and inquiring from him, one must, along with divine knowledge, hear about the truth of pure devotion —

সর্ব্ব-দেশ-কাল-দশায় জনের কর্ত্তব্য ।
গুরু-পাশে সেই ভক্তি প্রষ্টব্য, শ্রোতব্য ॥ ১২০ ॥

sarva-deśa-kāla-daśāya janera kartavya
in every place time circumstance of people the duty
guru-pāśe sei bhakti praṣṭavya, śrotavya
from the guru that bhakti is to be asked about to be heard

120 In every place, time and circumstance it is the duty of all people to ask the guru about that bhakti and to hear of it from him.

The third verse of the Catuḥ-ślokī — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 2, Chapter 9, verse 35)

এতাবদেব জিজ্ঞাস্যং তত্ত্বজিজ্ঞাসুনাত্মনঃ ৷
অন্বয়ব্যতিরেকাভ্যাং যৎ স্যাৎ সর্ব্বত্র সর্ব্বদা ॥ ১২১ ॥

etāvad eva jijñāsyaṁ
so much indeed to be inquired
tattva-jijñāsunātmanaḥ
by one seeking the truth of the Self
anvaya-vyatirekābhyāṁ
positively and negatively
yat syāt sarvatra sarvadā
which may be everywhere always

121 "This much must be inquired into by one who seeks the truth of the Self: That which exists everywhere and always, both directly and indirectly." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.35)[16]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.56.

The fourth verse describes the "secret," the whole of which the abhidheya is a limb — that is, the prayojana. In the devotee's heart is Bhagavān, conquered by the devotee's love; in Bhagavān's heart is the devotee, conquered by love for Bhagavān: their forms are joined together, locked in embrace. Between the

devotee and Bhagavān there is inconceivable oneness and difference (acintya-bhedābheda) —

আমাতে যে 'প্রীতি', সেই 'প্রেম' — 'প্রয়োজন' ।
কার্য্যদ্বারে কহি তার 'স্বরূপ'-লক্ষণ ॥ ১২২ ॥

āmāte ye 'prīti', sei 'prema' — 'prayojana'
for Me which affection that prema is the prayojana
kārya-dvāre kahi tāra 'svarūpa' lakṣaṇa
through its effects I describe its essential characteristic

122 Love for Me is prema, the goal (*prayojana*). I shall describe its essential nature through its effects.

পঞ্চভূত যৈছে ভূতের ভিতরে-বাহিরে ।
ভক্তগণে স্ফুরি আমি বাহিরে-অন্তরে ॥ ১২৩ ॥

pañca-bhūta yaiche bhūtera bhitare-bāhire
the five elements as of beings within without
bhakta-gaṇe sphuri āmi bāhire-antare
in the devotees am manifest I without within

123 Just as the five elements are within and without all beings, so I manifest Myself to My devotees, both within and without.

Anubhāṣya.
As the five elements are within and without living beings, so I am manifest within and without My devotees. The devotees know themselves to be forms that are instruments (*upakaraṇa-vigrahas*) for serving Bhagavān with love, and they know everything other than the devotees, too, simply as instruments for serving Bhagavān with love.

The fourth verse of the Catuḥ-ślokī — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 2, Chapter 9, verse 34)

যথা মহান্তি ভূতানি ভূতেষূচ্চাবচেষ্বনু ।
প্রবিষ্টান্যপ্রবিষ্টানি তথা তেষু ন তেষ্বহম্ ॥ ১২৪ ॥

yathā mahānti bhūtāni
as the great elements
bhūteṣūccāvaceṣv anu
in beings great and small after
praviṣṭāny apraviṣṭāni
entered not entered
tathā teṣu na teṣv aham
so in them not in them I

124 "As the great elements enter all beings, great and small, and yet remain outside them, so I am within all that is created and yet beyond it." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.9.34)[17]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.55.

Bhagavān is bound by the ropes of His devotee's love —

ভক্ত আমা বান্ধিয়াছে হৃদয়-কমলে ।
যাঁহা নেত্র পড়ে, তাঁহা দেখয়ে আমারে ॥ ১২৫ ॥

bhakta āmā bāndhiyāche hṛdaya-kamale
the devotee Me has bound in the lotus of the heart
yāṁhā netra paḍe, tāṁhā dekhaye āmāre
wherever the eyes fall there he sees Me

125 My devotee has bound Me in the lotus of his heart; wherever his eyes fall, there he sees Me.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 11, Chapter 2, verse 55)

বিসৃজতি হৃদয়ং ন যস্য সাক্ষা-
দ্ধরিরবশাভিহিতোঽপ্যঘৌঘনাশঃ ।
প্রণয়রসনয়া ধৃতাঙ্ঘ্রিপদ্মঃ
স ভবতি ভাগবতপ্রধান উক্তঃ ॥ ১২৬ ॥

visṛjati hṛdayaṁ na yasya sākṣād
leaves the heart not whose Himself
dharir avaśābhihito 'py aghaugha-nāśaḥ
Hari uttered helplessly even the destroyer of hosts of sins
praṇaya-rasanayā dhṛtāṅghri-padmaḥ
by the cord of love whose lotus feet are held fast
sa bhavati bhāgavata-pradhāna uktaḥ
he is of the bhāgavatas the foremost called

126 "Hari Himself, who destroys hosts of sins even when His name is uttered helplessly, never leaves the heart of one who holds His lotus feet fast with the cord of love. Such a devotee is called the foremost of the *bhāgavatas*." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.55)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hari destroys all sins even when His name is uttered unwittingly. He does not leave the heart of one in whose heart His lotus feet are bound with the rope of love (*praṇaya*); such a person is "the foremost of *bhāgavatas*."

Anubhāṣya.
When Nimi, the king of Videha, asked about the marks, conduct and gradations of the three kinds of devotees, or *bhāgavatas*, Havi Ṛṣi, one of the nine Yogendras, said in reply:

avaśābhihitaḥ (uttered unwittingly) **api aghaugha-nāśaḥ** (He who destroys heaps of sins, that is, multitudes of offences) **hariḥ** (indeed) **sākṣāt yasya hṛdayaṁ na visṛjati** (does not leave), **praṇaya-rasanayā** (with the rope of love) **dhṛtāṅghri-padmaḥ** (he by whom the lotus feet are held, bound within), **saḥ bhāgavata-pradhānaḥ uktaḥ bhavati** (is called "the foremost of *bhāgavatas*").

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 11, Chapter 2, verse 45)

সর্ব্বভূতেষু যঃ পশ্যেদ্ভগবদ্ভাবমাত্মনঃ ।
ভূতানি ভগবত্যাত্মন্যেষ ভাগবতোত্তমঃ ॥ ১২৭ ॥

sarva-bhūteṣu yaḥ paśyed
in all beings who sees
bhagavad-bhāvam ātmanaḥ
of the Lord the presence of the Self
bhūtāni bhagavaty ātmany
the beings in the Lord in the Self
eṣa bhāgavatottamaḥ
he the best of devotees

127 "One who sees the Lord, the Soul of all, present in all beings, and sees all beings in the Lord, is the best of devotees (*bhāgavatottama*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.45)[18]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 8.274.

The spiritual shelter (āśraya) everywhere sees spiritual objects related to Kṛṣṇa — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 30, verse 4)

গায়ন্ত্য উচ্চৈরমুমেব সংহতা
বিচিক্যুরুন্মত্তকবদ্বনাদ্বনম্ ।
পপ্রচ্ছুরাকাশবদন্তরং বহি-
র্ভূতেষু সন্তং পুরুষং বনস্পতীন্ ॥ ১২৮ ॥

gāyantya uccair amum eva saṁhatā
singing loudly of Him alone gathered together
vicikyur unmattaka-vad vanād vanam
they searched like madwomen from forest to forest
papracchur ākāśa-vad antaraṁ bahir
they asked like the sky within without
bhūteṣu santaṁ puruṣaṁ vanaspatīn
in beings present about the Person the trees

128 "Singing loudly of Him alone, the gopīs searched together from forest to forest like madwomen. They asked the trees about that Person who, like the sky, is present within and without all beings." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.30.4)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Gathered together, the gopīs sang loudly of Kṛṣṇa's qualities and, as if mad, began to search for Him from forest to forest. They began to ask the trees (*vanaspatis*) about that Supreme Person, Kṛṣṇa, who like the sky is present outside and within all beings.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Kṛṣṇa suddenly vanished from the place of the rāsa together with Śrī Rādhā. The gopīs, their minds absorbed in Kṛṣṇa, full of Kṛṣṇa, began to imitate Kṛṣṇa's various deeds and, tormented by separation, searched for Him everywhere. Śrī Śukadeva sings of this before Parīkṣit.

saṁhatāḥ (gathering together with one another) **uccaiḥ gāyantyaḥ vanād vanam** (from one forest to another) **amum** (Kṛṣṇa) **eva unmattaka-vat vicikyuḥ** (searched); **ākāśa-vat** (like the great element) **bhūteṣu** (in living beings) **bahiḥ antaram** (within) **santam** (present) **puruṣam** (they, to whom, through the bewilderment of love [*prema-vivarta*], Kṛṣṇa appeared everywhere) **vanaspatīn** (seeing them as full of consciousness) **papracchuḥ** (asked).

Here another reading quotes two more verses.[37] (1) *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.5.23: "Before creation Bhagavān alone existed — the Ātmā and Lord of all souls. When His desire [to create] was withdrawn into Himself, He, the Ātmā, remained alone, marked by many attributes." That is, before creation this universe was one with Bhagavān. He is the goal (*artha*) of the jīvas and is marked by the attributes of manifold opulences such as Vaikuṇṭha; at that time the desire to create and the like lay merged in Him, and that Bhagavān abode as the nondual Truth. (2) *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.28: "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra."

Everywhere in the Bhāgavatam the truths of sambandha, abhidheya and prayojana are described —

অতএব ভাগবতে এই 'তিন' কয়।
সম্বন্ধ-অভিধেয়-প্রয়োজন-ময় ॥ ১২৯ ॥

ataeva bhāgavate ei 'tina' kaya
therefore in the Bhāgavata these three it speaks of
sambandha-abhidheya-prayojana-maya
of sambandha abhidheya prayojana consisting

129 Therefore the *Bhāgavata* speaks of these three: it consists of *sambandha*, *abhidheya* and *prayojana*.

An example of a verse that reveals sambandha — (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 1, Chapter 2, verse 11)

বদন্তি তত্তত্ত্ববিদস্তত্ত্বং যজ্‌জ্ঞানমদ্বয়ম্ ।
ব্রহ্মেতি পরমাত্মেতি ভগবানিতি শব্দ্যতে ॥ ১৩০ ॥

vadanti tat tattva-vidas
they call that of truth the knowers
tattvaṁ yaj jñānam advayam
the Truth which knowledge non-dual
brahmeti paramātmeti
Brahman thus Paramātmā thus
bhagavān iti śabdyate
Bhagavān thus is named

130 "The knowers of the Truth call the non-dual knowledge the Truth; it is named Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.2.11)[19]

Everywhere in the Bhāgavatam the abhidheya, "devotion to Kṛṣṇa," is described —

এই ত' 'সম্বন্ধ', শুন 'অভিধেয়' ভক্তি ।
ভাগবতে প্রতি শ্লোকে ব্যাপে যার স্থিতি ॥ ১৩১ ॥

ei ta' 'sambandha', śuna 'abhidheya' bhakti
this indeed is sambandha hear the abhidheya bhakti
bhāgavate prati-śloke vyāpe yāra sthiti
in the Bhāgavata in every verse pervades whose presence

131 This is *sambandha*. Now hear of the *abhidheya*, bhakti, whose presence pervades every verse of the *Bhāgavata*.

Anubhāṣya.
In every verse of the *Bhāgavatam* the *abhidheya*, *sādhana-bhakti*, is spoken of.

An example of a verse that reveals the abhidheya —

ভক্ত্যাহমেকয়া গ্রাহ্যঃ শ্রদ্ধয়াত্মা প্রিয়ঃ সতাম্ ।
ভক্তিঃ পুনাতি মন্নিষ্ঠা শ্বপাকানপি সম্ভবাৎ ॥ ১৩২ ॥

bhaktyāham ekayā grāhyaḥ
by devotion I by exclusive am attained
śraddhayātmā priyaḥ satām
by faith the Self dear of the saintly
bhaktiḥ punāti man-niṣṭhā
devotion purifies fixed on Me
śva-pākān api sambhavāt
dog-eaters even from (the stain of) birth

132 "I, the dear Self of the saintly, am attained by single-minded devotion born of faith. Devotion fixed on Me purifies even dog-eaters from the stain of their birth." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.14.21)[20]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.138.

Here, as one can see, a variant reading quotes two more verses. (1) *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.14.20: "O Uddhava, neither yoga nor sāṅkhya, neither dharma nor study of the Vedas, neither austerity nor renunciation can win Me as intense devotion to Me does" (see Ādi 17.76). (2) *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.2.37: "For one who has turned away from the Lord, fear arises from absorption in what is other than Him; by His māyā come forgetfulness of the Lord and a false idea of oneself. Therefore the wise, seeing the guru as his worshipful deity and his very self, should worship the Lord with exclusive devotion" (see Madhya 20.119).

The marginal characteristics (taṭastha-lakṣaṇa) of the prayojana, love for

Kṛṣṇa —

এবে শুন, প্রেম, যেই — মূল ‘প্রয়োজন’ ।
পুলকাশ্রু-নৃত্য-গীত — যাহার লক্ষণ ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

ebe śuna, prema, yei-mūla ‘prayojana’
now hear prema which the chief prayojana
pulakāśru-nṛtya-gīta-yāhāra lakṣaṇa
thrill tears dancing singing whose signs

133 Now hear of prema, the chief *prayojana*, whose signs are the thrill of rapture, tears, dancing and singing.

An example of a verse that reveals the prayojana, love for Kṛṣṇa —

স্মরন্তঃ স্মারয়ন্তশ্চ মিথোঽঘৌঘহরং হরিম্ ।
ভক্ত্যা সংজাতয়া ভক্ত্যা বিভ্রত্যুৎপুলকাং তনুম্ ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

smarantaḥ smārayantaś ca
remembering reminding and
mitho ’ghaugha-haraṁ harim
one another who takes away hosts of sins Hari
bhaktyā saṁjātayā bhaktyā
by devotion born of devotion
bibhraty utpulakāṁ tanum
they bear thrilling bodies

134 “Remembering Hari, who takes away hosts of sins, and reminding one another of Him, they bear bodies thrilled by the devotion (*prema-bhakti*) born of devotion (*sādhana-bhakti*).” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.3.31)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Remembering Hari, who destroys masses of sin, and reminding one another of Him, they bear bodies whose hair stands on end through prema-bhakti born of *sādhana-bhakti*.

Anubhāṣya.
While describing the *bhāgavata-dharma* to Vasudeva, Śrī Nārada recounts the dialogue between Nimi, the king of Videha, and the nine Yogendras. Nimi asked,

“How can people who lack understanding and take themselves to be the body easily conquer māyā?” In answer, Prabuddha Ṛṣi, one of the nine Yogendras, describes what the conditioned soul attains. Taking shelter at the lotus feet of the guru, he practices without offence the devotion called *kīrtana*; thus he is freed from *anarthas* and then attains the goal of practice, *bhāva-bhakti*.

(Of the *sādhakas* who live in this way,) **bhaktyā** (by *sādhana-bhakti*) **sañjātayā** (attained) **bhaktyā** (by devotion whose mark is *prema*) **aghaugha-haraṁ** (who destroys heaps of sins) **hariṁ smarantaḥ mithaḥ** (to one another) **smārayantaḥ** (chanting together) **ca** (these devotees) **utpulakāṁ** (with hair standing on end) **tanuṁ bibhrati** (bear).

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.2.40)

এবংব্রতঃ স্বপ্রিয়নামকীর্ত্ত্যা-
জাতানুরাগো দ্রুতচিত্ত উচ্চৈঃ ।
হসত্যথো রোদিতি রৌতি গায়-
ত্যুন্মাদবন্নৃত্যতি লোকবাহ্যঃ ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

evaṁ-vrataḥ sva-priya-nāma-kīrtyā
one with such a vow by the chanting of the names of his beloved
jātānurāgo druta-citta uccaiḥ
in whom love has arisen with melted heart loudly
hasaty atho roditi rauti gāyaty
laughs then weeps cries out sings
unmāda-van nṛtyati loka-bāhyaḥ
like a madman dances beyond the world

135 “One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)[21]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 7.94.

Thus the Brahma-sūtra and the Bhāgavatam, the commentary on the Brahma-sūtra, establish one and the same meaning —

অতএব ভাগবত — সূত্রের 'অর্থ' রূপ ।
নিজ-কৃত সূত্রের নিজ-'ভাষ্য'-স্বরূপ ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

ataeva bhāgavata — sūtrera 'artha' rūpa
therefore the Bhāgavata — of the sūtras of the meaning the embodiment
nija-kṛta sūtrera nija-'bhāṣya'-svarūpa
by himself composed of the sūtras his own commentary in nature

136 Therefore the *Bhāgavatam* is the very meaning of the sūtras: by nature it is the author's own commentary on the sūtras he himself composed.

The Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam is (1) the commentary on the Brahma-sūtra, (2) the purport of the Mahābhārata, (3) the commentary on the Gāyatrī and (4) the unfolding of the meaning of the Vedas —

অর্থোঽযং ব্রহ্মসূত্রাণাং ভারতার্থবিনির্ণয়ঃ ।
গায়ত্রীভাষ্যরূপোঽসৌ বেদার্থপরিবৃংহিতঃ
গ্রন্থোঽষ্টাদশসাহস্রঃ শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতাভিধঃ ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

artho 'yaṁ brahma-sūtrāṇāṁ
the meaning this of the Brahma-sūtras
bhāratārtha-vinirṇayaḥ
of the meaning of the Mahābhārata the determination
gāyatrī-bhāṣya-rūpo 'sau
of the Gāyatrī of a commentary in the form it
vedārtha-paribṛṁhitaḥ
by the meaning of the Vedas enriched
grantho 'ṣṭādaśa-sāhasraḥ
a book of eighteen thousand (verses)
śrīmad-bhāgavatābhidhaḥ
Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam named

137 "This book of eighteen thousand verses, named *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, is the meaning of the *Brahma-sūtras*. It settles the sense of the *Mahābhārata*,

it is a commentary on the Gāyatrī, and it is enriched by the import of the Vedas." (Garuḍa Purāṇa)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
This *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is the meaning of the *Brahma-sūtra*, the settled purport of the *Mahābhārata* and a commentary on the Gāyatrī; the meaning of all the Vedas enriches it. The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* contains 18,000 verses.

Anubhāṣya.
ayaṁ bhāgavatābhidhaḥ (called the *Bhāgavatam*) **granthaḥ** — **brahma-sūtrāṇāṁ** (of the Vedānta-*sūtras*, known as the Uttara-mīmāṁsā) **arthaḥ** (the meaning: as their commentary, it is what the sūtras express), **bhāratārtha-vinirṇayaḥ** (that in which the meaning of the *Mahābhārata* is established); **asau** (this great book) — **gāyatrī-bhāṣya-rūpaḥ** (revealing the purport of the Brahma-gāyatrī, the mother of the Vedas), **vedārtha-paribṛṁhitaḥ** (enriched by the meaning of the Vedas), **aṣṭādaśa-sāhasraḥ** (composed of eighteen thousand verses).

Here a variant reading quotes one more verse: "Among the Purāṇas it is the Sāma[-veda]; it was spoken by Bhagavān Himself; it has twelve cantos and a hundred divisions."

"*Establishing the meaning of the smṛtis and itihāsas, beginning with the Mahābhārata*" —

সর্ব্ব বেদেতিহাসানাং সারং সারং সমুদ্ধৃতম্ ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

sarva vedetihāsānāṁ
of all the Vedas and Itihāsas
sāraṁ sāraṁ samuddhṛtam
the essence the essence extracted

138 "… the very essence of essences, drawn from all the Vedas and Itihāsas." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.42)[22]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
[It is] the essence drawn from all the Vedas and *itihāsas* ([Vyāsa] had his son Śrī Śukadeva study the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*).

Anubhāṣya.

sarva-vedetihāsānāṁ (of all the Vedas and *itihāsas*) **samuddhṛtam** (gathered, compiled) **sāraṁ sāraṁ** (the essence, that is, their finest part — [Vyāsa] made his son take up the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*: this is how it connects with the preceding [verse]).

"The meaning of the Brahma-sūtra" —

সর্ব্ববেদান্তসারং হি শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতমিষ্যতে ।
তদ্রসামৃততৃপ্তস্য নান্যত্র স্যাদ্রতিঃ ক্বচিৎ ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

sarva-vedānta-sāraṁ hi
of all Vedānta the essence indeed
śrīmad-bhāgavatam iṣyate
Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam is held to be
tad-rasāmṛta-tṛptasya
by its nectar of rasa of one satisfied
nānyatra syād ratiḥ kvacit
not elsewhere can be attraction ever

139 "*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is held to be the essence of all Vedānta. One who is satisfied with the nectar of its rasa is never attracted to anything else." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 12.13.15)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* may be called the essence of Vedānta. One who is satisfied by the nectar of the *Bhāgavatam*'s rasa finds no taste (*rati*) in any other scripture.

Anubhāṣya.

The *mahā-bhāgavata* Śrī Sūta finished narrating the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* before the sages headed by Śaunaka and stated the number of verses in the eighteen *mahā-purāṇas*. Then, concluding, he again glorifies the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*:

sarva-vedānta-sāraṁ (the finest part of all the Upaniṣads and the *Brahma-sūtra*) **hi śrīmad-bhāgavatam iṣyate** (is called), for **tad-rasāmṛta-tṛptasya** (of one who is satisfied by the nectar that is the rasa of this *Bhāgavatam*) **anyatra** (in scriptures other than the *Bhāgavatam*, or in people other than *bhāgavatas*) **kvacit** (ever) **ratiḥ na syāt** (cannot arise).

"A commentary on the Gāyatrī" —

গায়ত্রীর অর্থে এই গ্রন্থ-আরম্ভন ।
'সত্যং পরং' — সম্বন্ধ, 'ধীমহি' — সাধনে প্রয়োজন ॥ ১৪০ ॥

gāyatrīra arthe ei grantha-ārambhana
of the Gāyatrī with the meaning this book's beginning
'satyaṁ paraṁ' — sambandha, 'dhīmahi' — sādhane prayojana
satyaṁ paraṁ (the Supreme Truth) — sambandha dhīmahi (let us meditate) — in sādhana (abhidheya) prayojana

140 This book begins with the meaning of the Gāyatrī: "*satyaṁ param*" (the Supreme Truth) is the *sambandha*, and "*dhīmahi*" (let us meditate) is both the practice (*sādhana*) and the goal (*prayojana*).

Anubhāṣya.

The meaning of the Gāyatrī is contained already in the first verse of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*. The Supreme Truth is the *sambandha*; the effort of meditation, that is, the practice of *sādhana-bhakti*, is the *abhidheya*; and the fruit obtained — meditation, that is, prema-bhakti — is the *prayojana*, the fruit to which the *abhidheya* leads.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.1.1–2)

জন্মাদ্যস্য যতোঽন্বয়াদিতরতশ্চার্থেষ্বভিজ্ঞঃ স্বরাট্
তেনে ব্রহ্ম হৃদা য আদিকবয়ে মুহ্যন্তি যৎ সূরয়ঃ ।
তেজোবারিমৃদাং যথা বিনিময়ো যত্র ত্রিসর্গোঽমৃষা
ধাম্না স্বেন সদা নিরস্তকুহকং সত্যং পরং ধীমহি ॥ ১৪১ ॥

janmādy asya yato 'nvayād itarataś cārtheṣv abhijñaḥ sva-rāṭ
birth and so on of this from whom directly indirectly and in all purposes fully aware self-luminous

tene brahma hṛdā ya ādi-kavaye muhyanti yat sūrayaḥ
revealed the Veda through the heart who to the first poet are bewildered about whom the wise

tejo-vāri-mṛdāṁ yathā vinimayo yatra tri-sargo 'mṛṣā
of fire water earth as the interchange in whom the threefold creation real

dhāmnā svena sadā nirasta-kuhakaṁ satyaṁ paraṁ dhīmahi
by power His own always free of all deception the truth supreme let us meditate on

141 "Let us meditate on the Supreme Truth, from whom, directly and indirectly, this universe arises, endures and dissolves; who is fully aware of all purposes and shines by Himself (*svarāṭ*); who revealed the Veda through the heart to the first poet, Brahmā; about whom even the wise are bewildered; in whom, as fire, water and earth pass into one another, the threefold creation is real; and who by His own power is ever free of all deception." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.1)[23]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 8.265.

ধর্ম্মঃ প্রোজ্ঝিতকৈতবোঽত্র পরমো নির্ম্মৎসরাণাং সতাং
বেদ্যং বাস্তবমত্র বস্তু শিবদং তাপত্রয়োন্মূলনম্ ।
শ্রীমদ্ভাগবতে মহামুনিকৃতে কিম্বা পরৈরীশ্বরঃ
সদ্যো হৃদ্যবরুধ্যতেঽত্র কৃতিভিঃ শুশ্রূষুভিস্তৎক্ষণাৎ ॥ ১৪২ ॥

dharmaḥ projjhita-kaitavo 'tra paramo nirmatsarāṇāṁ satāṁ
dharma wholly-cast-out deceit here supreme of the non-envious of the saints
vedyaṁ vāstavam atra vastu śiva-daṁ tāpa-trayonmūlanam
to be known real here substance bestowing good the threefold miseries uprooting
śrīmad-bhāgavate mahā-muni-kṛte kimvā parair īśvaraḥ
in the beautiful Bhāgavata by the great sage composed what by others? the Lord
sadyo hṛdy avarudhyate 'tra kṛtibhiḥ śuśrūṣubhis tat-kṣaṇāt
at once in the heart is captured here by the pious who wish to hear that very moment

142 "In this beautiful *Bhāgavatam*, composed by the great sage, is taught the supreme dharma of the saintly who are free from envy, from which all deceit has been cast out. Here is known the true Reality, which bestows good and uproots the threefold miseries. What need is there of other scriptures? As soon as the pious wish to hear it, the Lord is at once captured within their hearts." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.2)[24]

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 1.91.

'কৃষ্ণভক্তিরসস্বরূপ' শ্রীভাগবত।
তাতে বেদশাস্ত্র হৈতে পরম মহত্ত্ব ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

'kṛṣṇa-bhakti-rasa-svarūpa' śrī-bhāgavata
of devotion to Kṛṣṇa of rasa the very form Śrī Bhāgavata
tāte veda-śāstra haite parama mahattva
therefore the Vedic scriptures than supreme greatness

143 The *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is the very form of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa; therefore its greatness surpasses that of the Vedic scriptures.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is the very form of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa. The Vedic scriptures, made of the words of Bhagavān, are like a tree, and the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* is the ripe fruit of that tree. So when they are compared by degree, it stands far above the Vedas.

"Enriched by the meaning of the Vedas" — the ripe fruit of the Vedas —

নিগমকল্পতরোর্গলিতং ফলং
শুকমুখাদমৃতদ্রবসংযুতম্ ।
পিবত ভাগবতং রসমালয়ং
মুহুরহো রসিকা ভুবি ভাবুকাঃ ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

nigama-kalpa-taror galitaṁ phalaṁ
of the Vedas wish-fulfilling of the tree fallen the fruit
śuka-mukhād amṛta-drava-saṁyutam
from Śuka's mouth with nectar juice filled
pibata bhāgavataṁ rasam ālayaṁ
drink the Bhāgavatam rasa up to (the bliss of) liberation
muhur aho rasikā bhuvi bhāvukāḥ
again and again O rasikas on earth bhāvukas

144 "O *rasikas*, O *bhāvukas* on earth! Again and again drink the *Bhāgavatam*, the ripe fruit fallen from the wish-fulfilling tree of the Vedas, filled with nectarean juice from the mouth of Śuka: drink its rasa, which embraces even the bliss of liberation." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.3)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
This scripture, the *Bhāgavatam*, is the fruit fallen from the wish-fulfilling tree of the Vedas, joined with the nectarean juice from Śukadeva's mouth. O *rasikas*, always drink this fruit, which is *rasa* itself! O *bhāvukas*, until you are fully absorbed (*parama-laya*) in the truth of rasa, that is, until you are immersed in it, relish the *Bhāgavatam* in this world (as transcendental *bhāvukas*); and even when immersed, you will go on drinking this supreme rasa again and again, eternally.

Anubhāṣya.
In the third verse of the first chapter of the first canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, [the author] offers a *maṅgalācaraṇa* in the form of a blessing:

aho (O) **rasikāḥ** (knowers of the rasa of service to Bhagavān), **bhāvukāḥ** (adept at contemplating particular *rasas*), **śuka-mukhāt** (from the mouth of Śuka — in the succession of Vyāsa's disciples and their disciples) **bhuvi** (to the earth) **galitam** (descended whole and unbroken; fallen of itself because it is ripe, not plucked by force) **amṛta-drava-saṁyutam** (joined with, marked by, the juice — the rasa that

is nectar, supreme bliss) **nigama-kalpa-taroḥ** (of the wish-fulfilling tree of the Vedas) **rasam** (free of hard, useless parts — rind, stones and the like — consisting of rasa alone) **phalaṁ bhāgavatam ā-layam** (up to and including the bliss of liberation) **muhuḥ pibata** (relish with the greatest reverence).

The Bhāgavatam never cloys as material things do —

বয়ন্তু ন বিতৃপ্যাম উত্তমঃশ্লোকবিক্রমে ।
যচ্ছৃণ্বতাং রসজ্ঞানাং স্বাদু স্বাদু পদে পদে ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

vayaṁ tu na vitṛpyāma
we but not are satiated
uttamaḥśloka-vikrame
by the exploits of Uttamaśloka
yac chṛṇvatāṁ rasa-jñānāṁ
which for those who hear rasa who know
svādu svādu pade pade
sweet sweet at every step

145 "We are never satiated with the exploits of Uttamaśloka, for to those who know rasa and hear of them they grow sweeter and sweeter at every step." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.1.19)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The more we hear of the exploits of Kṛṣṇa, Uttamaśloka, the more our thirst grows; the satisfaction that would quench it never comes. For to listeners who know rasa, the accounts of Kṛṣṇa yield a [new] taste at every step.

Anubhāṣya.

In Naimiṣāraṇya the sages headed by Śaunaka, seating the *mahā-bhāgavata* Śrīla Sūta Gosvāmī before them, ask him to tell of Śrī Hari's pastimes and His avatāras, and describe their ever-growing thirst to hear:

yat (whose exploits) **śṛṇvatāṁ** (of those who hear) **rasa-jñānāṁ** (of the *rasikas*) **pade pade** (at every moment) **svādu svādu** (become sweeter than sweet — this must be supplied), **tasmin uttamaḥśloka-vikrame** (in the exploits of Kṛṣṇa — in the accounts of His qualities, His prowess and so on; His fame (*śloka*) is such that darkness (*tamas*) departs (*ud-gacchati*) from it, and this is what *uttama* means)

vayaṁ tu (let others be satisfied if they will) **na vitṛpyāmaḥ** (are not fully satisfied, that is, we never think, "Enough").

The purport of the Śruti lies in the Bhāgavatam alone —

অতএব ভাগবত করহ বিচার ।
ইহা হৈতে পাবে সূত্র-শ্রুতির অর্থ-সার ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

ataeva bhāgavata karaha vicāra
therefore the Bhāgavata do study
ihā haite pābe sūtra-śrutira artha-sāra
this from you will gain of the sūtras of the śruti of the meaning the essence

146 Therefore study the *Bhāgavatam* carefully: from it you will gain the essential meaning of the sūtras and the śruti.

Anubhāṣya.
If you study the *Bhāgavatam*, you will understand the true meaning, the essence, of the *Brahma-sūtra* and the Upaniṣads. Whoever wants to read Vedānta or grasp the meaning of the Upaniṣads without studying the *Bhāgavatam* will inevitably end up with an empty meaning.

The command to chant constantly; liberation even from nāmābhāsa —

নিরন্তর কর কৃষ্ণনাম-সংকীর্ত্তন ।
হেলায় 'মুক্তি' পাবে, পাবে প্রেমধন ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

nirantara kara kṛṣṇa-nāma-saṁkīrtana
constantly do saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name
helāya 'mukti' pābe, pābe prema-dhana
easily liberation you will attain you will attain the treasure of love

147 Always chant the name of Kṛṣṇa in saṅkīrtana: you will easily attain liberation and gain the treasure of love.

(Bhagavad-gītā 18.54)

ব্রহ্মভূতঃ প্রসন্নাত্মা ন শোচতি ন কাঙ্ক্ষতি ।
সমঃ সর্ব্বেষু ভূতেষু মদ্ভক্তিং লভতে পরাম্ ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

brahma-bhūtaḥ prasannātmā
one who has realised Brahman serene in self
na śocati na kāṅkṣati
not grieves not desires
samaḥ sarveṣu bhūteṣu
equal to all beings
mad-bhaktiṁ labhate parām
for Me devotion attains supreme

148 "One who has realised Brahman and is serene within neither grieves nor desires. Equal to all beings, he attains supreme devotion to Me." (Bhagavad-gītā, 18.54)[25]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 8.65.

(The explanation by the author of the Sarvajña-bhāṣya, quoted by Śrīdhara on Bhāgavatam 10.87.21)

মুক্তা অপি লীলয়া বিগ্রহং কৃত্বা ভগবন্তং ভজন্তে ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

muktā api līlayā vigrahaṁ
the liberated even by līlā a form
kṛtvā bhagavantaṁ bhajante
having assumed Bhagavān worship

149 "Even the liberated, assuming a form (*vigraha*) by the Lord's *līlā*, worship Bhagavān." (words of the author of the Sarvajña-bhāṣya, quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.87.21)[26]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 24.107.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 2.1.9)

পরিনিষ্ঠিতোঽপি নৈর্গুণ্যে উত্তমঃশ্লোকলীলয়া ।
গৃহীতচেতা রাজর্ষে আখ্যানং যদধীতবান্ ॥ ১৫০ ॥

pariniṣṭhito 'pi nairguṇye
firmly established though in transcendence of the guṇas
uttamaḥ-śloka-līlayā
of Uttamaśloka by the pastimes
gṛhīta-cetā rājarṣe
captivated in mind O royal sage
ākhyānaṁ yad adhītavān
the narration which I studied

150 "O royal sage, although I was firmly established in transcendence of the *guṇas*, my mind was captivated by the pastimes of Uttamaśloka, and so I studied this narration." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.1.9)[27]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 24.46.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 3.15.43)

তস্যারবিন্দনয়নস্য পদারবিন্দ-
কিঞ্জল্কমিশ্রতুলসীমকরন্দবায়ুঃ ।
অন্তর্গতঃ স্ববিবরেণ চকার তেষাং
সংক্ষোভমক্ষরজুষামপি চিত্ততন্বোঃ ॥ ১৫১ ॥

tasyāravinda-nayanasya padāravinda-
of Him the lotus-eyed of the lotus feet
kiñjalka-miśra-tulasī-makaranda-vāyuḥ
with the filaments mixed of tulasī of the nectar the breeze
antar-gataḥ sva-vivareṇa cakāra teṣāṁ
having entered within through its own passage caused in them
saṅkṣobham akṣara-juṣām api citta-tanvoḥ
agitation devoted to the imperishable Brahman even of mind and body

151 “The breeze that bore the fragrance of tulasī, mingled with the pollen of the lotus-eyed Lord’s lotus feet, entered their nostrils and stirred both their minds and their bodies, though they were devoted to the imperishable Brahman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.15.43)[28]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 17.142.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.7.10)

আত্মারামাশ্চ মুনয়ো নির্গ্রন্থা অপ্যুরুক্রমে ।
কুর্ব্বন্ত্যহৈতুকীং ভক্তিমিত্থম্ভূতগুণো হরিঃ ॥ ১৫২ ॥

ātmārāmāś ca munayo
delighting in the ātmā and the sages
nirgranthā apy urukrame
free from knots even to Urukrama
kurvanty ahaitukīṁ bhaktim
perform causeless devotion
ittham-bhūta-guṇo hariḥ
of such qualities is Hari

152 ‘Even sages who delight in the ātmā and are free from the knots of the heart render causeless devotion to Urukrama, for such are the qualities of Hari.’” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.7.10)[29]

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 6.186.

The Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa praises the Lord’s ability to give 61 explanations

—

হেনকালে সেই মহারাষ্ট্রীয় ব্রাহ্মণ ।
সভাতে কহিল সেই শ্লোক-বিবরণ ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

hena-kāle sei mahārāṣṭrīya brāhmaṇa
at that time that Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa
sabhāte kahila sei śloka-vivaraṇa
in the assembly told of that verse the explanation

153 Just then the brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra told the assembly how the Lord had explained that verse.

এই শ্লোকের অর্থ প্রভু ‘একষষ্টি’ প্রকার ।
কৈরাছেন, যাহা শুনি’ লোকে চমৎকার ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

ei ślokera artha prabhu ‘ekaṣaṣṭi’ prakāra
of this verse the meaning the Lord sixty-one ways
kairāchena, yāhā śuni’ loke camatkāra
has given which hearing people are amazed

154 “The Lord has explained the meaning of this verse in sixty-one ways; all who hear it are amazed.”

At everyone’s urging the Lord sets forth the 61 explanations —

তবে সব লোক শুনিতে আগ্রহ করিল ।
‘একষষ্টি’ অর্থ প্রভু বিবরি’ কহিল ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

tabe saba loka śunite āgraha karila
then all the people to hear insistence showed
‘ekaṣaṣṭi’ artha prabhu vivari’ kahila
sixty-one meanings the Lord unfolding told

155 Then everyone insisted on hearing them, and the Lord unfolded the sixty-one meanings in detail.

The Lord’s learning amazes everyone, and they recognise Him as the Supreme Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa —

শুনিয়া লোকের বড় চমৎকার হৈল ।
চৈতন্যগোসাঞি — ‘শ্রীকৃষ্ণ’, নির্দ্ধারিল ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

śuniyā lokera baḍa camatkāra haila
hearing of the people great amazement arose
caitanya-gosāñi — 'śrī-kṛṣṇa', nirddhārila
Caitanya Gosāñi — Śrī Kṛṣṇa they concluded

156 Hearing them, the people were struck with wonder and concluded that Caitanya Gosāñi is Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself.

The Lord returns to His residence —

এত কহি' উঠিয়া চলিলা গৌরহরি ।
নমস্কার করে লোক হরিধ্বনি করি' ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

eta kahi' uṭhiyā calilā gaurahari
thus having spoken rising went Gaurahari
namaskāra kare loka hari-dhvani kari'
obeisances offer the people the sound of 'Hari' making

157 Having said this, Gaurahari rose and left, and the people bowed down to Him, calling out the name of Hari.

A flood of kīrtana in Kāśī —

সব কাশীবাসী করে নামসংকীর্ত্তন ।
প্রেমে হাসে, কাঁদে, গায়, করয়ে নর্ত্তন ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

saba kāśī-vāsī kare nāma-saṁkīrtana
all of Kāśī the residents perform saṅkīrtana of the Name
preme hāse, kāṁde, gāya, karaye nartana
in love laugh weep sing perform dance

158 All the residents of Kāśī took up the saṅkīrtana of the Name; in love they laughed, wept, sang and danced.

The Lord delivers Kāśī —

সন্ন্যাসী পণ্ডিত করে ভাগবত বিচার ।
বারাণসীপুর প্রভু করিলা নিস্তার ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

sannyāsī paṇḍita kare bhāgavata vicāra
the sannyāsīs the paṇḍitas do of the Bhāgavata study
vārāṇasī-pura prabhu karilā nistāra
Vārāṇasī the city the Lord made deliverance

159 The sannyāsīs and paṇḍitas began to study the *Bhāgavatam*. Thus the Lord delivered the city of Vārāṇasī.

With the Lord's coming, Kāśī resounds with the tumult of Kṛṣṇa's names —

নিজ-লোক লঞা প্রভু আইলা বাসাঘর ।
বারাণসী হৈল দ্বিতীয় নদীয়া-নগর ॥ ১৬০ ॥

nija-loka lañā prabhu āilā vāsāghara
His own people taking the Lord came to His lodging
vārāṇasī haila dvitīya nadīyā-nagara
Vārāṇasī became a second Nadīyā town

160 Taking His own people with Him, the Lord came back to His lodging. Vārāṇasī had become a second Nadīyā.

At the devotees' urging, the Lord distributes to the people of Kāśī — gripped by Māyāvāda and averse to Kṛṣṇa's name and to prema — without regard to qualification and for the trifling price of faith, His inexhaustible treasury of the name and prema, rare even for Brahmā —

নিজগণ লঞা প্রভু কহে হাস্য করি' ।
কাশীতে আমি আইলাঙ বেচিতে ভাবকালি ॥ ১৬১ ॥

nija-gaṇa lañā prabhu kahe hāsya kari'
His own associates with the Lord says a smile making
kāśīte āmi āilāṅa vecite bhāvakāli
to Kāśī I came to sell the wares of bhāva

161 Surrounded by His own associates, the Lord said with a smile, "I came to Kāśī to sell My wares of ecstatic feeling (*bhāva*).

কাশীতে গ্রাহক নাহি, বস্তু না বিকায় ।
পুনরপি দেশে বহি' লওয়া নাহি যায় ॥ ১৬২ ॥

kāśīte grāhaka nāhi, vastu nā vikāya
in Kāśī a buyer there is not the goods not sell
punarapi deśe vahi' laoyā nāhi yāya
again to My country carrying to take not is possible

162 In Kāśī there were no buyers, and the goods would not sell; yet they could not be carried back home again.

আমি বোঝা বহিমু, তোমা-সবার দুঃখ হইল ।
তোমা-সবার ইচ্ছায় বিনামূল্যে বিলাইল ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

āmi bojhā vahimu, tomā-sabāra duḥkha haila
I the load would carry of you all sorrow arose
tomā-sabāra icchāya vinā-mūlye bilāila
of you all by the wish without price I distributed

163 I would have carried the load back, but you were all grieved; so, by your wish, I have given it away free of charge."

All the devotees speak of the flood of prema in Kāśī and praise the Lord —

সবে কহে, — লোক তারিতে তোমার অবতার ।
'পূর্ব্ব' 'দক্ষিণ' 'পশ্চিম' করিলা নিস্তার ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

sabe kahe, — loka tārite tomāra avatāra
all say — the people to deliver Your descent
'pūrva' 'dakṣiṇa' 'paścima' karilā nistāra
the east the south the west You have made deliverance

164 Everyone said, "You have descended to deliver the people. You have delivered the east, the south and the west.

'এক' বারাণসী ছিল তোমাতে বিমুখ ।
তাহা নিস্তারিয়া কৈলা আমা-সবার সুখ ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

'eka' vārāṇasī chila tomāte vimukha
only one Vārāṇasī was from You turned away
tāhā nistāriyā kailā āmā-sabāra sukha
it having delivered You made of us all happiness

165 Vārāṇasī alone was turned away from You; by delivering it, You have made us all happy."

Countless people gather every day; in the cramped place they cannot see the Lord —

বারাণসী-গ্রামে যদি কোলাহল হইল ।
শুনি' গ্রামী দেশী লোক আসিতে লাগিল ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

vārāṇasī-grāme yadi kolāhala haila
in Vārāṇasī town when an uproar arose
śuni' grāmī deśī loka āsite lāgila
hearing villagers country people to come began

166 When the uproar arose in the town of Vārāṇasī, people from the villages and the countryside heard of it and began to come.

লক্ষ কোটি লোক আইসে, নাহিক গণন ।
সঙ্কীর্ণস্থানে প্রভুর না পায় দরশন ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

lakṣa koṭi loka āise, nāhika gaṇana
lakhs crores of people come there is no counting
saṅkīrṇa-sthāne prabhura nā pāya daraśana
in the cramped place of the Lord not get sight

167 People came in hundreds of thousands, in millions, beyond counting; in that cramped place they could not get a sight of the Lord.

When the Lord goes to see Viśveśvara, countless thirsting people get to see

Him —

প্রভু যবে স্নানে যান বিশ্বেশ্বর-দরশনে ।
দুইদিকে লোক করে প্রভু বিলোকনে ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

prabhu yabe snāne yāna viśveśvara-daraśane
the Lord when to bathe goes to see Viśveśvara
dui dike loka kare prabhu vilokane
on two sides the people make of the Lord beholding

168 Whenever the Lord went to bathe or to see Viśveśvara, people lined both sides of the way to behold Him.

Everyone calls out "Hari bol!" —

বাহু তুলি' প্রভু কহে — বল 'কৃষ্ণ' 'হরি' ।
দণ্ডবৎ করে লোকে হরিধ্বনি করি' ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

bāhu tuli' prabhu kahe — bala 'kṛṣṇa' 'hari'
arms raising the Lord says — say 'Kṛṣṇa' 'Hari'
daṇḍavat kare loke hari-dhvani kari'
prostrated obeisances offer the people the sound of 'Hari' making

169 Raising His arms, the Lord would say, "Say 'Kṛṣṇa!' Say 'Hari!'" and the people fell down before Him, calling out the name of Hari.

After five days in Kāśī the Lord sets out for Purī —

এইমত দিন পঞ্চ লোক নিস্তারিয়া ।
আর দিন চলিলা প্রভু উদ্বিগ্ন হঞা ॥ ১৭০ ॥

ei mata dina pañca loka nistāriyā
in this way days five the people delivering
āra dina calilā prabhu udvigna hañā
the next day departed the Lord uneasy becoming

170 In this way the Lord delivered the people for five days; the next day He set out, His heart uneasy.

Five devotees follow the Lord —

রাতে উঠি' প্রভু যদি করিলা গমন ।
পাছে লাগ্ লইলা তবে ভক্ত পঞ্চজন ॥ ১৭১ ॥

rāte uṭhi' prabhu yadi karilā gamana
at night rising the Lord when made departure
pāche lāg lailā tabe bhakta pañca jana
behind following took then devotees five persons

171 When the Lord rose at night and set off, five devotees followed close behind Him:

The names of the five devotees —

তপন মিশ্র, রঘুনাথ, মহারাষ্ট্রীয় ব্রাহ্মণ ।
চন্দ্রশেখর, কীর্ত্তনীয়া-পরমানন্দ — পঞ্চজন ॥ ১৭২ ॥

tapana miśra, raghunātha, mahārāṣṭrīya brāhmaṇa
Tapana Miśra Raghunātha the Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa
candraśekhara, kīrtanīyā-paramānanda — pañca jana
Candraśekhara Paramānanda the kīrtana singer — five persons

172 Tapana Miśra, Raghunātha, the brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra, Candraśekhara and Paramānanda the kīrtana singer — these were the five.

All want to go with the Lord to Purī, but He bids them farewell —

সবে চাহে প্রভু-সঙ্গে নীলাচল যাইতে ।
সবারে বিদায় দিলা প্রভু যত্ন-সহিতে ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

sabe cāhe prabhu-saṅge nīlācala yāite
all wish with the Lord to Nīlācala to go
sabāre vidāya dilā prabhu yatna-sahite
to all leave gave the Lord with care

173 All of them wished to go to Nīlācala with the Lord, but He took leave of them all with loving care:

[The Lord] wishes to go to Purī alone, by the Jhārikhaṇḍa road —

যাঁর ইচ্ছা, পাছে আইস আমারে দেখিতে ।
এবে আমি একা যাব ঝারিখণ্ড পথে ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

yāṁra icchā, pāche āisa āmāre dekhite
whose wish later come Me to see
ebe āmi ekā yāba jhārikhaṇḍa pathe
now I alone shall go of Jhārikhaṇḍa by the path

174 "Whoever wishes may come later to see Me; now I shall go alone by the path through Jhārikhaṇḍa."

[The Lord] sends Sanātana to Vṛndāvana, to Rūpa and Anupama —

সনাতনে কহিলা, — তুমি যাহ' বৃন্দাবন ।
তোমার দুই ভাই তথা কৈরাছে গমন ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

sanātane kahilā, — tumi yāha' vṛndāvana
to Sanātana He said — you go to Vṛndāvana
tomāra dui bhāi tathā kairāche gamana
your two brothers there have made their way

175 To Sanātana He said, "Go to Vṛndāvana. Your two brothers have already gone there.

In a voice full of compassion, Bhagavān, who loves His devotees, instructs Sanātana to look after the happiness of His devotees who travel to Vṛndāvana
—

কাঁথা-করঙ্গিয়া মোর কাঙ্গাল ভক্তগণ ।
বৃন্দাবনে আইলে তাঁদের করিহ পালন ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

kāṁthā-karaṅgiyā mora kāṅgāla bhakta-gaṇa
with a patched quilt and a water pot My penniless devotees
vṛndāvane āile tāṁdera kariha pālana
to Vṛndāvana when they come them do take care of

176 My penniless devotees, who own only a patched quilt and a water pot — when they come to Vṛndāvana, take care of them."

Embracing everyone, the detached Lord departs; the devotees fall unconscious —

এত বলি' চলিলা প্রভু সবা আলিঙ্গিয়া ।
সবেই পড়িলা তথা মূর্চ্ছিত হঞা ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

eta bali' calilā prabhu sabā āliṅgiyā
thus saying went the Lord all embracing
sabei paḍilā tathā mūrcchita hañā
all fell there unconscious becoming

177 Saying this, the Lord embraced them all and departed, and they all fell to the ground unconscious.

The five devotees return to Kāśī, and Sanātana sets out for Vṛndāvana —

কতক্ষণে উঠি' সবে দুঃখে ঘরে আইলা ।
সনাতন-গোসাঞি বৃন্দাবনেরে চলিলা ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

kata-kṣaṇe uṭhi' sabe duḥkhe ghare āilā
after a while rising all in sorrow home came
sanātana-gosāñi vṛndāvanere calilā
Sanātana Gosāñi for Vṛndāvana set out

178 After a while they got up and returned home in sorrow, and Sanātana Gosāñi set out for Vṛndāvana.

Rūpa Gosvāmī meets Subuddhi Rāya —

এথা রূপ-গোসাঞি যবে মথুরা আইলা ।
ধ্রুবঘাটে তাঁরে সুবুদ্ধিরায় মিলিলা ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

ethā rūpa-gosāñi yabe mathurā āilā
meanwhile Rūpa Gosāñi when to Mathurā came
dhruva-ghāṭe tāṁre subuddhi-rāya mililā
at Dhruva-ghāṭa him Subuddhi Rāya met

179 Meanwhile, when Rūpa Gosāñi came to Mathurā, Subuddhi Rāya met him at Dhruva-ghāṭa.

The earlier history of Subuddhi Rāya and Husain Shāh —

পূর্ব্বে যবে সুবুদ্ধি-রায় ছিলা গৌড়ে 'অধিকারী' ।
হুসেন-খাঁ 'সৈয়দ' করে তাহার চাকরী ॥ ১৮০ ॥

pūrve yabe subuddhi-rāya chilā gauḍe 'adhikārī'
formerly when Subuddhi Rāya was in Gauḍa a governor
husena-khāṁ 'saiyada' kare tāhāra cākarī
Husain Khān the Saiyad did his service

180 Formerly, when Subuddhi Rāya was a governor (*adhikārī*) in Gauḍa, Saiyad Husain Khān was in his service.

দীঘি খোদাইতে তারে 'মুনসীফ' কৈলা ।
ছিদ্র পাঞা রায় তারে চাবুক মারিলা ॥ ১৮১ ॥

dīghi khodāite tāre 'munsīpha' kailā
a large pond to dig him munsif made
chidra pāñā rāya tāre cābuka mārilā
a fault finding Rāya him with a whip struck

181 Rāya put him in charge (*munsīph*) of digging a large pond; finding a fault in his work, Rāya struck him with a whip.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Munsīph: the word *munsīph* comes from the word *insāph* (justice). One who takes charge of some matter on behalf of the principal owner is called a *munsīph*. *Chidra pāñā* — finding a fault.

পাছে যবে হুসেন-খাঁ গৌড়ে 'রাজা' হইল ।
সুবুদ্ধি-রায়েরে তিঁহো বহু বাড়াইল ॥ ১৮২ ॥

pāche yabe husena-khāṁ gauḍe 'rājā' haila
later when Husain Khān in Gauḍa king became
subuddhi-rāyere tiṁho bahu bāḍāila
Subuddhi Rāya he greatly advanced

182 Later, when Husain Khān became king of Gauḍa, he greatly advanced Subuddhi Rāya.

তার স্ত্রী তার অঙ্গে দেখে মারণের চিহ্নে ।
সুবুদ্ধি রায়েরে মারিতে কহে রাজা-স্থানে ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

tāra strī tāra aṅge dekhe māraṇera cihne
his wife on his body sees of the beating the marks
subuddhi rāyere mārite kahe rājā-sthāne
Subuddhi Rāya to kill says to the king

183 His wife saw the marks of the whipping on his body and urged the king to have Subuddhi Rāya killed.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"His wife" — Husain Shāh's begum. "The mark of the blow" — the mark of the whip with which Subuddhi Rāya had struck him.

রাজা কহে, — আমার পোষ্টা রায় হয় 'পিতা' ।
তাহারে মারিব আমি, — ভাল নহে কথা ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

rājā kahe, — āmāra poṣṭā rāya haya 'pitā'
the king says — my patron Rāya is a father
tāhāre māriba āmi, — bhāla nahe kathā
him shall kill I — good is not the word

184 The king said, "Rāya has been my patron; he is a father to me. That I should kill him — such talk is not right."

স্ত্রী কহে, — ‘জাতি’ লহ’, যদি প্রাণে না মারিবে ।
রাজা কহে, — জাতি নিলে ইঁহো নাহি জীবে ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

strī kahe, — ‘jāti’ laha’, yadi prāṇe nā māribe
the wife says — his caste take if of life not you will deprive
rājā kahe, — jāti nile iṁho nāhi jībe
the king says — caste if taken he not will live

185 His wife said, “If you will not take his life, then take his caste.” The king said, “If his caste is taken, he will not survive.”

স্ত্রী মরিতে চাহে, রাজা সঙ্কটে পড়িল ।
করোঁয়ার পানি তার মুখে দেওয়াইল ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

strī marite cāhe, rājā saṅkaṭe paḍila
the wife to die wishes the king into a dilemma fell
karoṁyāra pāni tāra mukhe deoyāila
from a karoyā water his into the mouth had put

186 His wife threatened to die, and the king was caught in a dilemma. At last he had water from a Muslim’s water pot (*karoyā*) put into Subuddhi Rāya’s mouth.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Karoyāra pāni: a *karoyā* is the vessel in which Muslims keep water. From such a *karoyā*, water touched by Muslims was put into Subuddhi Rāya’s mouth.

Subuddhi Rāya comes alone to Kāśī —

তবে সুবুদ্ধি-রায় সেই ‘ছদ্ম’ পাঞা ।
বারাণসী আইলা, সব বিষয় ছাড়িয়া ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

tabe subuddhi-rāya sei ‘chadma’ pāñā
then Subuddhi Rāya that pretext obtaining
vārāṇasī āilā, saba viṣaya chāḍiyā
to Vārāṇasī came all worldly affairs giving up

187 Taking this as his pretext (*chadma*), Subuddhi Rāya gave up all his worldly affairs and came to Vārāṇasī.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Chadma — a pretext. Subuddhi Rāya had already wished to give up worldly affairs; on the pretext of the loss of caste he left his family.

He asks the smārta paṇḍitas what atonement to perform, and different people prescribe different things —

প্রায়শ্চিত্ত পুছিলা তিঁহো পণ্ডিতের গণে ।
তাঁরা কহে, — তপ্ত-ঘৃত খাঞা ছাড়’ প্রাণে ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

prāyaścitta puchilā tiṁho paṇḍitera gaṇe
atonement asked he of the paṇḍitas the group
tāṁrā kahe, — tapta-ghṛta khāñā chāḍa’ prāṇe
they say — boiling ghee drinking give up your life

188 He asked the paṇḍitas what atonement he should perform. They said, “Drink boiling ghee and give up your life.”

Subuddhi Rāya doubts the atonements prescribed to him —

কেহ কহে, — এই নহে, ‘অল্প’ দোষ হয় ।
শুনিয়া রহিলা রায় করিয়া সংশয় ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

keha kahe, — ei nahe, ‘alpa’ doṣa haya
someone says — this is not (so) slight the fault is
śuniyā rahilā rāya kariyā saṁśaya
hearing remained Rāya having doubt

189 Another said, “Not so: the fault is slight.” Hearing this, Rāya was left in doubt.

When the Lord comes to Kāśī, [Subuddhi Rāya] tells Him everything and asks

what atonement he should perform —

তবে যদি মহাপ্রভু বারাণসী আইলা ।
তাঁরে মিলি' রায় আপন-বৃত্তান্ত কহিলা ॥ ১৯০ ॥

tabe yadi mahāprabhu vārāṇasī āilā
then when Mahāprabhu to Vārāṇasī came
tāṁre mili' rāya āpana-vṛttānta kahilā
Him meeting Rāya his own story told

190 Then, when Mahāprabhu came to Vārāṇasī, Rāya met Him and told Him his story.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Subuddhi Rāya met Mahāprabhu when the Lord came to Vārāṇasī before going to Mathurā.

The Lord gives the best of all prescriptions and instructs Subuddhi Rāya —

প্রভু কহে, — ইঁহা হৈতে যাহ' বৃন্দাবন ।
নিরন্তর কর কৃষ্ণনামসংকীর্ত্তন ॥ ১৯১ ॥

prabhu kahe, — iṁhā haite yāha' vṛndāvana
the Lord says — from here go to Vṛndāvana
nirantara kara kṛṣṇa-nāma-saṁkīrtana
constantly do saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa's name

191 The Lord said, "Go from here to Vṛndāvana and always chant the name of Kṛṣṇa in saṅkīrtana.

The different fruits of nāmābhāsa and of the pure name —

এক 'নামাভাসে' তোমার পাপ-দোষ যাবে ।
আর 'নাম' লইতে কৃষ্ণচরণ পাইবে ॥ ১৯২ ॥

eka 'nāmābhāse' tomāra pāpa-doṣa yābe
by one semblance of the Name (nāmābhāsa) your sins and faults will go
āra 'nāma' laite kṛṣṇa-caraṇa pāibe
and the Name taking Kṛṣṇa's feet you will attain

192 By the mere semblance of the holy name (*nāmābhāsa*) your sin and its taint will go; and by chanting the Name itself you will attain Kṛṣṇa's feet.

আর কৃষ্ণনাম লৈতে কৃষ্ণস্থানে স্থিতি ।
মহাপাতকের হয় এই প্রায়শ্চিত্তি ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

āra kṛṣṇa-nāma laite kṛṣṇa-sthāne sthiti
and Kṛṣṇa's name taking in Kṛṣṇa's abode residence
mahā-pātakera haya ei prāyaścitti
of the greatest sins is this the atonement

193 Chanting Kṛṣṇa's name further, you will dwell in Kṛṣṇa's abode. This is the atonement even for the greatest sins."

By way of Ayodhyā, Rāya goes to Naimiṣāraṇya and stays there some days —

পাঞা আজ্ঞা রায় বৃন্দাবনেরে চলিলা ।
প্রয়াগ, অযোধ্যা দিয়া নৈমিষারণ্যে আইলা ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

pāñā ājñā rāya vṛndāvanere calilā
receiving the order Rāya for Vṛndāvana set out
prayāga, ayodhyā diyā naimiṣāraṇye āilā
Prayāga Ayodhyā by way of to Naimiṣāraṇya came

194 Receiving this order, Rāya set out for Vṛndāvana and, by way of Prayāga and Ayodhyā, came to Naimiṣāraṇya.

Meanwhile the Lord, having visited Vṛndāvana, comes again to Prayāga —

কতক দিবস রায় নৈমিষারণ্যে রহিলা ।
প্রভু বৃন্দাবন হৈতে প্রয়াগ যাইলা ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

kataka divasa rāya naimiṣāraṇye rahilā
some days Rāya in Naimiṣāraṇya stayed
prabhu vṛndāvana haite prayāga yāilā
the Lord Vṛndāvana from to Prayāga went

195 Rāya stayed some days in Naimiṣāraṇya; meanwhile the Lord went from Vṛndāvana to Prayāga.

Missing the Lord in Mathurā, Rāya grieves —

মথুরা আসিয়া রায় প্রভুবার্ত্তা পাইল ।
প্রভুর লাগ্ না পাঞা মনে বড় দুঃখ হৈল ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

mathurā āsiyā rāya prabhu vārtā pāila
to Mathurā coming Rāya of the Lord news received
prabhura lāg nā pāñā mane baḍa duḥkha haila
of the Lord meeting not getting in his mind great sorrow arose

196 Coming to Mathurā, Rāya received news of the Lord; having missed meeting Him, he was deeply grieved.

Rāya's renunciation and humility —

শুষ্ককাষ্ঠ আনি' রায় বেচে মথুরাতে ।
পাঁচ ছয় পয়সা হয় এক এক বোঝাতে ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

śuṣka-kāṣṭha āni' rāya vece mathurāte
dry wood bringing Rāya sells in Mathurā
pāṁca chaya payasā haya eka eka bojhāte
five six paisā there are for one each bundle

197 Rāya would gather dry wood and sell it in Mathurā, earning five or six *paisā* a bundle.

আপনে রহে এক পয়সার চানা চাবাঞা ।
আর পয়সা বাণিয়া-স্থানে রাখেন ধরিয়া ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

āpane rahe eka payasāra cānā cābāñā
himself lives of one paisā chickpeas chewing
āra payasā bāṇiyā-sthāne rākhena dhariyā
the other paisā with a merchant keeps saving

198 He himself lived on one *paisā*'s worth of chickpeas and kept the rest of his money with a merchant.

What the Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavas are used to and love —

দুঃখী বৈষ্ণব দেখি' তাঁরে করান ভোজন ।
গৌড়ীয়া আইলে দধি, ভাত, তৈল-মর্দ্দন ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

duḥkhī vaiṣṇava dekhi' tāṁre karāna bhojana
a poor Vaiṣṇava seeing him makes eat
gauḍīyā āile dadhi, bhāta, taila-mardana
Gauḍīyas when they come yogurt rice oil massage

199 Whenever he saw a poor Vaiṣṇava, he fed him; and when Gauḍīyas came, he gave them yogurt and rice and had them massaged with oil.

Taking Śrī Rūpa with him, [Subuddhi Rāya] shows him the twelve forests of Vṛndāvana —

রূপ-গোসাঞি আসি' তাঁরে বহু প্রীতি কৈলা ।
আপন-সঙ্গে লঞা 'দ্বাদশ বন' দেখাইলা ॥ ২০০ ॥

rūpa-gosāñi āsi' tāṁre bahu prīti kailā
Rūpa Gosāñi having come to him much affection showed
āpana-saṅge lañā 'dvādaśa vana' dekhāilā
with himself taking the twelve forests showed

200 When Rūpa Gosāñi came, Rāya welcomed him with great affection, took him along and showed him the twelve forests.

Searching for Sanātana, Śrī Rūpa goes from Vṛndāvana to Prayāga —

মাসমাত্র রূপ-গোসাঞি রহিলা বৃন্দাবনে ।
শীঘ্র চলি' আইলা সনাতনানুসন্ধানে ॥ ২০১ ॥

māsa-mātra rūpa-gosāñi rahilā vṛndāvane
a month only Rūpa Gosāñi stayed in Vṛndāvana
śīghra cali' āilā sanātanānusandhāne
quickly setting out came in search of Sanātana

201 Rūpa Gosāñi stayed in Vṛndāvana only a month; then he quickly set out in search of Sanātana.

গঙ্গাতীর-পথে প্রভু প্রয়াগেরে আইলা ।
তাহা শুনি' দুইভাই সে পথে চলিলা ॥ ২০২ ॥

gaṅgā-tīra-pathe prabhu prayāgere āilā
by the Gaṅgā bank path the Lord to Prayāga came
tāhā śuni' dui bhāi se pathe calilā
that hearing the two brothers by that path went

202 The Lord had come to Prayāga by the path along the bank of the Gaṅgā; hearing this, the two brothers went by that same path.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Hearing of this": in Mathurā Rūpa Gosvāmī heard that earlier Mahāprabhu had gone to Mathurā by the road along the Gaṅgā; now, eager to see that road, he came the same way with Anupama.

Meanwhile Sanātana comes from Prayāga to Mathurā —

এথা সনাতন গোসাঞি প্রয়াগে আসিয়া ।
মথুরা আইলা সনাতন রাজপথ দিয়া ॥ ২০৩ ॥

ethā sanātana gosāñi prayāge āsiyā
meanwhile Sanātana Gosāñi to Prayāga coming
mathurā āilā sanātana rāja-patha diyā
to Mathurā came Sanātana the royal road by

203 Meanwhile Sanātana Gosāñi, having come to Prayāga, went on to Mathurā by the royal road.

In Mathurā [Sanātana] meets Rāya and hears about Rūpa and Anupama —

মথুরাতে সুবুদ্ধি-রায় তাঁহারে মিলিলা ।
রূপ-অনুপম-কথা সকলি কহিলা ॥ ২০৪ ॥

mathurāte subuddhi-rāya tāṁhāre mililā
in Mathurā Subuddhi Rāya him met
rūpa-anupama-kathā sakali kahilā
of Rūpa and Anupama the news all told

204 In Mathurā Subuddhi Rāya met him and told him all the news of Rūpa and Anupama.

Why the three brothers did not meet —

গঙ্গাপথে দুইভাই রাজপথে সনাতন ।
অতএব তাঁহা সনে না হৈল মিলন ॥ ২০৫ ॥

gaṅgā-pathe dui bhāi rāja-pathe sanātana
by the Gaṅgā path the two brothers by the royal road Sanātana
ataeva tāṁhā sane nā haila milana
therefore with them together not took place meeting

205 The two brothers went by the Gaṅgā path and Sanātana by the royal road; that is why he did not meet them.

Rāya treats Sanātana as was fitting before his renunciation; Sanātana does not welcome it and stays indifferent —

সুবুদ্ধি-রায় বহু স্নেহ করে সনাতনে ।
ব্যবহার-স্নেহ সনাতন নাহি মানে ॥ ২০৬ ॥

subuddhi-rāya bahu sneha kare sanātane
Subuddhi Rāya much affection shows to Sanātana
vyavahāra-sneha sanātana nāhi māne
of worldly relations affection Sanātana not accepts

206 Subuddhi Rāya showed Sanātana great affection, but Sanātana would not accept an affection rooted in worldly relationships (*vyavahāra-sneha*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Vyavahāra-sneha — affection rooted in worldly relationships.

Sanātana Prabhu, the great renunciant, searching for Kṛṣṇa —

মহা-বিরক্ত সনাতন ভ্রমেন বনে বনে ।
প্রতিবৃক্ষে, প্রতিকুঞ্জে রহে রাত্রি-দিনে ॥ ২০৭ ॥

mahā-virakta sanātana bhramena vane vane
greatly renounced Sanātana wanders in forest after forest
prati-vṛkṣe, prati-kuñje rahe rātri-dine
under every tree in every grove stays night and day

207 Supremely renounced, Sanātana wandered from forest to forest, staying night and day now under one tree, now in another grove.

Sanātana performs the work of an ācārya of the sampradāya —

মথুরামাহাত্ম্য-শাস্ত্র সংগ্রহ করিয়া ।
লুপ্ততীর্থ প্রকট কৈলা বনেতে ভ্রমিয়া ॥ ২০৮ ॥

mathurā-māhātmya-śāstra saṅgraha kariyā
on the glory of Mathurā of scriptures collection making
lupta-tīrtha prakaṭa kailā vanete bhramiyā
lost holy places manifest made in the forests wandering

208 He collected the scriptures on the glories of Mathurā and, wandering through the forests, brought the lost holy places to light.

Sanātana stays in Vṛndāvana, while Rūpa and Anupama stay in Kāśī —

এইমত সনাতন বৃন্দাবনেতে রহিলা ।
রূপ-গোসাঞি দুইভাই কাশীতে আইলা ॥ ২০৯ ॥

ei mata sanātana vṛndāvanete rahilā
in this way Sanātana in Vṛndāvana stayed
rūpa-gosāñi dui bhāi kāśīte āilā
Rūpa Gosāñi the two brothers to Kāśī came

209 Thus Sanātana stayed in Vṛndāvana, while the two brothers, Rūpa Gosāñi and Anupama, came to Kāśī.

In Kāśī they meet the three devotees —

মহারাষ্ট্রীয় দ্বিজ, শেখর, মিশ্রতপন ।
তিনজন-সহ রূপ করিলা মিলন ॥ ২১০ ॥

mahārāṣṭrīya dvija, śekhara, miśra-tapana
the Mahārāṣṭrian brāhmaṇa Śekhara Tapana Miśra
tina-jana-saha rūpa karilā milana
with three persons Rūpa made meeting

210 There Rūpa met the three — the brāhmaṇa from Mahārāṣṭra, Candraśekhara and Tapana Miśra.

Śrī Rūpa and his younger brother also lodge in Śekhara's house and take their meals in Tapana Miśra's house —

শেখরের ঘরে বাসা, মিশ্র ঘরে ভিক্ষা ।
মিশ্রমুখে শুনে সনাতনে প্রভুর 'শিক্ষা' ॥ ২১১ ॥

śekharera ghare vāsā, miśra ghare bhikṣā
in Śekhara's house lodging in Miśra's house meals
miśra-mukhe śune sanātane prabhura 'śikṣā'
from Miśra's mouth hears to Sanātana the Lord's teachings

211 He lodged in Candraśekhara's house and took his meals in Miśra's house, and from Miśra he heard the teachings the Lord had given Sanātana.

[Śrī Rūpa] rejoices to hear how the Lord instructed Sanātana in Kāśī and delivered the Māyāvādī sannyāsīs —

কাশীতে প্রভুর চরিত্র শুনি' তিনের মুখে ।
সন্ন্যাসীরে কৃপা শুনি' পাইলা বড় সুখে ॥ ২১২ ॥

kāśīte prabhura caritra śuni' tinera mukhe
in Kāśī the Lord's deeds hearing of the three from the mouths
sannyāsīre kṛpā śuni' pāilā baḍa sukhe
to the sannyāsīs mercy hearing he felt great happiness

212 Hearing from the three about the Lord's deeds in Kāśī, and of His mercy to the sannyāsīs, he was overjoyed.

Śrī Rūpa is happy to see the people's devotion to the Lord and to hear their kīrtana —

মহাপ্রভুর উপর লোকের প্রণতি দেখিয়া ।
সুখী হৈলা লোকমুখে কীর্ত্তন শুনিয়া ॥ ২১৩ ॥

mahāprabhura upara lokera praṇati dekhiyā
towards Mahāprabhu of the people reverence seeing
sukhī hailā loka-mukhe kīrtana śuniyā
happy became from the people's mouths kīrtana hearing

213 Seeing the people's reverence for Mahāprabhu and hearing kīrtana from their lips, he rejoiced.

After ten days in Kāśī, Śrī Rūpa and his brother set out for Gauḍa —

দিন দশ রহি' রূপ গৌড়ে যাত্রা কৈল ।
সনাতন-রূপের এই চরিত্র কহিল ॥ ২১৪ ॥

dina daśa rahi' rūpa gauḍe yātrā kaila
days ten staying Rūpa to Gauḍa journey made
sanātana-rūpera ei caritra kahila
of Sanātana and Rūpa this account I have told

214 After staying ten days, Rūpa set out for Gauḍa. Thus I have told the story of Sanātana and Rūpa.

With His companion Balabhadra, the Lord, striving to find Kṛṣṇa, goes to Purī

by the Jhārikhaṇḍa road as before —

এথা মহাপ্রভু যদি নীলাদ্রি চলিলা ।
নির্জ্জন বনপথে মহা-সুখ পাইলা ॥ ২১৫ ॥

ethā mahāprabhu yadi nīlādri calilā
meanwhile Mahāprabhu when to Nīlādri went
nirjana vana-pathe mahā-sukha pāilā
on the solitary forest path great happiness He felt

215 Meanwhile, as Mahāprabhu went towards Nīlādri, He felt great joy on the solitary forest path.

সুখে চলি' আইসে প্রভু বলভদ্র-সঙ্গে ।
পূর্ব্ববৎ মৃগাদি সঙ্গে কৈলা নানারঙ্গে ॥ ২১৬ ॥

sukhe cali' āise prabhu balabhadra-saṅge
happily walking comes the Lord with Balabhadra
pūrvavat mṛgādi saṅge kailā nānā-raṅge
as before with the deer and others together made various sports

216 Happily the Lord journeyed on with Balabhadra and, as before, sported in many ways with the deer and other creatures.

Arriving at Āṭhāranālā, [the Lord] sends Balabhadra to call the devotees in Purī —

আঠারনালাতে আসি' ভট্টাচার্য্য ব্রাহ্মণে ।
পাঠাঞা বোলাইলা নিজ-ভক্তগণে ॥ ২১৭ ॥

āṭhāranālāte āsi' bhaṭṭācārya brāhmaṇe
to Āṭhāranālā coming the Bhaṭṭācārya brāhmaṇa
pāṭhāñā bolāilā nija-bhakta-gaṇe
sending summoned His own devotees

217 Coming to Āṭhāranālā, He sent the brāhmaṇa Bhaṭṭācārya ahead to call His devotees.

Hearing of the Lord's arrival, the devotees seem to receive the mantra that revives the dead (mṛta-sañjīvanī) —

শুনিয়া ভক্তের গণ যেন পুনরপি জীলা ।
দেহে প্রাণ আইলে, — যেন ইন্দ্রিয় উঠিলা ॥ ২১৮ ॥

śuniyā bhaktera gaṇa yena punarapi jīlā
hearing the devotees as if again came to life
dehe prāṇa āile, — yena indriya uṭhilā
in the body life when it comes — as the senses rise up

218 Hearing the news, the devotees seemed to come back to life — as the senses rise up when life returns to the body.

Coming to Narendra-sarovara, everyone sees the Lord —

আনন্দে বিহ্বল ভক্তগণ ধাঞা আইলা ।
নরেন্দ্রে আসিয়া সবে প্রভুরে মিলিলা ॥ ২১৯ ॥

ānande vihvala bhakta-gaṇa dhāñā āilā
with bliss overwhelmed the devotees running came
narendre āsiyā sabe prabhure mililā
to Narendra coming all the Lord met

219 Overwhelmed with bliss, the devotees came running; at Narendra lake they all met the Lord.

The devotees and the Lord greet one another fittingly, with obeisances, embraces and so on —

পুরী-ভারতীর প্রভু বন্দিলেন চরণ ।
দোঁহে মহাপ্রভুরে কৈলা প্রেম-আলিঙ্গন ॥ ২২০ ॥

purī-bhāratīra prabhu vandilena caraṇa
of Purī and Bhāratī the Lord honoured the feet
doṁhe mahāprabhure kailā prema-āliṅgana
both Mahāprabhu gave loving embraces

220 The Lord bowed at the feet of Purī and Bhāratī, and both of them embraced Mahāprabhu with love.

দামোদর-স্বরূপ, পণ্ডিত গদাধর ।
জগদানন্দ, কাশীশ্বর, গোবিন্দ, বক্রেশ্বর ॥ ২২১ ॥

dāmodara-svarūpa, paṇḍita gadādhara
Svarūpa Dāmodara Paṇḍita Gadādhara
jagadānanda, kāśīśvara, govinda, vakreśvara
Jagadānanda Kāśīśvara Govinda Vakreśvara

221 Svarūpa Dāmodara, Gadādhara Paṇḍita, Jagadānanda, Kāśīśvara, Govinda, Vakreśvara,

কাশী-মিশ্র, প্রদ্যুম্ন মিশ্র, পণ্ডিত-দামোদর ।
হরিদাস-ঠাকুর, আর পণ্ডিত-শঙ্কর ॥ ২২২ ॥

kāśī-miśra, pradyumna miśra, paṇḍita-dāmodara
Kāśī Miśra Pradyumna Miśra Dāmodara Paṇḍita
haridāsa-ṭhākura, āra paṇḍita-śaṅkara
Haridāsa Ṭhākura and Śaṅkara Paṇḍita

222 Kāśī Miśra, Pradyumna Miśra, Dāmodara Paṇḍita, Haridāsa Ṭhākura and Śaṅkara Paṇḍita —

When the devotees and Bhagavān meet, both are overwhelmed by prema —

আর সব ভক্ত প্রভুর চরণে পড়িলা ।
সবা আলিঙ্গিয়া প্রভু প্রেমাবিষ্ট হৈলা ॥ ২২৩ ॥

āra saba bhakta prabhura caraṇe paḍilā
and all devotees of the Lord at the feet fell
sabā āliṅgiyā prabhu premāviṣṭa hailā
all embracing the Lord overwhelmed with love became

223 these and all the other devotees fell at the Lord's feet, and the Lord, embracing them all, was overwhelmed with love.

The Lord takes everyone to see Jagannātha —

আনন্দ-সমুদ্রে ভাসে সব ভক্তগণে ।
সবা লঞা চলে প্রভু জগন্নাথ-দরশনে ॥ ২২৪ ॥

ānanda-samudre bhāse saba bhakta-gaṇe
in the ocean of bliss float all the devotees
sabā lañā cale prabhu jagannātha-daraśane
all taking goes the Lord for darśana of Jagannātha

224 All the devotees floated in an ocean of bliss. Taking them all with Him, the Lord went to see Jagannātha.

The Lord is overwhelmed by prema; dancing and singing —

জগন্নাথ দেখি' প্রভু প্রেমাবিষ্ট হৈলা ।
ভক্ত-সঙ্গে বহুক্ষণ নৃত্য-গীত কৈলা ॥ ২২৫ ॥

jagannātha dekhi' prabhu premāviṣṭa hailā
Jagannātha seeing the Lord overwhelmed with love became
bhakta-saṅge bahu-kṣaṇa nṛtya-gīta kailā
with the devotees for a long time dancing and singing did

225 Seeing Jagannātha, the Lord was overwhelmed with love, and for a long time He danced and sang with the devotees.

[The Lord] receives Jagannātha's garland and prasāda; the paḍichā bows to Him —

জগন্নাথ-সেবক আনি' মালা-প্রসাদ দিলা ।
তুলসী-পড়িছা আসি' চরণ বন্দিলা ॥ ২২৬ ॥

jagannātha-sevaka āni' mālā-prasāda dilā
Jagannātha's servants bringing garland and prasāda gave
tulasī-paḍichā āsi' caraṇa vandilā
Tulasī the paḍichā coming the feet honoured

226 A servant of Jagannātha brought a garland and prasāda and gave them to Him, and Tulasī, the *paḍichā*, came and bowed at His feet.

The news of the Lord's arrival spreads everywhere; Rāya and the Bhaṭṭācārya come from Kaṭaka and see the Lord —

মহাপ্রভু আইলা — গ্রামে কোলাহল হৈল ।
সার্ব্বভৌম, রামানন্দ, বাণীনাথ মিলিল ॥ ২২৭ ॥

mahāprabhu āilā — grāme kolāhala haila
Mahāprabhu has come in the town an uproar arose
sārvabhauma, rāmānanda, vāṇīnātha milila
Sārvabhauma Rāmānanda Vāṇīnātha met (Him)

227 The town was in an uproar: "Mahāprabhu has come!" Sārvabhauma, Rāmānanda and Vāṇīnātha came to meet Him.[30]

The Lord stays in Kāśī Miśra's house; Sārvabhauma invites Him —

সবা সঙ্গে লঞা প্রভু মিশ্র-বাসা আইলা ।
সার্ব্বভৌম-পণ্ডিত গোসাঞিরে নিমন্ত্রণ কৈলা ॥ ২২৮ ॥

sabā saṅge lañā prabhu miśra-vāsā āilā
all with taking the Lord to the residence at Miśra's came
sārvabhauma-paṇḍita gosāñire nimantraṇa kailā
Sārvabhauma and the Paṇḍita the Gosāñi invitation made

228 Taking everyone with Him, the Lord came to His residence at Kāśī Miśra's house, and Sārvabhauma and Gadādhara Paṇḍita invited Him to a meal.

Wishing to honour prasāda with the devotees, [the Lord] has the prasāda brought —

প্রভু কহে, — মহাপ্রসাদ আন এই স্থানে ।
সবা-সঙ্গে ইঁহা আজি করিমু ভোজনে ॥ ২২৯ ॥

prabhu kahe, — mahā-prasāda āna ei sthāne
the Lord says — mahā-prasāda bring to this place
sabā-saṅge iṁhā āji karimu bhojane
with all here today I shall take my meal

229 The Lord said, “Bring the *mahā-prasāda* here: today I shall eat here with everyone.”

Mahāprabhu honours mahā-prasāda with the devotees —

তবে দুঁহে জগন্নাথপ্রসাদ আনিলা ।
সবা-সঙ্গে মহাপ্রভু ভোজন করিলা ॥ ২৩০ ॥

tabe duṁhe jagannātha-prasāda ānilā
then both Jagannātha’s prasāda brought
sabā-saṅge mahāprabhu bhojana karilā
with all Mahāprabhu meal took

230 Then the two of them brought Jagannātha’s prasāda, and Mahāprabhu ate with everyone.

The journey from Vṛndāvana back to Purī has been described —

এই ত’ কহিলুঁ, — প্রভু দেখি’ বৃন্দাবন ।
পুনঃ করিলেন যৈছে নীলাদ্রি-গমন ॥ ২৩১ ॥

ei ta’ kahiluṁ, — prabhu dekhi’ vṛndāvana
thus I have told — the Lord having seen Vṛndāvana
punaḥ karilena yaiche nīlādri-gamana
again made how the journey to Nīlādri

231 Thus I have told how the Lord, after seeing Vṛndāvana, journeyed back to Nīlādri.

In the hearer spiritual consciousness awakens, and he attains Kṛṣṇa —

ইহা যেই শ্রদ্ধা করি’ করয়ে শ্রবণ ।
অচিরাৎ পায় সেই চৈতন্য-চরণ ॥ ২৩২ ॥

ihā yei śraddhā kari’ karaye śravaṇa
this whoever faith having does hearing
acirāt pāya sei caitanya-caraṇa
soon attains he Caitanya’s feet

232 Whoever hears this with faith will soon attain the feet of Śrī Caitanya.[31]

A survey of the Madhya-līlā: for six of the 24 years [the Lord] travels through Bhārata, preaching the name and prema —

মধ্যলীলার করিলুঁ এই দিগ্‌দরশন ।
ছয় বৎসর কৈলা যৈছে গমনাগমন ॥ ২৩৩ ॥

madhya-līlāra karilun̐ ei dig-daraśana
of the Madhya-līlā I have made this brief survey
chaya vatsara kailā yaiche gamanāgamana
six years He made how goings and comings

233 Thus I have given a brief survey of the Madhya-līlā — how for six years the Lord travelled away and came back.

The remaining 18 years [the Lord] rejoices in kīrtana with the devotees in Purī —

শেষ অষ্টাদশ বৎসর নীলাচলে বাস ।
ভক্তগণ-সঙ্গে করে কীর্ত্তন-বিলাস ॥ ২৩৪ ॥

śeṣa aṣṭādaśa vatsara nīlācale vāsa
the last eighteen years in Nīlācala residence
bhakta-gaṇa-saṅge kare kīrtana-vilāsa
with the devotees enjoys the pastimes of kīrtana

234 The last eighteen years He lived in Nīlācala, enjoying the pastimes of kīrtana with His devotees.

Following Vyāsa's practice in the Bhāgavatam, [the author] reviews the Madhya-līlā again by briefly describing its chapters —

মধ্যলীলার ক্রম এবে করি অনুবাদ ।
অনুবাদ কৈলে হয় কথার আস্বাদ ॥ ২৩৫ ॥

madhya-līlāra krama ebe kari anuvāda
of the Madhya-līlā the sequence now I make recapitulation
anuvāda kaile haya kathāra āsvāda
recapitulation when made there is of the narrative the relish

235 Now I shall recapitulate the Madhya-līlā in order, for in recapitulation the narrative is relished anew.

প্রথম পরিচ্ছেদে — শেষলীলার সূত্রগণ ।
তথি-মধ্যে কোন ভাগের বিস্তার বর্ণন ॥ ২৩৬ ॥

prathama paricchede — śeṣa-līlāra sūtra-gaṇa
in the first chapter — of the final pastimes the synopsis
tathi-madhye kona bhāgera vistāra varṇana
within it of some parts detailed description

236 In the First Chapter: a synopsis of the final pastimes, with some parts described in detail.

দ্বিতীয় পরিচ্ছেদে — প্রভুর প্রলাপ-বর্ণন ।
তথি-মধ্যে নানা-ভাবের দিগ্‌দরশন ॥ ২৩৭ ॥

dvitīya paricchede — prabhura pralāpa-varṇana
in the second chapter — the Lord's description of the ecstatic utterances (pralāpa)
tathi-madhye nānā-bhāvera dig-daraśana
within it of various bhāvas a brief survey

237 In the Second Chapter: a description of the Lord's ecstatic utterances (*pralāpa*), with a brief survey of various *bhāvas*.

তৃতীয় পরিচ্ছেদে — প্রভুর কহিলুঁ সন্ন্যাস ।
আচার্য্যের ঘরে যৈছে করিলা বিলাস ॥ ২৩৮ ॥

tṛtīya paricchede — prabhura kahiluṁ sannyāsa
in the third chapter — the Lord's I have told sannyāsa
ācāryera ghare yaiche karilā vilāsa
in the Ācārya's house how He enjoyed pastimes

238 In the Third Chapter I have told of the Lord's sannyāsa and of His pastimes in the house of the Ācārya.

চতুর্থে মাধব-পুরীর চরিত্র-আস্বাদন ।
গোপাল-স্থাপন, ক্ষীর-চুরীর বর্ণন ॥ ২৩৯ ॥

caturthe mādhava-purīra caritra-āsvādana
in the fourth of Mādhava Purī the relishing of the life
gopāla-sthāpana, kṣīra-curīra varṇana
the installation of Gopāla of the theft of the sweet rice the description

239 In the Fourth: the relishing of Mādhava Purī's life, the installation of Gopāla, and the story of the stolen sweet rice (*kṣīra*).

পঞ্চমে — সাক্ষীগোপাল-চরিত্র-বর্ণন ।
নিত্যানন্দ কহে, প্রভু করেন আস্বাদন ॥ ২৪০ ॥

pañcame — sākṣī-gopāla-caritra-varṇana
in the fifth — of Sākṣi-gopāla the story the description
nityānanda kahe, prabhu karena āsvādana
Nityānanda tells the Lord does relishing

240 In the Fifth: the story of Sākṣi-gopāla, which Nityānanda told and the Lord relished.

ষষ্ঠে — সার্ব্বভৌমের করিলা উদ্ধার ।
সপ্তমে — তীর্থযাত্রা, বাসুদেব-নিস্তার ॥ ২৪১ ॥

ṣaṣṭhe — sārvabhaumera karilā uddhāra
in the sixth — Sārvabhauma He made the deliverance
saptame — tīrtha-yātrā, vāsudeva-nistāra
in the seventh — the pilgrimage the deliverance of Vāsudeva

241 In the Sixth: how the Lord delivered Sārvabhauma. In the Seventh: His pilgrimage and the deliverance of Vāsudeva.

অষ্টমে — রামানন্দ-সংবাদ বিস্তার ।
আপনে শুনিলা 'সর্ব্বসিদ্ধান্তের সার' ॥ ২৪২ ॥

aṣṭame — rāmānanda-saṁvāda vistāra
in the eighth — the conversation with Rāmānanda in detail
āpane śunilā 'sarva-siddhāntera sāra'
Himself heard of all conclusions the essence

242 In the Eighth: the conversation with Rāmānanda in detail, in which the Lord Himself heard "the essence of all conclusions."

নবমে — কহিলুঁ দক্ষিণ-তীর্থ-ভ্রমণ ।
দশমে — কহিলুঁ সর্ব্ববৈষ্ণব-মিলন ॥ ২৪৩ ॥

navame — kahiluṁ dakṣiṇa-tīrtha-bhramaṇa
in the ninth — I told the tour of the southern holy places
daśame — kahiluṁ sarva-vaiṣṇava-milana
in the tenth — I told the meeting with all the Vaiṣṇavas

243 In the Ninth I told of His tour of the holy places of the South; in the Tenth, of His meeting with all the Vaiṣṇavas.

একাদশে — শ্রীমন্দিরে 'বেড়া-সংকীর্ত্তন' ।
দ্বাদশে — গুণ্ডিচা-মন্দির-মার্জ্জন-ক্ষালন ॥ ২৪৪ ॥

ekādaśe — śrī-mandire 'beḍā-saṁkīrtana'
in the eleventh — at the Śrī Mandira the beḍā-saṅkīrtana (around the temple)
dvādaśe — guṇḍicā-mandira-mārjana-kṣālana
in the twelfth — of the Guṇḍicā temple the cleaning the washing

244 In the Eleventh: the *beḍā-saṅkīrtana* around the Śrī Mandira; in the Twelfth: the cleaning and washing of the Guṇḍicā temple.

ত্রয়োদশে — রথ-আগে প্রভুর নর্ত্তন ।
চতুর্দ্দশে — ‘হেরাপঞ্চমী’-যাত্রা-দরশন ॥ ২৪৫ ॥

trayodaśe — ratha-āge prabhura nartana
in the thirteenth — before the chariot the Lord’s dancing
caturdaśe — ‘herā-pañcamī’-yātrā-daraśana
in the fourteenth — of the Herā-pañcamī festival the witnessing

245 In the Thirteenth: the Lord’s dancing before the chariot; in the Fourteenth: His witnessing of the Herā-pañcamī festival.

তার মধ্যে ব্রজদেবীর ভাবের শ্রবণ ।
স্বরূপ কহিলা, প্রভু কৈলা আস্বাদন ॥ ২৪৬ ॥

tāra madhye vraja-devīra bhāvera śravaṇa
within it of Vraja of the goddesses of the bhāvas the hearing
svarūpa kahilā, prabhu kailā āsvādana
Svarūpa told the Lord did relishing

246 Within it is the hearing of the *bhāvas* of the divine maidens of Vraja: Svarūpa described them, and the Lord relished them.

পঞ্চদশে — ভক্তের গুণ আপনে কহিলা ।
সার্ব্বভৌম-ঘরে ভিক্ষা, অমোঘ তারিলা ॥ ২৪৭ ॥

pañcadaśe — bhaktera guṇa āpane kahilā
in the fifteenth — of the devotees the virtues Himself told
sārvabhauma-ghare bhikṣā, amogha tārilā
in Sārvabhauma’s house a meal Amogha He delivered

247 In the Fifteenth: the Lord Himself spoke of His devotees’ virtues, took a meal at Sārvabhauma’s house and delivered Amogha.

ষোড়শে — বৃন্দাবনযাত্রা গৌড়দেশ-পথে ।
পুনঃ নীলাচলে আইলা, নাটশালা হৈতে ॥ ২৪৮ ॥

ṣoḍaśe — vṛndāvana-yātrā gauḍa-deśa-pathe
in the sixteenth — the journey to Vṛndāvana by the road through Gauḍa
punaḥ nīlācale āilā, nāṭaśālā haite
again to Nīlācala came Nāṭaśālā from

248 In the Sixteenth: the journey towards Vṛndāvana by way of Gauḍa, and the return to Nīlācala from Nāṭaśālā.

সপ্তদশে — বনপথে মথুরা-গমন ।
অষ্টাদশে — বৃন্দাবন বিহার-গমন ॥ ২৪৯ ॥

saptadaśe — vanapathe mathurā-gamana
in the seventeenth — by the forest path the journey to Mathurā
aṣṭādaśe — vṛndāvana vihāra-gamana
in the eighteenth — in Vṛndāvana the wandering in pastimes

249 In the Seventeenth: the journey to Mathurā by the forest path; in the Eighteenth: His wanderings in pastimes through Vṛndāvana.

ঊনবিংশে — মথুরা হৈতে প্রয়াগ-গমন ।
তার মধ্যে শ্রীরূপেরে শক্তি-সঞ্চারণ ॥ ২৫০ ॥

ūnaviṁśe — mathurā haite prayāga-gamana
in the nineteenth — Mathurā from the journey to Prayāga
tāra madhye śrī-rūpere śakti-sañcāraṇa
within it to Śrī Rūpa the infusion of śakti

250 In the Nineteenth: the journey from Mathurā to Prayāga, and within it the infusion of *śakti* into Śrī Rūpa.

বিংশতি পরিচ্ছেদে — সনাতনের মিলন ।
তার মধ্যে ভগবানের স্বরূপ-বর্ণন ॥ ২৫১ ॥

viṁśati paricchede — sanātanera milana
in the twentieth chapter — with Sanātana the meeting
tāra madhye bhagavānera svarūpa-varṇana
within it of Bhagavān of the nature the description

251 In the Twentieth Chapter: the meeting with Sanātana, and within it a description of the nature (*svarūpa*) of Bhagavān.

একবিংশে — কৃষ্ণৈশ্বর্য্য-মাধুর্য্য বর্ণন ।
দ্বাবিংশে — দ্বিবিধ সাধনভক্তির বিবরণ ॥ ২৫২ ॥

ekaviṁśe — kṛṣṇaiśvarya-mādhurya varṇana
in the twenty-first — of Kṛṣṇa's majesty and sweetness the description
dvāviṁśe — dvividha sādhana-bhaktira vivaraṇa
in the twenty-second — of the twofold sādhana-bhakti the explanation

252 In the Twenty-first: a description of Kṛṣṇa's majesty and sweetness; in the Twenty-second: an explanation of the two kinds of *sādhana-bhakti*.

ত্রয়োবিংশে — প্রেমভক্তিরসের কথন ।
চতুর্ব্বিংশে — 'আত্মারামাঃ'-শ্লোকার্থ-বর্ণন ॥ ২৫৩ ॥

trayoviṁśe — prema-bhakti-rasera kathana
in the twenty-third — of loving devotion of the rasas the telling
caturviṁśe — 'ātmārāmāḥ'-ślokārtha-varṇana
in the twenty-fourth — 'ātmārāmāḥ' of the verse's meaning the description

253 In the Twenty-third: an account of the *rasas* of prema-bhakti; in the Twenty-fourth: an explanation of the meanings of the *ātmārāma* verse.

পঞ্চবিংশে — কাশীবাসীরে বৈষ্ণবকরণ ।
কাশী হৈতে পুনঃ নীলাচলে আগমন ॥ ২৫৪ ॥

pañcaviṁśe — kāśī-vāsīre vaiṣṇava-karaṇa
in the twenty-fifth — the residents of Kāśī Vaiṣṇavas making
kāśī haite punaḥ nīlācale āgamana
Kāśī from again to Nīlācala the coming

254 In the Twenty-fifth: how the residents of Kāśī were made Vaiṣṇavas, and the return from Kāśī to Nīlācala.

পঞ্চবিংশতি পরিচ্ছেদে এই কৈলুঁ অনুবাদ ।
যাহার শ্রবণে হয় গ্রন্থার্থ-আস্বাদ ॥ ২৫৫ ॥

pañcaviṁśati paricchede ei kailuṁ anuvāda
of the twenty-five chapters this I have made recapitulation
yāhāra śravaṇe haya granthārtha-āsvāda
whose by the hearing there is of the book's meaning the relish

255 Thus I have recapitulated the twenty-five chapters; by hearing this, one relishes the meaning of the book.

The Madhya-līlā has been described in brief —

সংক্ষেপে কহিলুঁ এই মধ্যলীলা-সার ।
কোটিগ্রন্থে বর্ণন না যায় ইহার বিস্তার ॥ ২৫৬ ॥

saṅkṣepe kahiluṁ ei madhya-līlā-sāra
in brief I have told this essence of the Madhya-līlā
koṭi-granthe varṇana nā yāya ihāra vistāra
in millions of books to describe not possible its full extent

256 I have told the essence of the Madhya-līlā in brief; its full extent could not be described even in millions of books.

To deliver the jīvas the Lord travels through all of Bhārata and preaches by His own conduct —

জীব নিস্তারিতে প্রভু ভ্রমিলা দেশে-দেশে ।
আপনে আস্বাদি' ভক্তি করিলা প্রকাশে ॥ ২৫৭ ॥

jīva nistārite prabhu bhramilā deśe-deśe
the jīvas to deliver the Lord wandered from land to land
āpane āsvādi' bhakti karilā prakāśe
Himself relishing bhakti made manifest

257 To deliver the jīvas, the Lord wandered from land to land; relishing bhakti Himself, He revealed it to the world.

What the Lord taught —

কৃষ্ণতত্ত্ব, ভক্তিতত্ত্ব, প্রেমতত্ত্ব আর ।
ভাবতত্ত্ব, রসতত্ত্ব, লীলাতত্ত্ব-সার ॥ ২৫৮ ॥

kṛṣṇa-tattva, bhakti-tattva, prema-tattva āra
the truth of Kṛṣṇa the truth of bhakti the truth of prema and
bhāva-tattva, rasa-tattva, līlā-tattva-sāra
the truth of bhāva the truth of rasa of the truth of līlā the essence

258 The truth of Kṛṣṇa, the truth of bhakti, the truth of prema, the truth of *bhāva*, the truth of rasa, and the essence of the truth of *līlā* —

শ্রীভাগবত-তত্ত্বরস করিলা প্রচারে ।
কৃষ্ণতুল্য ভাগবত, জানাইলা সংসারে ॥ ২৫৯ ॥

śrī-bhāgavata-tattva-rasa karilā pracāre
of the Śrī Bhāgavata the truth the rasa He made preaching
kṛṣṇa-tulya bhāgavata, jānāilā saṁsāre
equal to Kṛṣṇa the Bhāgavata He made known to the world

259 these, and the truth and rasa of the *Śrī Bhāgavatam*, He preached; and He made known to the world that the *Bhāgavatam* is equal to Kṛṣṇa.

Now as listener, now as speaker, [the Lord] preaches pure devotion —

ভক্ত লাগি' বিস্তারিলা আপন-বদনে ।
কাঁহা ভক্ত-মুখে কহাই শুনিলা আপনে ॥ ২৬০ ॥

bhakta lāgi' vistārilā āpana-vadane
the devotees for the sake of He expounded with His own mouth
kāṁhā bhakta-mukhe kahāi śunilā āpane
sometimes through the devotees' mouths making them speak heard Himself

260 For the sake of His devotees He expounded these truths with His own lips; and sometimes He had His devotees speak them and listened Himself.

Incomparably affectionate to His devotees, the One without a second, an ocean of causeless mercy —

শ্রীচৈতন্য-সম আর কৃপালু বদান্য ।
ভক্তবৎসল না দেখি ত্রিজগতে অন্য ॥ ২৬১ ॥

śrī-caitanya-sama āra kṛpālu vadānya
to Śrī Caitanya equal another merciful magnanimous
bhakta-vatsala nā dekhi trijagate anya
affectionate to devotees not I see in the three worlds other

261 In the three worlds I see no one else as merciful, as magnanimous and as affectionate to His devotees as Śrī Caitanya.

Only firm faith in the Reality (vastu), not blind faith, leads to the Supreme Truth, Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa —

শ্রদ্ধা করি' এই লীলা শুন, ভক্তগণ ।
ইহার শ্রবণে পাইবা চৈতন্য-চরণ ॥ ২৬২ ॥

śraddhā kari' ei līlā śuna, bhakta-gaṇa
faith having this līlā hear O devotees
ihāra śravaṇe pāibā caitanya-caraṇa
of this by the hearing you will attain Caitanya's feet

262 O devotees, hear these pastimes with faith: by hearing them you will attain the feet of Caitanya.

ইহার প্রসাদে পাইবা কৃষ্ণতত্ত্বসার ।
সর্ব্বশাস্ত্র-সিদ্ধান্তের ইঁহা পাইবা পার ॥ ২৬৩ ॥

ihāra prasāde pāibā kṛṣṇa-tattva-sāra
of this by the grace you will attain of the truth of Kṛṣṇa the essence
sarva-śāstra-siddhāntera iṁhā pāibā pāra
of all the scriptures of the conclusions here you will reach the far shore

263 By the grace of this *līlā* you will attain the essence of the truth of Kṛṣṇa, and here you will reach the far shore of the conclusions of all the

scriptures.

Kṛṣṇa-līlā and Caitanya-līlā are one undivided river of nectar, to be relished only by a devotee whose heart is pure —

কৃষ্ণলীলা অমৃত-সার, তার শত শত ধার,
দশদিকে বহে যাহা হৈতে ।
সে চৈতন্যলীলা হয়, সরোবর অক্ষয়,
মনো হংস চরাহ' তাহাতে ॥ ২৬৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa-līlā amṛta-sāra, tāra śata śata dhāra,
Kṛṣṇa's līlā of nectar the essence its hundreds hundreds streams
daśa-dike vahe yāhā haite
in the ten directions flow which from
se caitanya-līlā haya, sarovara akṣaya,
that Caitanya's līlā is a lake inexhaustible
mano haṁsa carāha' tāhāte
of the mind the swan let roam in it

264 Kṛṣṇa's *līlā* is the essence of nectar, and Caitanya's *līlā* is the inexhaustible lake from which it flows in hundreds upon hundreds of streams in all ten directions. Let the swan of your mind glide upon it.

The author's humble prayer —

ভক্তগণ, শুন মোর দৈন্য-বচন ।
তোমা-সবার পদধূলি, অঙ্গে বিভূষণ করি',
কিছু মুঞি করোঁ নিবেদন ॥ ২৬৫ ॥ধ্রুব॥

bhakta-gaṇa, śuna mora dainya-vacana
O devotees hear my humble words
tomā-sabāra pada-dhūli, aṅge vibhūṣaṇa kari',
of you all the dust of the feet on my body ornament making
kichu muñi karoṅ nivedana
something I make petition

265 O devotees, hear my humble words. Adorning my body with the dust of your feet, I lay a petition before you.[32]

[The author] asks the devotees to relish the conclusions of devotion and the rasa of love for Kṛṣṇa —

কৃষ্ণভক্তিসিদ্ধান্তগণ, যাতে প্রফুল্ল পদ্মবন,
তার মধু করি' আস্বাদন ।
প্রেমরস-কুমুদবনে, প্রফুল্লিত রাত্রি-দিনে,
তাতে চরাও মনোভৃঙ্গগণ ॥ ২৬৬ ॥

kṛṣṇa-bhakti-siddhānta-gaṇa, yāte praphulla padma-vana,
of devotion to Kṛṣṇa the conclusions in which (lake) blossoming of lotuses the forest
tāra madhu kari' āsvādana
its honey making relishing
prema-rasa-kumuda-vane, praphullita rātri-dine,
of prema of rasa in the forest of kumudas blossoming night and day
tāte carāo mano-bhṛṅga-gaṇa
there let roam of the mind the bees

266 In that lake the conclusions of devotion to Kṛṣṇa are a forest of blossoming lotuses: relish their honey. And the rasa of prema is a forest of *kumuda* lilies blooming night and day: there let the bees of your mind roam.

Anubhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa-līlā alone is "the essence of nectar" (*amṛta-sāra-vastu*); everything else is "without essence" (*asāra*). Hundreds of streams of the essence of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa-līlā flow in all ten directions from the nectar of Kṛṣṇa-līlā. And the essence of the nectar of Kṛṣṇa-līlā is, in turn, Śrī Caitanya-līlā.

In our time, regarding Caitanya-līlā as separate from Kṛṣṇa-līlā, people are trying to create new doctrines — "Nadīyā-nāgarī," the "Gaura-nāgarī līlā" and others — produced by ever newer fancies. Some members of the Theosophical Society, and some of the other groups hostile to devotion, the *prākṛta* Bāuls and the Sahajiyās, cast Śrī Gaurāṅga in the mold of their own unruly worldly tendencies. Some imag-

ine Him a political leader, others a worshipper of Śakti, still others a libertine with illicit lovers (*nāgarīs*).

The eternal *līlā* of Goloka rises in the material world at the time of the Lord's manifestation. Yet at that time none of the associates of Gaura's *līlā*, headed by Śrī Rūpa, ever saw or knew of any "Gaura-nāgara-līlā"; so it is certainly not Caitanya-līlā. Devotion to Gaura must be practiced only by following in the footsteps of a Vaiṣṇava guru who follows Śrī Rūpa. There is no gain at all in plunging into the lake of fancy and forming "the party of the new Gorā"[39].

Caitanya-līlā is the inexhaustible lake; the conclusions of devotion to Kṛṣṇa are the lotus forest of that lake, the rasa of prema is the forest of *kumuda* lilies, and the devotees' minds are the bees.

The varieties of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are the very life of the devotees —

নানা-ভাবের ভক্তজন, হংস-চক্রবাকগণ,
যাতে সবে করেন বিহার ।
কৃষ্ণকেলি-মৃণাল, যাহা পাই' সর্ব্বকাল,
ভক্ত-হংস করয়ে আহার ॥ ২৬৭ ॥

nānā-bhāvera bhakta-jana, haṁsa-cakravāka-gaṇa,
of various bhāvas the devotees swans cakravākas
yāte sabe karena vihāra
in which all make sport
kṛṣṇa-keli-mṛṇāla, yāhā pāi' sarva-kāla,
of Kṛṣṇa's play the lotus stems which finding at all times
bhakta-haṁsa karaye āhāra
the devotee swans make their food

267 Devotees of various *bhāvas* are the swans and *cakravāka* birds who all sport in its waters, and Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are the tender lotus stalks that the devotee-swans find at all times and feed upon.

Anubhāṣya.

The lotus stems of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes are the "food" of the swanlike devotees. The pastimes of Kṛṣṇacandra, the embodiment of the rasa of eternal *sambhoga*, are the food of the eternal servants who have taken shelter of Śrī Gaurasundara — the em-

bodiment of the eternal rasa of *vipralambha*, whose body is nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa.

By such relishing, the joy of prema grows —

সেই সরোবরে গিয়া, হংস-চক্রবাক হঞা,
সদা তাঁহা করহ বিলাস ।
খণ্ডিবে সকল দুঃখ, পাইবা পরম সুখ,
অনায়াসে হবে প্রেমোল্লাস ॥ ২৬৮ ॥

sei sarovare giyā, haṁsa-cakravāka hañā,
to that lake going swans cakravākas becoming
sadā tāṁhā karaha vilāsa
always there do enjoy
khaṇḍibe sakala duḥkha, pāibā parama sukha,
will be cut off all sorrows you will attain supreme happiness
anāyāse habe premollāsa
without effort there will be the elation of prema

268 Go to that lake, become swans and *cakravākas*, and sport there for ever. All your sorrows will be cut away, you will attain the highest happiness, and the elation of prema will come without effort.

Anubhāṣya.

O devotees of Gaura, plunge into the lake of Caitanya-līlā and, eternally serving Kṛṣṇa as swans and *cakravākas* sheltered at Śrī Gaura's feet, sport in the lake of worship of Śrī Gaura. Then you will not have to suffer the "sorrow" of serving someone other than Kṛṣṇa, which comes from imagining Gaurāṅga, as the "Nadīyā-nāgarī" do, to be some material object of enjoyment. You will attain the supreme happiness, service to Kṛṣṇa, and become intoxicated with the joy of love for Kṛṣṇa.

The pure devotees distribute to the people of the world the nectar of the

pastimes of Gaura and Kṛṣṇa —

এই অমৃত অনুক্ষণ, সাধু মহান্ত-মেঘগণ,
বিশ্বোদ্যানে করে বরিষণ ।
তাতে ফলে অমৃত-ফল, ভক্ত খায় নিরন্তর,
তার প্রেমে জীয়ে জগজন ॥ ২৬৯ ॥

ei amṛta anukṣaṇa, sādhu mahānta-megha-gaṇa,
this nectar constantly the sādhus great souls clouds
viśvodyāne kare variṣaṇa
on the garden of the world make showering
tāte phale amṛta-phala, bhakta khāya nirantara,
by that grow nectarean fruits the devotees eat constantly
tāra preme jīye jaga-jana
by their love live the people of the world

269 The sādhus and great souls, like clouds, constantly shower this nectar on the garden of the world. From it grow nectarean fruits. The devotees feast on them without cease, and the whole world lives by the love of these devotees.

Anubhāṣya.
The saintly *mahāntas* sheltered at Gaura's feet, like clouds, always shower the nectar of Kṛṣṇa-līlā on the garden of this world. This watering by streams of rain yields fruits — the nectar of prema; the devotees eat them constantly, and the people of the world live by that prema.

Gaura-līlā is a filling of thickened milk, and Kṛṣṇa-līlā in it is fine camphor; one can relish them by the path of śruti, by the mercy of Hari, the guru and the Vaiṣṇavas —

চৈতন্যলীলা — অমৃতপূর, কৃষ্ণলীলা — সুকর্পূর,
দুহে মিলি' হয় সুমাধুর্য্য ।
সাধু-গুরু-প্রসাদে, তাহা যেই আস্বাদে,
সেই জানে মাধুর্য্য-প্রাচুর্য্য ॥ ২৭০ ॥

caitanya-līlā — amṛta-pūra, kṛṣṇa-līlā — sukarpūra,
Caitanya's līlā — a filling of nectar Kṛṣṇa's līlā — fine camphor
duhe mili' haya sumādhurya
the two combining become exquisite sweetness
sādhu-guru-prasāde, tāhā yei āsvāde,
of the sādhus and guru by the grace that whoever relishes
sei jāne mādhurya-prācurya
he knows of sweetness the abundance

270 Caitanya's *līlā* is a filling of nectar (*amṛta-pūra*), and Kṛṣṇa's *līlā* is fine camphor; combined, the two become an exquisite sweetness. Whoever relishes it by the grace of the sādhus and the Guru knows the abundance of that sweetness.

Anubhāṣya.

The nectar of Caitanya-līlā is like the *pūra*, the filling made of that nectar of prema, and Kṛṣṇa-līlā is like fine camphor; only when these two nectars are joined is there excellent sweetness. The sweetness of Kṛṣṇa-līlā, nourished by the nectar of Caitanya-līlā, has become full of excellent sweetness.

The band of *asuras* hostile to Gaura do not accept Gaura's *līlā* or the Gaura-mantra; so they have no chance of tasting the sweetness of Kṛṣṇa-līlā. The band of *daityas* hostile to Kṛṣṇa, on the other hand, are indifferent to the nectar of Kṛṣṇa-līlā. Imagining themselves *nāgarīs* and following the "Nadīyā-nāgarī," they separate from Kṛṣṇa Gaura — the embodiment of the rasa of *vipralambha*, whose body is nondifferent from Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa — that is, they make Him an embodiment of the rasa of *sambhoga*; thus they uproot the sweetness of the variety of Gaura's *līlā*.

Abundant sweetness is relished only by joining the two *līlās* — when, by the mercy of sādhus and gurus who follow Śrī Rūpa, that is, by following Śrī Rūpa, one knows the nectar of Gaura-līlā and the nectar of Kṛṣṇa-līlā to be nondifferent from each other. A follower of Śrī Rūpa firmly believes in this alone.

The nectar of these two līlās is the devotee's food; the two are inseparably one

—

যে লীলামৃত বিনে, খায় যদি অন্নপানে,
তবে ভক্তের দুর্ব্বল জীবন ।
যার একবিন্দু-পানে, উৎফুল্লিত তনুমনে,
হাসে, গায়, করয়ে নর্ত্তন ॥ ২৭১ ॥

ye līlāmṛta vine, khāya yadi anna-pāne,
which the nectar of līlā without eats if food and drink
tabe bhaktera durbala jīvana
then of the devotee feeble the life
yāra eka-bindu-pāne, utphullita tanu-mane,
whose of a single drop by drinking blossoming in body and mind
hāse, gāya, karaye nartana
laughs sings does dancing

271 If a devotee takes food and drink without the nectar of this *līlā*, his life grows feeble; but by drinking a single drop of it he blossoms in body and mind, and laughs, sings and dances.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

People are nourished by food and drink. The devotees, though they too take food and drink as those averse to God do, grow weak if they do not drink the nectar of Caitanya-līlā mixed with Kṛṣṇa-līlā.

Anubhāṣya.

A variant reading: *khāya yadi anupāne* (“if he takes [food] with a drink”).

This nectar is hard to obtain by the path of reasoning —

এ অমৃত কর পান, যার সম নাহি আন,
চিত্তে করি’ সুদৃঢ় বিশ্বাস ।
না পড়’ কুতর্ক-গর্ত্তে, অমেধ্য কর্কশ আবর্ত্তে,
যাতে পড়িলে হয় সর্ব্বনাশ ॥ ২৭২ ॥

e amṛta kara pāna, yāra sama nāhi āna,
this nectar do drinking whose equal there is not other
citte kari' sudṛḍha viśvāsa
in the heart making firm faith
nā paḍa' kutarka-garte, amedhya karkaśa āvarte,
not fall into the pit of false argument into the impure harsh whirlpool
yāte paḍile haya sarva-nāśa
into which having fallen there is total ruin

272 Drink this nectar, which has no equal, with firm faith in your heart. Do not fall into the pit of false argument, into its impure and harsh whirlpool: whoever falls there meets total ruin.

Anubhāṣya.
If, regarding the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa and of Gaura as different from each other, one is swept along by the impure, harsh whirlwind rooted in false arguments, and gives up worship of Kṛṣṇa to worship Gaura, or gives up service to Gaura to serve Kṛṣṇa, the deluded jīva is utterly ruined.

Obeisance to the Pañca-tattva and to the listeners —

শ্রীচৈতন্য, নিত্যানন্দ, শ্রীঅদ্বৈত, ভক্তবৃন্দ,
আর যত শ্রোতা ভক্তগণ ।
তোমা-সবার শ্রীচরণ, করি শিরে বিভূষণ,
যাহা হৈতে অভীষ্ট-পূরণ ॥ ২৭৩ ॥

śrī-caitanya, nityānanda, śrīadvaita, bhakta-vṛnda,
Śrī Caitanya Nityānanda Śrī Advaita the devotees
āra yata śrotā bhakta-gaṇa
and all listening devotees
tomā-sabāra śrī-caraṇa, kari śire vibhūṣaṇa,
of you all the holy feet I make on my head an ornament
yāhā haite abhīṣṭa-pūraṇa
from which of the cherished desire fulfilment

273 Śrī Caitanya, Nityānanda, Śrī Advaita, the assembly of devotees, and all you devotees who listen — I make your holy feet the ornament of my

head, for from them comes the fulfilment of every cherished desire.

Obeisance to the beloved worshipable [teachers] —

শ্রীরূপ-সনাতন- রঘুনাথ-জীব-চরণ,
শিরে ধরি, — যার করি আশ ।
কৃষ্ণলীলামৃতান্বিত, চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত,
কহে কিছু দীন কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ২৭৪ ॥

śrī-rūpa-sanātana- raghunātha-jīva-caraṇa,
of Śrī Rūpa Sanātana Raghunātha Jīva the feet
śire dhari, — yāra kari āśa
on my head holding — in which I place my hope
kṛṣṇa-līlāmṛtānvita, caitanya-caritāmṛta,
endowed with the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's līlā the Caitanya-caritāmṛta
kahe kichu dīna kṛṣṇadāsa
tells a little lowly Kṛṣṇadāsa

274 Holding on my head the feet of Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha and Jīva, in whom I place my hope, lowly Kṛṣṇadāsa tells a little of the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, which is filled with the nectar of Kṛṣṇa's *līlā*.

শ্রীমন্মদনগোপাল-গোবিন্দদেব-তুষ্টয়ে ।
চৈতন্যার্পিতমস্ত্বেতচ্চৈতন্যচরিতামৃতম্ ॥ ২৭৫ ॥

śrīman-madana-gopāla-
of Śrīman Madana-Gopāla
govinda-deva-tuṣṭaye
and Govinda-deva for the satisfaction
caitanyārpitam astv etac
offered to Caitanya may be this
caitanya-caritāmṛtam
Caitanya-caritāmṛta

275 For the satisfaction of Śrīman Madana-Gopāla and Govinda-deva, may this *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* be offered to Śrī Caitanya.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

May this *Caitanya-caritāmṛta* be offered to Kṛṣṇa Caitanya for the pleasure of Śrī Madana-Gopāla and Śrī Govinda-deva.

Anubhāṣya.

śrīman-madana-gopāla-govinda-deva-tuṣṭaye (for the satisfaction, the pleasure, of Śrīman Madana-Gopāla and Govinda-deva) **etat caitanya-caritāmṛtam caitanyārpitam astu** (I offer to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya).

Indifferent to the blame and praise of non-devotees, the author considers himself fulfilled by the devotees' happiness alone —

তদিদমতিরহস্যং গৌরলীলামৃতং যৎ
খলু সমুদয়লোকৈর্নাদৃতং তৈরলভ্যম্ ।
ক্ষতিরিয়মিহ কা মে স্বাদিতং যৎ সমন্তাৎ
সহৃদয়-সুমনোভির্মোদমেষাং তনোতি ॥ ২৭৬ ॥

tad idam ati-rahasyaṁ gaura-līlāmṛtaṁ yat
that this most secret the nectar of Gaura's līlā which
khalu samudaya-lokair nādṛtaṁ tair alabhyam
indeed by the mass of people not honoured by them unattainable
kṣatir iyam iha kā me svāditaṁ yat samantāt
loss this here what to me relished since on all sides
sahṛdaya-sumanobhir modam eṣāṁ tanoti
by the large-hearted the noble-minded joy their expands

276 This most secret nectar of Gaura's *līlā* is surely not honoured by the common crowd: it lies beyond their reach. What loss is that to me? Relished on every side by the large-hearted and noble-minded, it increases their joy.[33]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This most confidential nectar of Gaura's pastimes is the treasure of a devotee's life, but the unqualified will certainly not value it. That is no loss to me. On the contrary, all good-hearted sādhus have fully relished the nectar of these pastimes; may this book increase the joy of those great souls.

Thus ends the twenty-fifth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

Anubhāṣya.

ati-rahasyaṁ (most confidential) **tat gaura-līlāmṛtam** (this jewel of a book) **khalu** (certainly) **samudaya-lokaiḥ** (by all the wicked, unqualified people) **na ādṛtam**, **yataḥ** ([for] it) **taiḥ** (for the wicked) **alabhyam** (is impossible to obtain). **iha** (in this) **me** (my) **iyaṁ kā kṣatiḥ** (what loss)? — **yat** (since here) **sahṛdaya-sumanobhiḥ** (by guileless sages whose hearts are wholly devoted) **samantāt** (on all sides) **svāditam** (being relished) **eṣām** (of these noble souls) **modam tanoti** (increases).

Thus ends the twenty-fifth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.18; translation as there. ↩
2. The same verse as Madhya 22.22; translation as there. ↩
3. The same verse as Madhya 22.30; translation as there. ↩
4. The same verse as Madhya 17.186; translation as there. ↩
5. The same verse as Ādi 17.122; translation as there. ↩
6. The same verse as Madhya 18.116; translation as there. Reference as in the heading of the edition (in Madhya 18.116 — the *Vaiṣṇava-tantra* only). ↩
7. The same verse as Madhya 19.150; translation as there. ↩
8. The same verse as Madhya 15.270; translation as there. ↩
9. The same verse as Madhya 22.53; translation as there. ↩
10. In the edition Vyāsa's thought is printed in quotation marks. ↩
11. The same verse as Ādi 1.51; translation as there. Numbered as in the heading of the edition (p. 835): 2.9.30; in Ādi 1.51 and in other editions — 2.9.31. ↩
12. The same verse as Ādi 1.52; translation as there. Numbered as in the heading of the edition (p. 836): 2.9.31; in Ādi 1.52 and in other editions — 2.9.32. ↩
13. The same verse as Madhya 24.72 (= Ādi 1.53); translation as there. Numbered as in the heading of the edition (p. 836): 2.9.32, as in Madhya 24.72; in Ādi 1.53 and in other editions — 2.9.33. ↩
14. The same verse as Ādi 1.54; translation as there. Numbered as in the heading of the edition (p. 837): 2.9.33; in Ādi 1.54 and in other editions — 2.9.34. ↩
15. "These four" (*e 'cāri' vicāra*) beside *dharmādi* are, according to the *Anubhāṣya* and the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*, the four aims of life (*catur-varga*): dharma, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa*. ↩

16. The same verse as Ādi 1.56; translation as there. Numbered as in the heading of the edition (p. 837): 2.9.35; in Ādi 1.56 and in other editions — 2.9.36. ↩
17. The same verse as Ādi 1.55; translation as there. Numbered as in the heading of the edition (p. 837): 2.9.34; in Ādi 1.55 and in other editions — 2.9.35. ↩
18. The same verse as Madhya 8.274; translation as there. ↩
19. The same verse as Ādi 2.11; translation as there. ↩
20. The same verse as Madhya 20.138; translation as there. ↩
21. The same verse as Ādi 7.94; translation as there. ↩
22. Number as in the heading of the edition (p. 839): 1.3.42; 1.3.41 in the numbering of other editions. ↩
23. The same verse as Madhya 8.265; translation as there. ↩
24. The same verse as Ādi 1.91 (there «কিং বা»; here, as in the edition, «কিম্বা»); translation as there. The verse names no sage (*mahā-muni-kṛte*, “composed by the great sage”); the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 1.91 explains: Śrī Nārāyaṇa. ↩
25. The same verse as Madhya 8.65; translation as there. ↩
26. The same verse as Madhya 24.107; translation and reference as there, following the heading of the edition (p. 841). The line is printed without a number (only «॥»). ↩
27. The same verse as Madhya 24.46; translation as there. The edition (p. 841) reads «নৈর্গুণ্যে». ↩
28. The same verse as Madhya 17.142; translation as there. ↩
29. The same verse as Madhya 6.186; translation as there. Here the Lord’s speech, begun in 89, ends; from 153 the edition resumes the narrative. ↩
30. The first line of the verse is the second line of Madhya 16.252; that half is translated as there. ↩
31. The second line of the verse is the same as in Madhya 15.301; translated as there. ↩
32. «ধ্রুব» (in the edition «ধ্রু») after the number marks the refrain of the song. ↩
33. Here the edition gives the colophon: “Thus ends the twenty-fifth chapter of the Madhya-khaṇḍa of the *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*: Making the Residents of Kāśī Vaiṣṇavas, and the Return to Nīlācala”, and the words: “Thus the Madhya-līlā is completed.” ↩
34. The edition reads «তিনমূর্ত্তির» (“of the three forms”), apparently for «চিন্মূর্ত্তির» (“of the spiritual form”); checked against the scan. ↩
35. The verse translation reads differently: “purified Sanātana Gosvāmī by instructing him in spiritual truths.” ↩
36. The verse translation reads differently: “made of pure spiritual bliss.” ↩

37. In the edition this unnumbered paragraph stands right after the comment on verse 128; by its sense it probably refers to verse 130 (the example of a verse on *sambandha*). The translation of 1.3.28 follows CC Ādi 2.67. ↩
38. So in the edition; in the verse translation and in the accepted numbering, *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.41. ↩
39. Gorā is the colloquial Bengali form of the name Gaura. ↩